Executive Governance Manual

Fraternal Council Archives™

Offline print edition

Compiled 2026-11-05 from docs/EXECUTIVE_GOVERNANCE_MANUAL.md

Fraternal Council Archives™ — Executive Governance Manual

Audience: the Grand Knight (GK) and the Deputy Grand Knight (DGK). Recorders, Historians, Trustees and other seated officers use the chapters on their own desks.

Covers: the navigation map, meetings and elections, events, the final release of payments, charity vetting and endorsement, performance and the executive dashboard, flagged hours, the roadmap, the Active Desks, goals, the loaner library, affiliations, the Operations Knowledge Vault and the global search bar.

One portfolio for two seats. The Deputy Grand Knight holds every grant of the Grand Knight. Each task in this manual that names the Grand Knight is also a task of the Deputy Grand Knight.

Open this manual from your desk. The Grand Knight Desk header has **Executive Governance Manual (PDF)** and a **How do I…** search that answers from this manual only.

Signing up, logging hours and taking donations are in the *Member User Guide*.

Numbering and shared tasks: this manual numbers its own chapters from 1. A task that several officers do is printed word for word in the manual of each of those officers. A reference to a section in another manual names that manual. The manual map lists the chapters of all four officer manuals.

Contents

- 1. Left navigation map
- 2. Governance
- 3. Faith In Action
- 4. Finances: release, vetting and endorsement
- 5. Performance
- 6. Resources
- 7. Find members with a trade skill
- 8. Automated messages reference
- 9. Member engagement
- 10. Flagged hours review
- 11. Council Wide Settings
- 12. Asset photos and remote help
- 13. Annual roadmap, meeting check-in and meeting photos
- 14. The Active Desks dashboard
- 15. The Shared Equipment Library and the colour-coded calendar
- 16. Planning workflows and bilateral council affiliations
- 17. The Operations Knowledge Vault
- 18. Revenue split profiles
- 19. The global search bar
- 20. The Navigation Guide screen
- 21. Testing and training sandboxes
- Manual map

How to read a tutorial

Every tutorial starts with a **Prerequisite (who can do this)** line. The line states the access privilege that the task needs. Stop when your role is not on the line.

Every tutorial then has five parts: **Goal**, **Start point**, **Steps**, **Expected result** and **Common problems**. A **Warning** line comes before the steps when the task deletes data, sends messages, posts money or cannot be undone.

---

1. Left navigation map

This part maps every link of the left navigation, then the **Active Desks** tabs, then the timed settings, then the phone app. Each category is a collapsible block. Only the overview is open. Select a category title to open it. Select the title again to close it.

1.1 Overview: how the left navigation works

Overview — read this first

- **Everyone lands on Home.** After you sign in, the portal opens on the **Home** tab of the **Active Desks** row. This is true for every member, officer, Admin and Super Admin, every time you sign in, even when you had another tab open before. **Home** shows the newsletters, the feast days, your reminders, today's agenda, the honor board and the prayer list. The only button on **Home** is **Praying Hands** (section 14.2).
- **Your volunteer check-in is on the Member Actions Hub.** Select **Member Actions Hub** in the **Faith In Action** pillar. The page opens at its own address, `/member-actions`, under the heading **Member Actions Hub**. It holds only the four tabs of the Volunteer Check-In & Service Center: **My active shifts**, **Registration desk**, **Fraternal roster** and **Hour ledger** (section 14.6). The shift trackers, your charity requests and your open sheets are on the **Member Desk** tab.
- **The Navigation Guide follows your role.** A member reads a short summary of each page that the member can open. Officers, Admins and Super Admins read the full map (section 1.7).
- **The sidebar shows only your links.** A link that your role cannot open does not show. The sidebar never shows a locked or greyed-out link. A pillar with no allowed links does not show.
- **Seven pillars, always open.** The sidebar groups its links into seven pillars: **Governance**, **Faith In Action**, **Finances**, **Performance**, **Resources**, **Answers** and **System Settings**. Section 1.3 lists the links of each pillar.
- **The Navigation Guide is at the top.** It explains each link that your sidebar shows (sections 1.7 and 1.8).
- **Three pages open from the header. Messaging** (envelope icon) opens **Council Messages & Alerts** and **My Distribution Lists**. **Help** (question-mark icon) opens the **Online Help Center**. Your name opens **My Profile**.
- **The Active Desks row is on every page.** It holds **Home** and the desks that your seat clears (section 1.4).
- **Switched-off modules are gone.** A module that your council switched off has no link (section 2 of the Super Admin System Manual).

1.2 Left navigation by category

The categories group the links by the work you do. A link can sit in a different pillar from its category. The **Pillar** column names where to find the link in the sidebar.

Dashboard

Link	Pillar	Who sees it	What it holds	Section
Home	Faith In Action	Every member	The newsletters feed, the verse, your reminders (read only), the feast days, today's agenda, the Top 5 honor board and the prayer list with **Praying Hands**	14.2
Member Actions Hub	Faith In Action	Every member	Its own page, `/member-actions`: the four Volunteer Check-In & Service Center tabs - **My active shifts**, **Registration desk**, **Fraternal roster** and **Hour ledger**	14.6
Executive Dashboard	Performanc e	Officers, Admins, the Council Historian	The roadmap ribbon and the **Executive Summary**	14.11

Link	Pillar	Who sees it	What it holds	Section
Council Dashboard	Performance	Every member	The council's engagement, the leaderboards and the membership history	9.1
Financial Dashboard	Finances	General ledger readers	The council's money at a glance	2.4 (Treasurer Manual)
Growth & Hours Charts	Performance	Officers, Admins	Membership growth and service hours by month	5.2

Calendars

Link	Pillar	Who sees it	What it holds	Section
Visual Master Calendar	Faith In Action	Every member	Events, shifts, meetings and birthdays by date, in mission colours	15.4
Event Planner	Faith In Action	Event planners, Admins	Event dates, shifts and sign-up targets	3
Recurring Meetings	Governance	Officers, Admins	The year's meeting pattern	2.4
Meeting Center	Governance	Every member	Meetings, invitations and minutes	2
Live Meeting Console	Governance	Officers, Admins	The live agenda, check-ins, ballots and hand tallies	2.1

Rosters

Council roster

Link	Pillar	Who sees it	What it holds	Section
Supreme Council Sync	System Settings	Admins, finance officers	The Supreme Council reports, Forms 1728 and 1295. The roster CSV upload is on the **Financial Secretary Desk**	2.4 (Financial Secretary Manual)
Council Roster	Faith In Action (first link)	Every member reads it. Council Admins and Super Admins add and edit members there	The phone, email and degree of active brothers of your council and its sister councils. A Super Admin sees every council, with a **Council** picker to filter the list. Admins get **Add Member**, **Edit** on each row (every status for their own council) and **Skills**. The same list is on the **Member Desk**, the **Grand Knight Desk** and the **Financial Secretary Desk**	14.6
Member Actions Hub → **Fraternal roster** tab	Faith In Action	Every member	The same list as **Council Roster**	14.6

Officer seats and connected councils

Link	Pillar	Who sees it	What it holds	Section
Council Election Center	Governance	Every member	Election progress, nominations and the secret ballot at a live meeting	2.7

Link	Pillar	Who sees it	What it holds	Section
Appointed Leadership Matrix	Governance	The GK, the DGK, Admins	The appointed seats	2.7
Connected Councils	System Settings	The GK, the DGK, Admins	Affiliation invites and the connected councils	16.5

Vetting

Expense signatures

Link	Pillar	Who sees it	What it holds	Section
FS Expense Audit Queue	Finances	The FS, Admins	Reports that wait for a payment request	6.4 (Financial Secretary Manual)
Treasurer Ledger Audit	Finances	The Treasurer, Admins	Reports to code to a budget line and a GL account	6.4 (Treasurer Manual)
GK Expense Authorize	Finances	The GK, the DGK, Admins	Reports that wait for the final signature	14.5

Charity grants

Link	Pillar	Who sees it	What it holds	Section
Propose Charity Grant	Finances	Every member	The charity proposal form	4.3
Charity Vetting Queue	Governance	Officers, Trustees, Admins	Proposals to vet	4.3
Charitable Grants Registry	Finances	Finance officers, Super Admins	Approved grants and their checks	2.7 (Treasurer Manual)

Audits

Link	Pillar	Who sees it	What it holds	Section
Trustee Semiannual Audit	Finances	Trustees, general ledger readers	The semiannual audit and its period locks	4

Ledgers

Money ledgers

Link	Pillar	Who sees it	What it holds	Section
General Ledger	Finances	General ledger readers	The chart of accounts and every posting	2.4 (Treasurer Manual)
Balance Sheet	Finances	General ledger readers	Assets, liabilities and net worth	2.4 (Treasurer Manual)
My Expense Reports	Finances	Every member	Your own expense reports and their status	4.1
Disbursed Check Registry	Finances	Finance officers, Super Admins	Approved reports paid by check	2.3 (Treasurer Manual)
Donations History	Finances	Officers, Admins	Recorded donations	1.9 (Financial Secretary Manual)

Link	Pillar	Who sees it	What it holds	Section
Annual Budget Center	Finances	Every member reads it	The council's annual budget	2.9 (Treasurer Manual)

Service and asset ledgers

Link	Pillar	Who sees it	What it holds	Section
Post-event Ledger	Performance	Every member	Event results that event owners record	5.3
Member Actions Hub → Hour ledger tab	Faith In Action	Every member	Your logged service hours	14.6
Shared Equipment Library	Resources	Every member	The items the council and its connected councils lend	15.1

Archives

Link	Pillar	Who sees it	What it holds	Section
Fraternal Annals & Oral History	Performance	Every member	Annals, the diary, oral histories and the In Memoriam roll	5
Operations Knowledge Vault	System Settings	Officers, Admins	Every lesson the councils filed	17.3
Lessons Registry	Performance	Officers, Admins	Lessons from past events	5.5
Media & Memory Center (**Browse Gallery**, **Gallery Administration Hub**)	Top of the sidebar	Every member	Event and meeting photos, albums and photo uploads	6.2
Council Artifacts	Resources	Every member	Flyers, minutes and photo albums filed in Google Drive	6.2
Constitutional Bylaws	Governance	Every member	The council's bylaws	2.8
SOP Center	Answers	Every member	The standard operating procedures	4.1 (Administrator User Guide)

Settings, planning and help

Planning and faith

Link	Pillar	Who sees it	What it holds	Section
Member Activities	Faith In Action	Admins, activity keepers	The council's standing activities	3.4
Faith Center	Faith In Action	Every member	The feast day, the daily verse and the prayer intentions	3
Recruitment Factory	Resources	Officers, Admins	Event flyers	6.3
Constitutional Advisor	Governance	Officers, Admins, Super Admins	Parliamentary answers with citations	2

Help

Link	Pillar	Who sees it	What it holds	Section
Online Help Center	Answers	Every member	Answers to common questions	4 (Administrator User Guide)
Interactive Help Desk	Answers	Every member	Task search over the member guide	4 (Administrator User Guide)
Navigation Guide	Top of the sidebar	Every member	Your own collapsible map, at your role's depth	1.7

System Settings

Link	Who sees it	What it holds	Section
Council Wide Settings	Officers, Admins, Super Admins	Five drawers: Standard Bank Accounts, User Access & Roster Control, System Settings, Feature Controls, Council Feature Deployment Matrix	11
Council Lookup Tables	Admins, finance officers	Payment methods, lists and the email gateway	5.1 (Administrator User Guide)
Secure Access Vault	Officers, Admins, Super Admins	Sealed keys for Drive, mail and receipt reading	5.2 (Administrator User Guide)
Master Feature Deployment Grid	Super Admins	The module switches of each council	2 (Super Admin System Manual)
Global System Parameters	Super Admins	Dues, organization type and platform settings	4.1 (Super Admin System Manual)
Councils	Super Admins	The council list	3.4 (Super Admin System Manual)
Global Charities Registry	Super Admins	The shared charity list	3.4 (Super Admin System Manual)
Global Lookup Tables	Super Admins	The global lookup tables	3.4 (Super Admin System Manual)
Parish & Pastors Linkage	Admins	Parishes, pastors, pastor assignments and the home parish link (adds the parish's General Ledger accounts)	5.6 (Administrator User Guide), 3.5 (Super Admin System Manual)
Remote Assistance Desk	Super Admins	Co-watching help sessions	12.3
Impersonate Council Admin	Super Admins	View the portal as a council Admin you are helping	6.2 (Super Admin System Manual)
View As Member	Council Admins, Super Admins	A read-only picture of what one member of your own council sees	9.1 (Administrator User Guide)
Administrative Feedback Loops	Admins, Super Admins	Notes to the platform owner	10.1 (Administrator User Guide)

1.3 The links of each pillar

The seven pillars, in sidebar order

Pillar	Links, in sidebar order
Governance	Live Meeting Console, Recurring Meetings, Meeting Center, Council Election Center, Appointed Leadership Matrix, Constitutional Bylaws, Constitutional Advisor, Charity Vetting Queue
Faith In Action	Member Activities, Member Actions Hub, Event Planner, Visual Master Calendar, Faith Center

Pillar	Links, in sidebar order
Finances	My Expense Reports, Propose Charity Grant (always at the top); then the **FINANCIAL REPORTS** accordion (Chart of Accounts & GL, Balance Sheet, Financial Dashboard, Annual Budget Center) and the **FINANCIAL ACTIONS** accordion (Treasurer Ledger Audit, FS Expense Audit Queue, GK Expense Authorize, Trustee Semiannual Audit, Disbursed Check Registry, Charitable Grants Registry, Donations History)
Performance	Council Dashboard, Executive Dashboard, Growth & Hours Charts, Fraternal Annals & Oral History, Post-event Ledger, Lessons Registry
Resources	Council Artifacts, Recruitment Factory, Shared Equipment Library
Answers	Online Help Center, Interactive Help Desk, SOP Center
System Settings	Councils, Master Feature Deployment Grid, Global System Parameters, Remote Assistance Desk, Impersonate Council Admin, View As Member, Administrative Feedback Loops, Council Wide Settings, Connected Councils, Operations Knowledge Vault, Supreme Council Sync, Council Lookup Tables, Secure Access Vault, Council Asset Management, Global Charities Registry, Global Lookup Tables, Parish & Pastors Linkage

The **System Settings** pillar had the name **Setup** in earlier versions of the portal.

Two changes came with Sprint 10:

- The sidebar has no **Home** link. Select the **Home** tab in the tab row above every page.
- **Media & Memory Center** sits above the pillars, under **Navigation Guide**. Its two links are **Browse Gallery** and **Gallery Administration Hub**.
- The sidebar shows its links as plain text, with no icons. Admins and Super Admins open the **Admin Desk** from its tab on the **Active Desks** row.

The menu button (three lines) at the top of the sidebar hides the sidebar. Select the menu button again to show the sidebar. The portal remembers the choice on each computer.

1.4 Desks map: the Active Desks tabs

The desk tabs and their drawers

Tab	Who gets the tab	Drawers or sections	Section
Home	Every member	**Latest Council Newsletters & Bulletins**, Bible Verse of the Day, Live Actionable Reminders, Liturgical Feast Day Tracker, Upcoming Event Agenda, Top 5 Fraternal Volunteers, Community Prayer Request List. No links into the desks; the only button is **Praying Hands**.	14.2
Super Admin Desk	Super Admins	Communications Cabinet (Feedback Communication Center, Council Access Request Approval Queue), Settings Cabinet (Global System Parameters, Global Lookup Tables, System Feature Flag Control Panel, Secure Access Vault), Global Charities Registry	10.3 (Admin User Guide)

Tab	Who gets the tab	Drawers or sections	Section
Grand Knight Desk	The GK, the DGK, Admins, Super Admins	Approved Expenses, Flagged Hours Review, Shifts Awaiting Hours, Charitable Grant Requests Vetting Board, FS/GK Compliance Endorsements, Council Goals & Targets, Shared Equipment Library, Affiliation Invites, Connected Councils, Constitutional Advisor Panels; **Reference Workflows**: Charitable Donation Workflow, Planning & Budgeting Workflow, Council Election Workflow	14.5
Financial Secretary Desk	The FS, Admins, Super Admins	FS Expense Audit Queue, Expense Report (ER) Routing Track, Charitable Donation Records, FS/GK Compliance Endorsements, Charitable Grants Registry, Excel Roster Imports; **Reference Workflows**: Expense Report (ER) Workflow, Charitable Donation Workflow (outgoing charity grants)	6.4 (Financial Secretary Manual)
Treasurer Desk	The Treasurer, Admins, Super Admins	Treasurer Ledger Audit, Disbursed Check Registry, Charitable Grants Registry, Cash Box Audit Closure Panel, High-Volume Batch Transaction Coder, Annual Budget vs Actuals Ledger Grid, Bank Statement Match-Window; **Accounting Configuration**: General Ledger; **Reference Workflows**: Expense Report (ER) Workflow, Charitable Donation Workflow, Planning & Budgeting Workflow	6.4 (Treasurer Manual)
Recorder Desk	The Recorder, Admins, Super Admins	Historical Meeting Minutes Archive, Meeting Minutes Entry Desk, Start Live Meeting Sequence, Council Resolutions and Motions Ledger; **Reference Workflows**: Council Election Workflow	14.8
Historian Desk	The Council Historian, Admins, Super Admins	Fraternal Diary Entry Logs, Monthly Newsletters, Meeting Photos, Oral History Recordings, Google Drive Media Gallery Sync Board; **Reference Workflows**: Council Election Workflow	14.10
Member Desk	Every member	**Open Shifts Needing Volunteers** and **My shifts** side by side at the top, **My Charity Requests**, **My open expense sheets**, the **Council Roster** panel	14.6

1.5 Timed settings map

The time windows and reminder days

Setting	Default	Where it is set	Who changes it	Section
Days after an event or meeting to submit expenses	30 days	**Council Wide Settings** → **System Settings** drawer → **Financial Submissions**	Officers, Admins, Super Admins	11.2
Days back a member may log volunteer time	90 days	**Council Wide Settings** → **System Settings** drawer → **Volunteer & Meeting Operations**	Officers, Admins, Super Admins	11.2

Setting	Default	Where it is set	Who changes it	Section
Hours before an event that gate donations open	2 hours	**Council Wide Settings** → **System Settings** drawer → **Volunteer & Meeting Operations**	Officers, Admins, Super Admins	11.2
Days after a meeting that the minutes are due	7 days	**Council Wide Settings** → **System Settings** drawer → **Volunteer & Meeting Operations**	Officers, Admins, Super Admins	11.2
Days without service before a member counts as inactive	365 days	**Council Wide Settings** → **System Settings** drawer → **Volunteer & Meeting Operations**	Officers, Admins, Super Admins	3.4 (Financial Secretary Manual)
Days after a shift before the first hours reminder	5 days	**Council Wide Settings** → **System Settings** drawer → **Reminder Cadences**	Officers, Admins, Super Admins	11.2
Days between follow-up hours reminders	7 days	**Council Wide Settings** → **System Settings** drawer → **Reminder Cadences**	Officers, Admins, Super Admins	11.2
Invitation lead time, sign-in length, record retention	See section 4.2 of the Super Admin System Manual	**Global System Parameters** → **Platform Settings**	Super Admins	4.2 (Super Admin System Manual)

The settings marked **Not used yet** on the page are saved for future features (section 11.2). Your own **Navigation Guide** shows the numbers in force for your council now.

1.6 Mobile lines: the phone app tabs

The five phone tabs

Tab	Use the tab to	Can the council switch it off?
Home	See your upcoming shifts and your expense report summary	No
Mtgs	Answer meeting invitations and read agendas	Yes, with **Meeting management**
Signup	Find shifts in the next 30 days and sign up	Yes, with **Event shifts**
Report	Log hours for a council activity or a shift	No
Collect	Record cash, card, QR-code and item donations	Yes, with **Fundraising inflow**

The navy header of the phone holds the **envelope** (messages) and **your name** (**Settings**, large text and **Sign out**). The member guide explains each phone task.

1.7 Concept: the Navigation Guide

The **Navigation Guide** link is at the top of the sidebar, above the seven pillars. Every member sees the link.

The **Navigation Guide** page is a collapsible map in the same order as this part: the sidebar categories, your desks, your time limits and the phone tabs. Only the **Overview** block is open. Select a block title to open it. Chapter 20 explains the screen in full.

The page reads your member type and your officer roles. The page then lists only the links and desks that you can open. The depth of the map follows your role.

You sign in as	Depth	The guide shows
Member	Summary	One short sentence for each page that you can open, for example **Home**, **Member Actions Hub**, **Visual Master Calendar** and the **Member Desk**. No leadership, finance desk or settings page.
Council Officer	Full	The member pages and the desks of your office, with the sidebar pillar of each link and every drawer of each desk. For example **GK Expense Authorize** and the **Grand Knight Desk** drawers for the Grand Knight.
Council Admin	Full	The member pages and the leadership, finance and settings pages of your council, with every drawer of each desk.
Super Admin	Full	Every page, including **Global System Parameters**, and the **Admin Desk** and **Super Admin Desk** tabs on the **Active Desks** row.

A few pages read differently for leaders. For example, a member reads that **Annual Budget Center** shows the budget. A leader also reads that budget keepers draft and approve the budget there. A module that your council switched off is not in the guide, because the module is not in your sidebar.

The **Your time limits** part of the guide lists the time windows and reminder days in force for you now. The guide reads the numbers from your council's settings and the platform settings each time the page opens. A member sees the limits that a member meets: the expense window, the logging window, the hours reminders, the invitation lead time and the sign-in length. A leader also sees every other time setting. The settings that no feature uses yet are listed last under **Saved for future features (not used yet)**.

1.8 Read your Navigation Guide

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** Every signed-in member.

Goal: Learn what each link in your sidebar does.

Start point: Sidebar → **Navigation Guide** (at the top, above the pillars).

Steps:

1. Select **Navigation Guide**.
2. Read the first line. The line shows how you are signed in, for example *You are signed in as: Council Officer (Grand Knight)*.
3. Read **In the top bar** in the open **Overview** block for the Messaging menu and your name menu.
4. Select a category title, for example **Calendars**, to open it. Select the title again to close it.
5. Select a link name to open that page.
6. Open **Your desks** to see your desk tabs. Officers and Admins also see every drawer of each desk.
7. Open **Your time limits** for your council's time windows and reminder days.
8. Open **Phone app tabs** for the phone tabs that your council has on.

Expected result: The page lists every link and desk that you can open, at the depth of your role. **Your time limits** shows your council's current numbers.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
A page that a colleague uses is not in your guide.	Your role cannot open the page.	Ask a council Admin about your role.
A whole module is missing from the guide.	Your council switched the module off (section 2 of the Super Admin System Manual).	Ask a Super Admin to switch the module on.

2. Governance

2.1 Run a live meeting

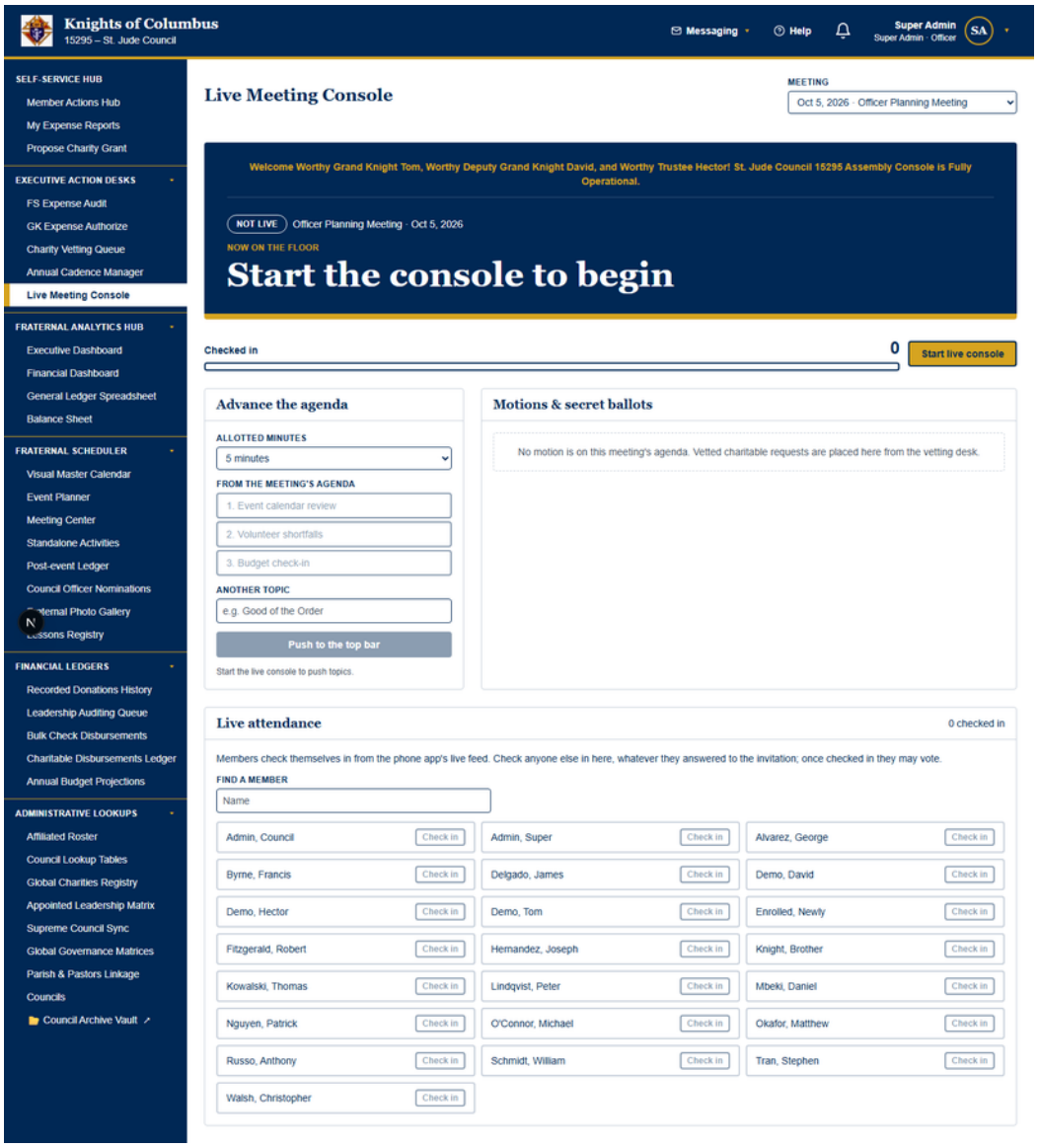
> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be a seated officer of the council, a council Admin, the meeting owner or a Super Admin. Other members do not see this desk.
>
> **Warning: Passed**, **Failed** and **Tabled** record the council's decision on the motion.

Goal: Chair a council meeting from one screen.

Start point: Sidebar → Governance → **Live Meeting Console**.

Steps:

1. Choose the meeting in **Meeting**.
2. Select **Start live console**.
3. Check in members in **Live attendance**. Use **Find a member** to search.
4. Select a line in **Order of Business** to put the line on the floor.
5. Set **Allotted minutes** for the topic.
6. For a motion, select **Launch secret smartphone ballot**. Members vote **Approve**, **Deny** or **Abstain** on their phones.
7. Select **Passed**, **Failed** or **Tabled**.
8. Select **Close the console** after the last item.



Live Meeting Console (/meetings/live)

Expected result: The top bar shows **Now on the floor** and the countdown. Phones that follow the agenda show the same line.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
"Start the console first"	The console is not live.	Select **Start live console**.
Passed is greyed out.	The smartphone ballot has no more Approve votes than Deny votes.	Select **Failed** or **Tabled**.
"No meeting from the past week on is yours to run."	No meeting is in range for you.	Schedule the meeting in the **Meeting Center**.

2.2 Record a hand tally

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be the council's Grand Knight, Deputy Grand Knight or Recorder, a council Admin or a Super Admin.
>
> **Warning: Save tally & decide the motion** decides the motion. A tie fails the motion.

Goal: Record a vote by raised hands.

Start point: Sidebar → Governance → **Live Meeting Console** → the motion → **Record Hand Tally**.

Steps:

1. Count the hands for the motion. Enter the count in **Approved hands**.
2. Count the hands against the motion. Enter the count in **Denied hands**.
3. Select **Save tally & decide the motion**.
4. Optional: for a passed motion that releases money, choose the posting in **General-ledger posting**. Select **Save link**.

Expected result: The motion shows **Passed** or **Failed**. A linked motion shows **Ledger linked**.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
"Type both counts; at least one hand."	A count is empty, or both counts are 0.	Enter both counts.
The hand tally is refused.	A smartphone ballot already opened on the motion.	Decide the motion from the ballot result.

2.3 Correct a live agenda line

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be the council's Grand Knight, Deputy Grand Knight or Recorder, a council Admin or a Super Admin.

Goal: Fix or add an agenda line during the meeting.

Start point: Sidebar → Governance → **Live Meeting Console** → **Order of Business**.

Steps:

1. Select the line. The line opens for editing.
2. Correct the text. Press Enter to save. Press Escape to cancel.
3. For a new topic, select **Blank last-minute line - click to write it**.

Expected result: The corrected line shows on the console and on members' phones.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
A line does not open for editing.	The DGK and other officers do not edit the agenda.	Ask the GK or the Recorder.

2.4 Lay down the year's meetings with a cadence

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be a council Admin, the Grand Knight, the Deputy Grand Knight or a Super Admin. Other members do not see this desk.
>
> **Warning: Populate the year** creates up to 12 meetings and their invitations.

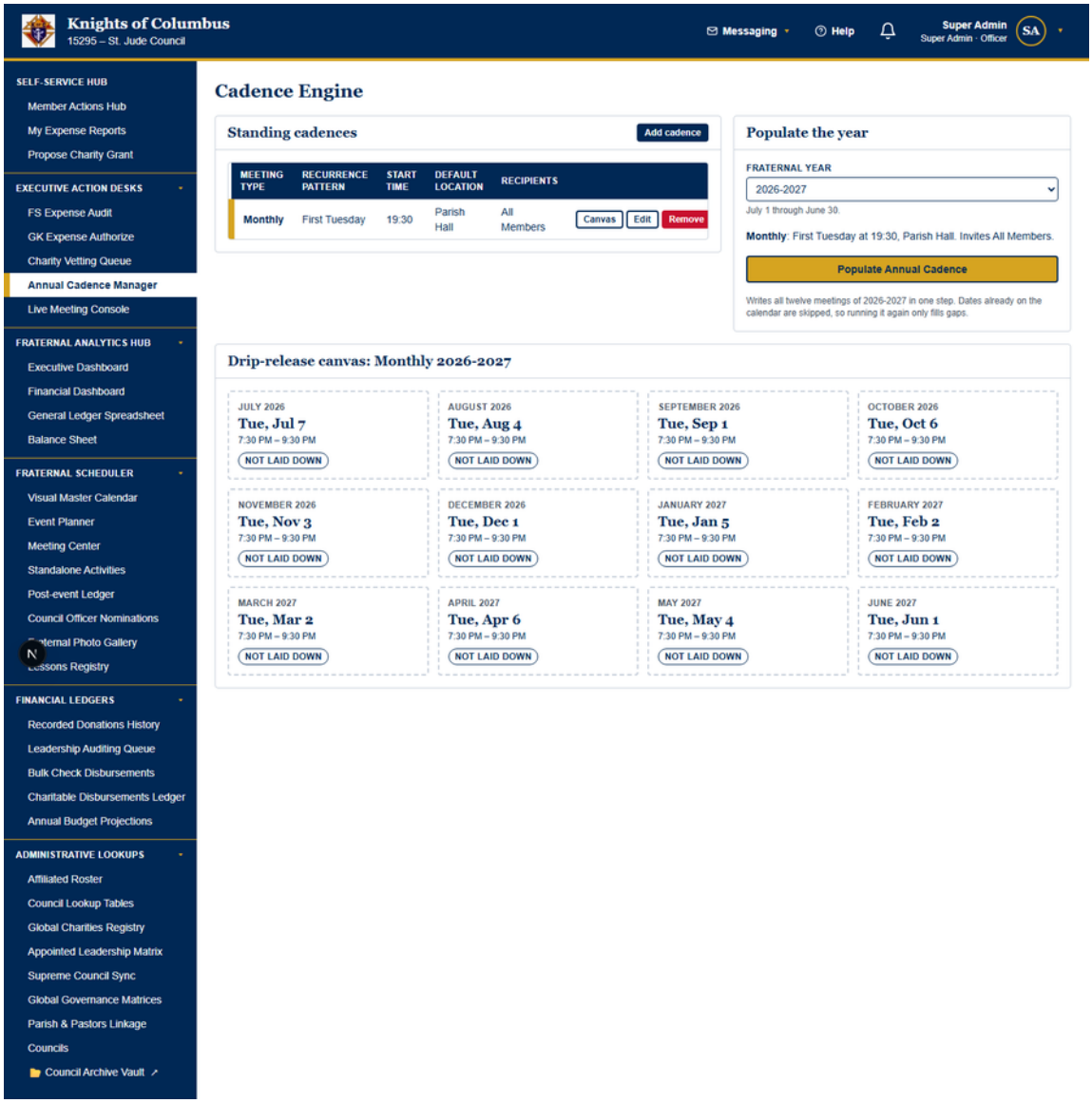
Goal: Create the fraternal year's regular meetings in one step.

Start point: Sidebar → Governance → **Recurring Meetings**.

Steps:

1. Select **Add cadence**.
2. Choose the **Meeting type**.
3. Set **Recurrence pattern: week** and **Recurrence pattern: day**, for example First and Tuesday.

4. Set **Start time**, **Default location** and **Default recipient group**.
5. Select **Save cadence**.
6. Choose the **Fraternal year**. Select **Populate the year**.
7. To see the year's dates, select **View Scheduled Releases** on the cadence row. A future date with no meeting yet shows **Scheduled**.
8. Read the badge on each card. The badge changes when the meeting's end time passes. A held meeting shows **Held**. A past date with no meeting shows **Past**.
9. To change one upcoming meeting, select **Customize Agenda & Location** on its card. Change **Location** or **Agenda**. Select **Save**. The cadence's default location does not change.



Recurring Meetings (/meetings/cadence)

Expected result: The platform creates one meeting per month, July through June. Each meeting lasts 120 minutes. Invitations are released 5 days before each meeting by default. A Super Admin sets the number of days for every council (section 4.2 of the Super Admin System Manual).

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
A month has no new meeting.	A meeting of the same type already exists on that date.	No action. The platform skips the date.
A card has no **Customize Agenda & Location** button.	The meeting is over, or the date has no meeting yet.	Populate the year first. A past meeting stays as recorded.

2.5 Schedule a single meeting

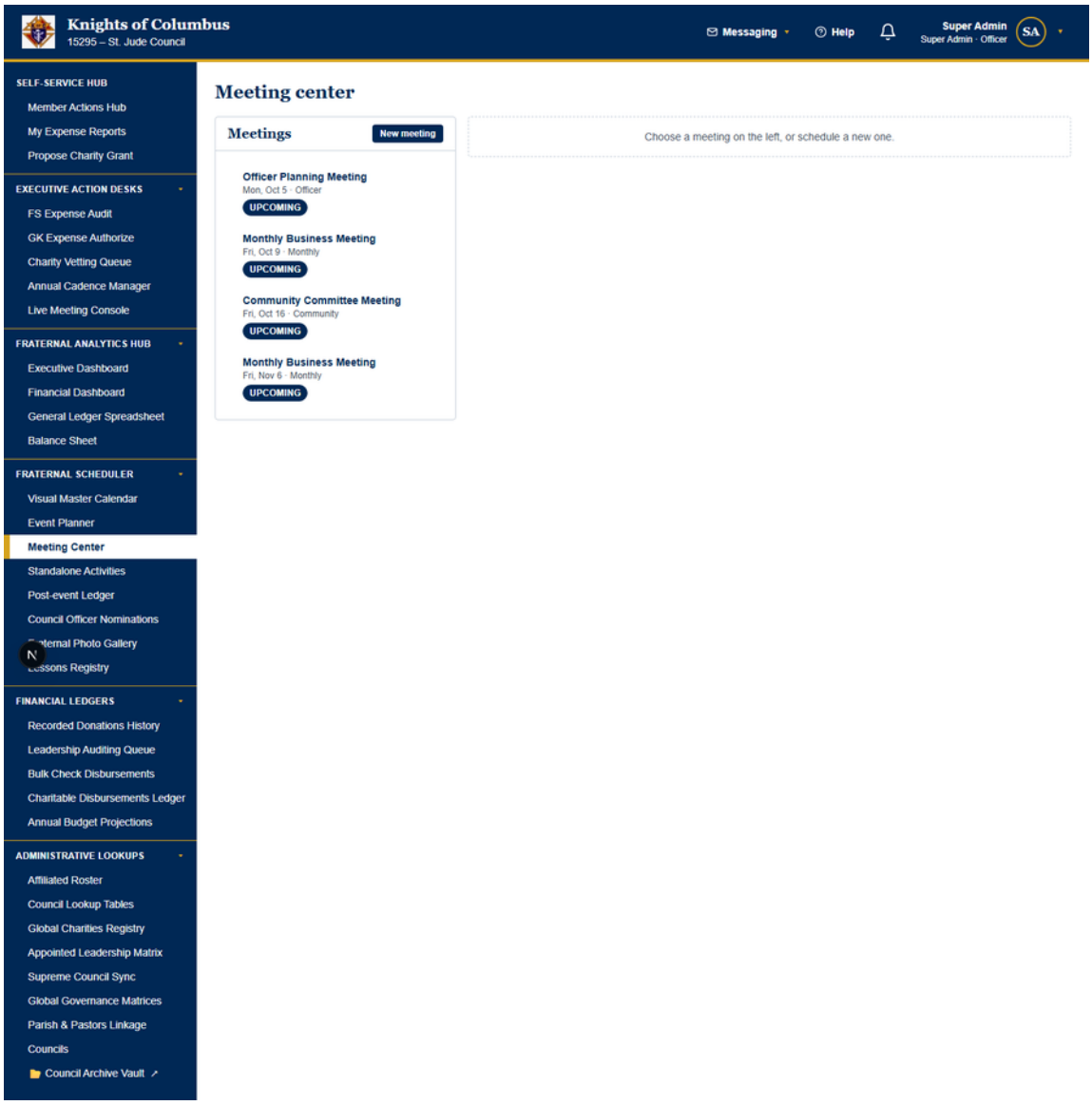
> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be a seated officer of the council, a council Admin or a Super Admin.
>
> **Warning: Schedule meeting** sends invitations at once.

Goal: Create one meeting and invite members.

Start point: Sidebar → Governance → **Meeting Center**.

Steps:

1. Select **New meeting**.
2. Fill in **Meeting name**, **Type**, **Date**, **Location**, **Starts** and **Ends**.
3. Check the **Agenda**. The **Type** fills the agenda from the council's template.
4. For a meeting over several days, tick **Multi-Day Assembly / Extended Event**. Set the **End date**.
5. Choose the invitees: **All active members**, **Officers only** or **Choose members…**.
6. Select **Schedule meeting**.
7. After the meeting, select **Upload minutes**. Tick each attendee. Save.



Meeting Center (/meetings)

Expected result: A message shows *"Meeting scheduled and invitations sent."*

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
New members are not invited.	The members joined after the meeting was scheduled.	Select **Invite all active members**.
A multi-day assembly adds no hours.	Multi-day assemblies add no meeting hours by design.	No action.

2.6 Keep the meeting agenda templates

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be a council Admin, the Grand Knight, the Deputy Grand Knight or a Super Admin.

Goal: Set the default agenda for one meeting type.

Start point: Sidebar → System Settings → **Council Lookup Tables** → **Meeting Agenda Templates**.

Steps:

1. Choose the **Meeting type**.
2. Write the outline in **Default agenda outline**.
3. Select **Save template**.
4. To remove a template, clear the text. Select **Save template**.

Expected result: A new meeting of the type starts with the outline.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
A meeting kept the old agenda.	The officer typed an agenda before choosing the type.	Select **Use the template** on the meeting form.

2.7 Manage nominations and appointments

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be an active member to nominate. You must be the Grand Knight, the Deputy Grand Knight or a Super Admin to appoint officers.

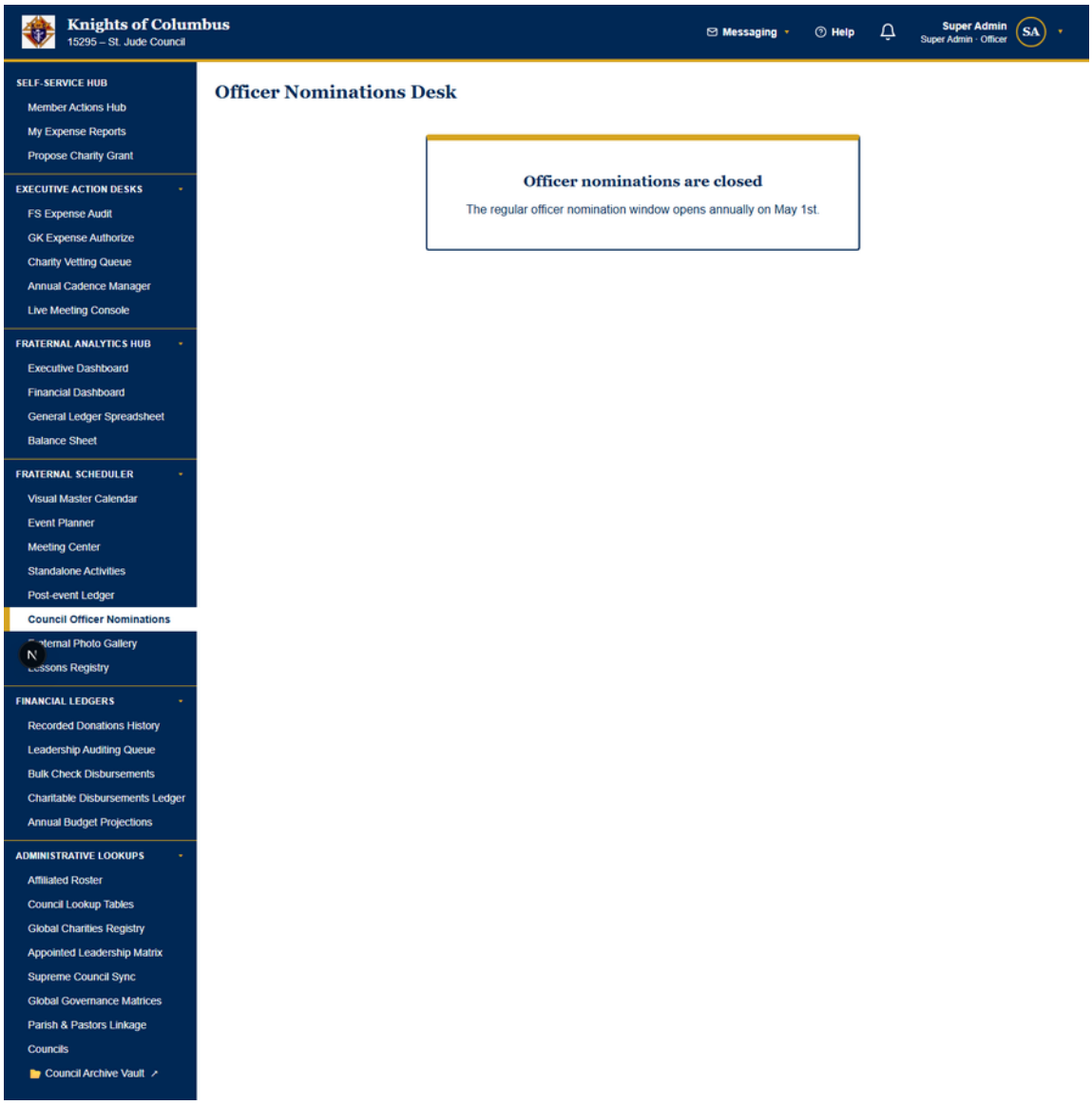
Goal: Fill the council's elected and appointed seats.

Start point: Sidebar → Governance → **Council Election Center** or **Appointed Leadership Matrix**.

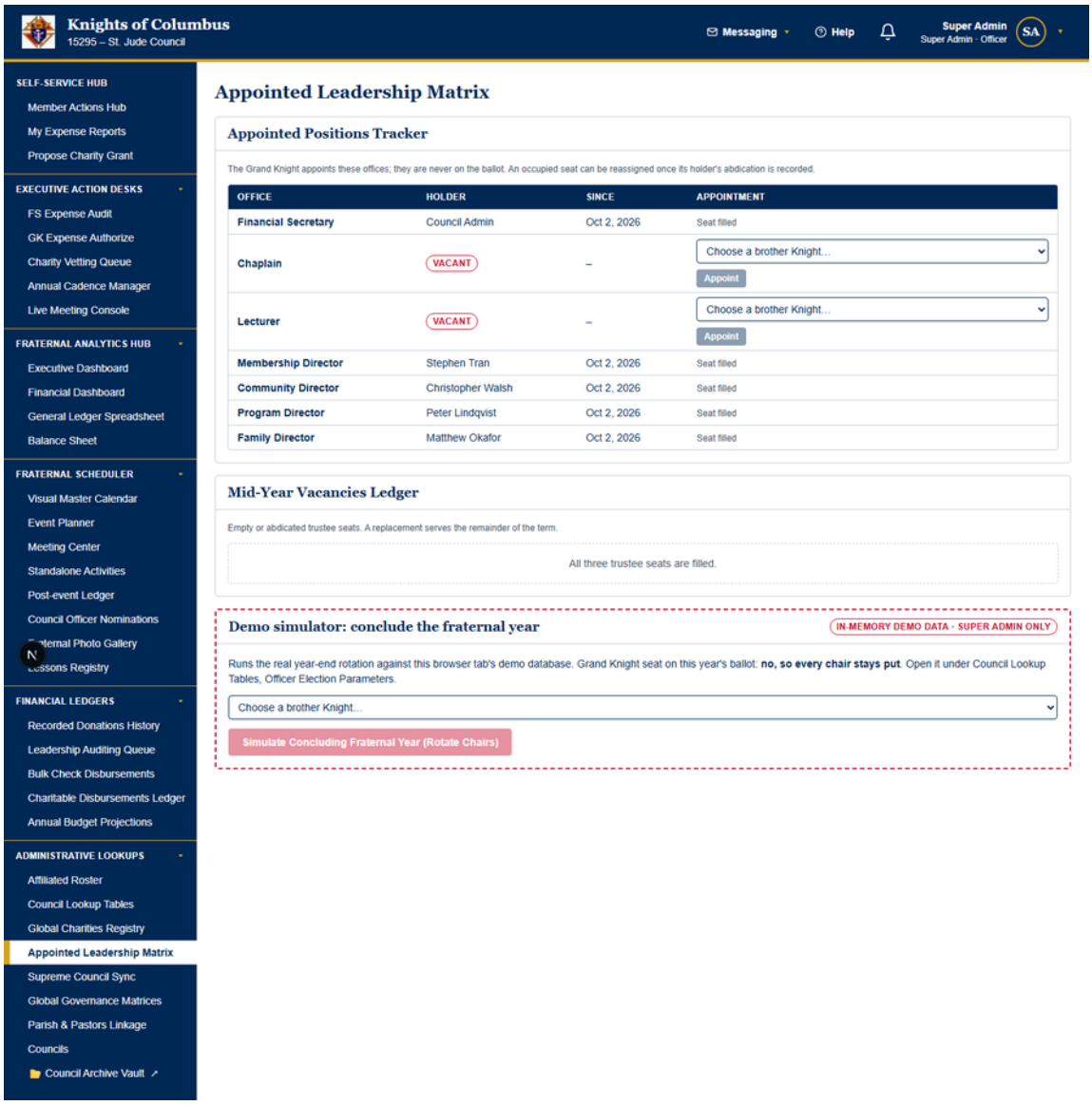
Steps:

1. Open **Council Election Center**. The election progress bar is at the top of the page. It always shows the current step.
2. Open the **Election Positions** drawer to see each elected office, its officer and its ballot status. All drawers are closed when the page opens.
3. Open the **Candidate Nominations** drawer to nominate a Brother Knight for office.
4. Open **Appointed Leadership Matrix** to fill an appointed seat.
5. Choose the member for each vacant seat. Save.

At a live meeting, members vote in the **Cast Active Ballot** drawer. Each member types the meeting PIN to check in, then votes by secret ballot on the motion that the chair opened (section 5.7 of the Member User Guide).



Nominations and elections (/elections)



Appointed positions (/elections/appointments)

Expected result: The seat shows the member's name.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
Both pages are missing.	The council switched off **Officer elections**.	Ask a Super Admin (section 2 of the Super Admin System Manual).

2.8 Concept: the Council Bylaws Data Vault

The vault holds one bylaws document per council. Every member of the council reads the bylaws.

- The vault stores the bylaws as text in the `Council.BylawsMarkdown` column. The limit is 100,000 characters.
- The vault also stores the save time in `BylawsUpdatedAt`.
- A line that starts with `#` starts an article. A line that starts with `##` starts a section.
- The vault splits the text into clauses. The clause id `A2.S3` means article 2, section 3. The id `A0` holds text before the first article.

- The **AI Parliamentary Reasoning Stream** panel lists every clause with its id, heading and word count. Select **?** on the panel for a tip. The AI cites a clause by its id, so keep one topic in each section.
- The parliamentary engines read the same clauses. A motion or a ruling cites a clause by the clause id.

2.9 Edit the council bylaws

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be the council's Grand Knight or Deputy Grand Knight, a council Admin or a Super Admin. Other members see no **Edit bylaws** button.
>
> **Warning: Save bylaws** replaces the stored text for every member. The vault keeps no earlier version.

Goal: Change the council bylaws.

Start point: Sidebar → Governance → **Constitutional Bylaws**.

Steps:

1. Copy the current text to a file as a backup.
2. Select **Edit bylaws**. An empty vault starts from the standard Knights of Columbus council bylaws template. The empty vault also shows the template as a preview. Replace each bracketed field, for example **[Council Name]**.
3. Change the text in **Bylaws text**.
4. Check the **Preview** panel. The panel scrolls inside a fixed height of 500 pixels, so **Save bylaws** and **Cancel** stay on the screen.
5. Check the clause ids in **AI Parliamentary Reasoning Stream**.
6. Select **Save bylaws**.

Expected result: A message shows *"The bylaws are saved."*

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
A section has no clause id.	The heading has no ## at the start.	Add ## and a space at the start of the line.
The text stops at the limit.	The text has 100,000 characters.	Shorten the text.

The SOP Center holds the same procedure: **Answers → SOP Center → Edit the council bylaws**.

3. Faith In Action

3.1 Create an event

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must have council Admin privileges for the council, or Super Admin privileges.

Goal: Create an event that volunteers can sign up for.

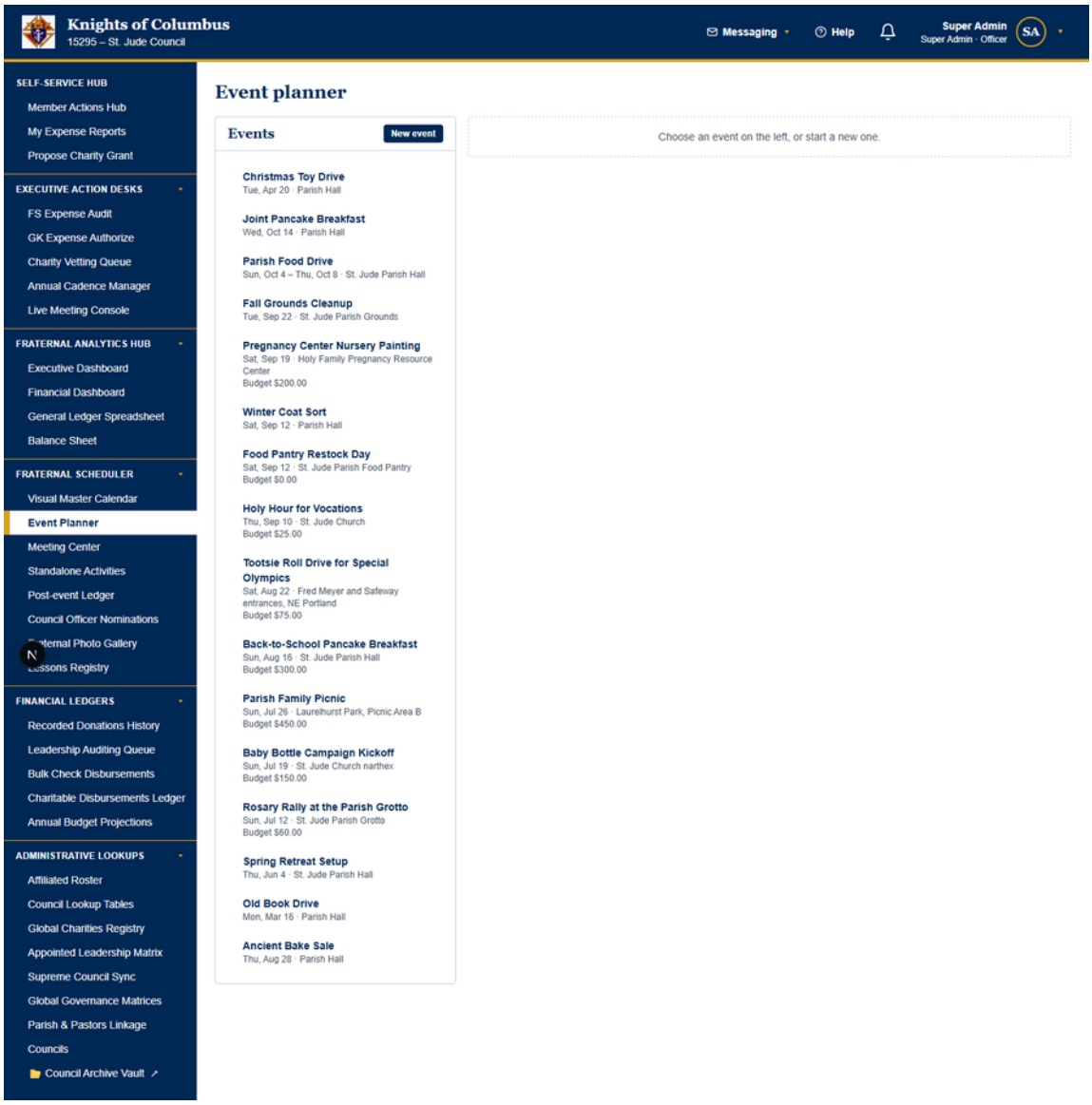
Start point: Sidebar → Faith In Action → **Event Planner**.

Steps:

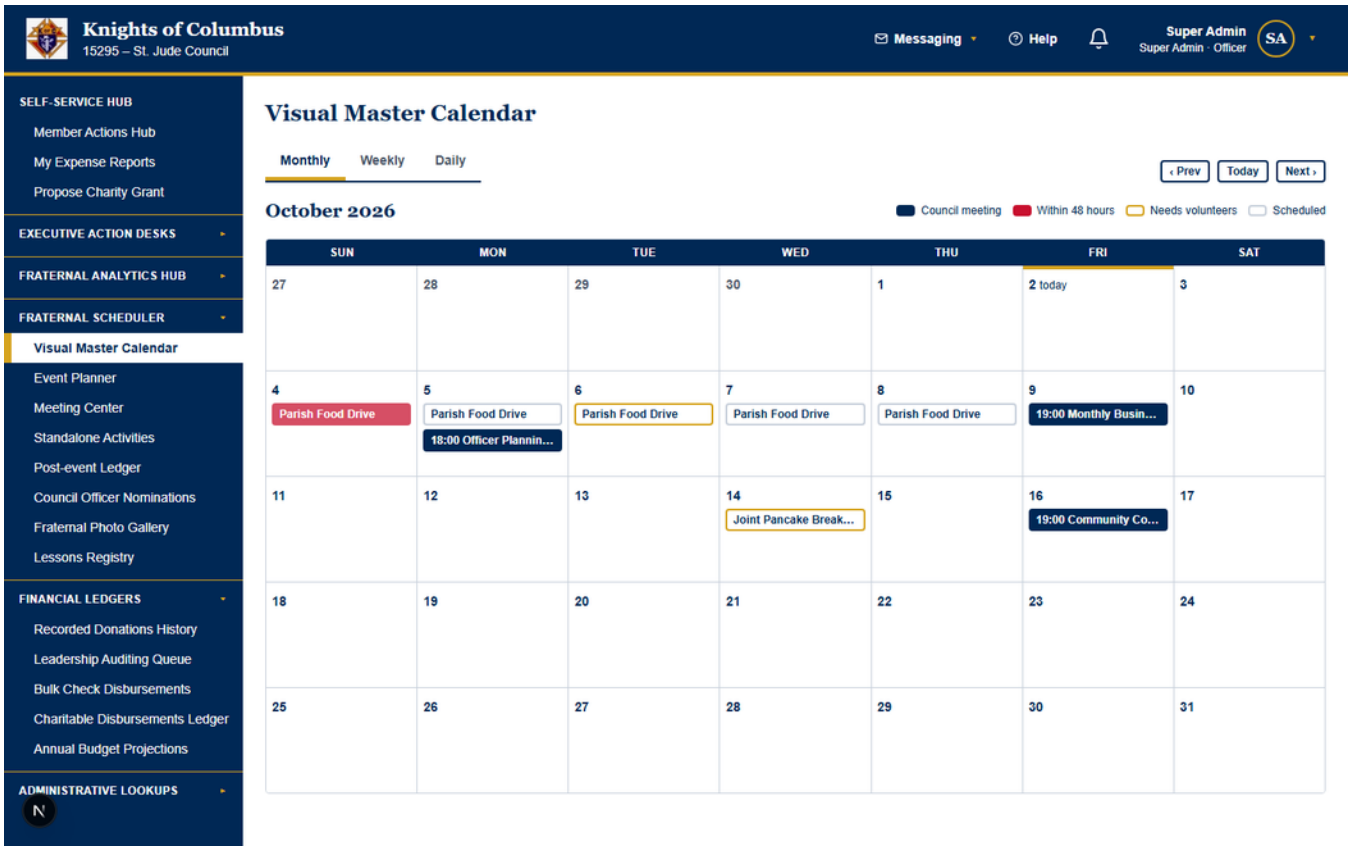
1. Select **New event**.
2. Fill in **Event name**, **Description**, **Starts**, **Ends** and **Location**.
3. Choose the **Category** and the **Owner**.
4. Optional: enter **Budget ($)** and **Planned attendees**.
5. Tick each council in **Councils sharing this event**.
6. Tick **Is Annual** for an event that repeats each year (see section 2.10 of the Treasurer Manual).
7. Select **Create event**. The **Confirm the Form 1728 line** window opens.
8. Read the **Best guess**. The system reads it from the event name and the category.
9. Do one of these:

- To keep the best guess, select **Confirm line and save**.
- To use a different line, choose it under **Suggested lines**, or type a word in **Or choose any line** and choose it from the list. Then select **Confirm line and save**.

> **Note:** the window opens again when you change the event name. To change only the line, select **Change Form 1728 line** under the event name.



Event Planner split screen (/events)



Council calendar (/calendar)

Expected result: A message shows *"Event created. Add its shifts below."*

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The date is refused.	**Ends** is before **Starts**.	Correct the dates.
The save is refused.	No council is ticked.	Tick at least one council.
The window shows *"No suggestion is at least 60% sure"*.	The event name does not name a Form 1728 program clearly enough. The cutoff is the **Form 1728 suggestion confidence cutoff** on **Global System Parameters**.	Choose the correct line in the list. The Form 1728 report uses the line that you confirm.
The window shows fewer than three suggestion cards.	Only the lines at least 60% sure show as cards.	Choose a card, or choose any line in the list.
You select **Cancel** in the Form 1728 window.	The event is not saved.	Select **Create event** again and confirm a line.

3.2 Add shifts to an event

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must have council Admin privileges for the council, or Super Admin privileges.
>
> **Warning:** a shift with sign-ups or logged hours cannot be deleted.

Goal: Give the event the time slots that volunteers fill.

Start point: Sidebar → Faith In Action → **Event Planner** → the event → **Shifts** panel.

Steps:

1. Enter the **Shift name**.
2. Enter a **Date** inside the event dates.
3. Enter the start time and the end time.
4. Enter **Volunteers needed**.
5. Select **Add shift**.
6. Repeat steps 1 to 5 for each day and time slot.



Expected result: The shift shows in the grid with a status pill.

Pill	Meaning
Full (navy)	The shift has its volunteers. Extra members may join as honorary volunteers.
Needs *n* soon (red)	The shift starts within 48 hours and needs volunteers.
Needs *n* (gold)	Nobody has signed up, or the shift starts within 7 days.
Needs *n* (outline)	The shift has time to fill.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The shift date is refused.	The date is outside the event dates.	Change the shift date or the event dates.
Delete is refused.	Members signed up or logged hours.	Keep the shift.

3.3 Copy an event as a twin

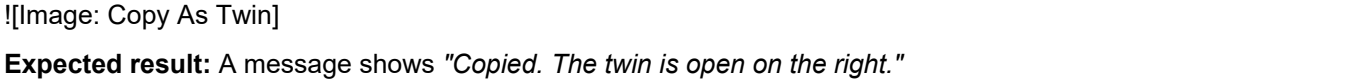
> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must have council Admin privileges for the council, or Super Admin privileges.

Goal: Repeat a past event with the same shift pattern.

Start point: Sidebar → Faith In Action → **Event Planner** → the past event → **Copy as a twin**.

Steps:

1. Check **New event name**. Change the name if needed.
2. Set **New first day**.
3. Select **Copy event**.
4. Check every shift of the twin.



Expected result: A message shows *"Copied. The twin is open on the right."*

Copied	Not copied
Details, councils, owner, budget, the **Is Annual** tag	Sign-ups and logged hours
Every shift, moved by the same number of days	Post-event results and lessons

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
A shift is on the wrong weekday.	The new first day is on a different weekday.	Pick a first day on the same weekday.

3.4 Keep the council activities

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must have council Admin privileges for the council, or Super Admin privileges.

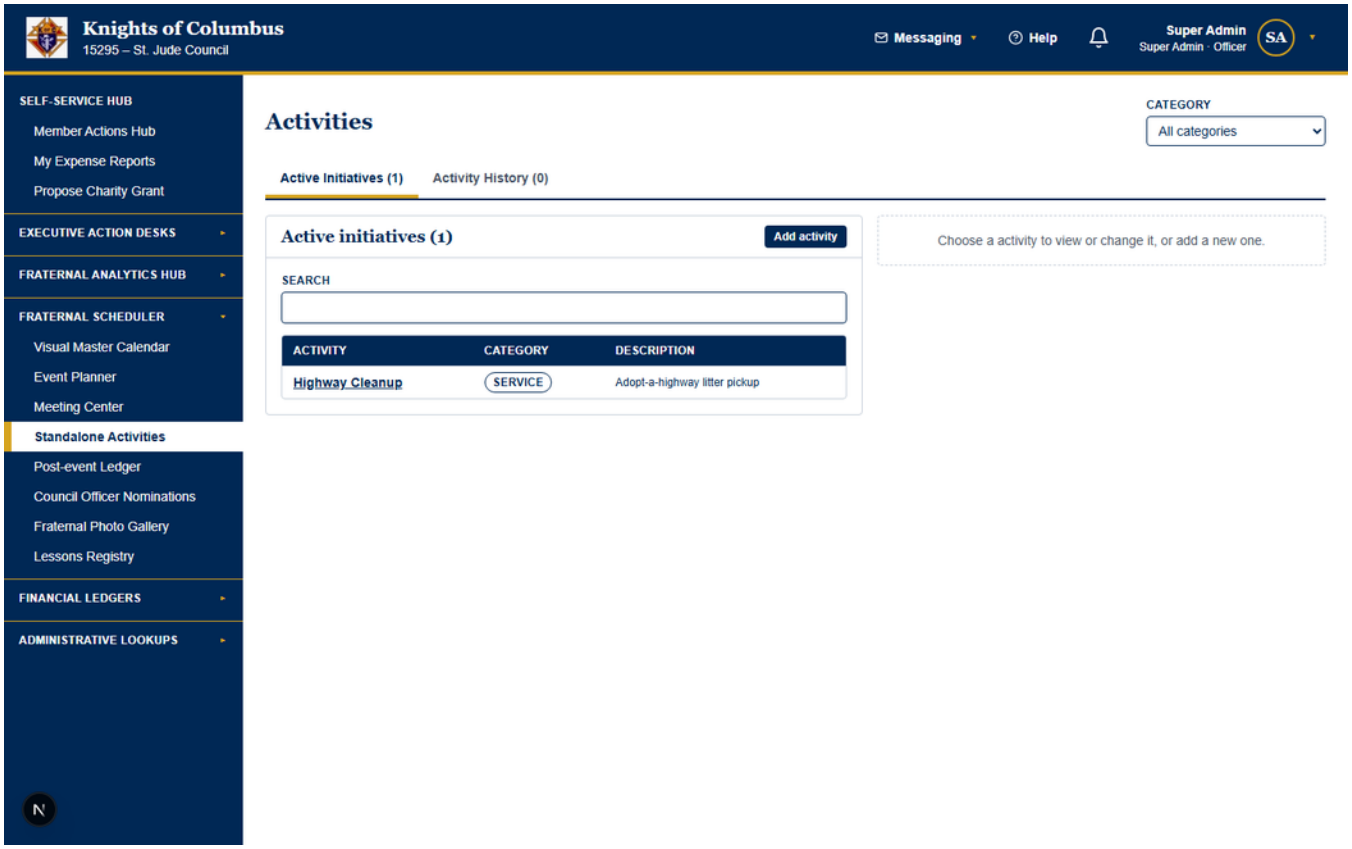
Goal: Keep the list of ongoing activities that members log time against.

Start point: Sidebar → Faith In Action → **Member Activities** → the **Current Activities** tab.

Steps:

1. Add an activity with a name, a description and a category.
2. Save. The **Confirm the Form 1728 line** window opens.
3. Read the **Best guess**. To keep it, select **Confirm line and save**.
4. To use a different line, choose it under **Suggested lines** or in **Or choose any line**. Then select **Confirm line and save**.

> **Note:** the window opens again when you rename the activity. To change only the line, select **Change line** in the **Form 1728** column. The same window opens when you add or rename an activity in **Admin Desk** → **Council Lookup Tables** → **Activities**.



Activities catalog (/activities)

Expected result: The activity shows as a tile on the phone **Report** tab.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
A sister council does not see the activity.	Activities belong to one council.	Add the activity in each council.
The message *"Not saved. Confirm a Form 1728 line to save the activity."* shows.	You selected **Cancel** in the Form 1728 window.	Save again and confirm a line.

3.5 Print the Form 1728 year-to-date report

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must have council Admin privileges for the council, or Super Admin privileges. The panel shows only for a Knights of Columbus council.

Goal: Print or export the activity hours from January 1 to today, by Form 1728 line.

Start point: Sidebar → Faith In Action → **Member Activities** → the **Form 1728 year to date** panel.

Steps:

1. Read the table. Each section (Faith, Family, Community, Life) ends with a subtotal row. The last row is the total.
2. To print, select **Print**. A print-ready page opens with every line of the form. Lines with no hours show 0.
3. To keep a spreadsheet copy, select **Export CSV**. The file name starts with `form-1728-`.

Expected result: The printer prints the report, or the CSV file is in your downloads folder.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
Print and **Export CSV** do not show.	No activity hours are logged since January 1.	Log hours first. The buttons show when the panel has hours.
The print page does not open.	The browser blocked the new window.	Allow pop-ups for the portal. Select **Print** again.
Event shift hours are not in the panel.	The panel totals activity hours only.	Use **Supreme Council Sync** for the full report with event hours.

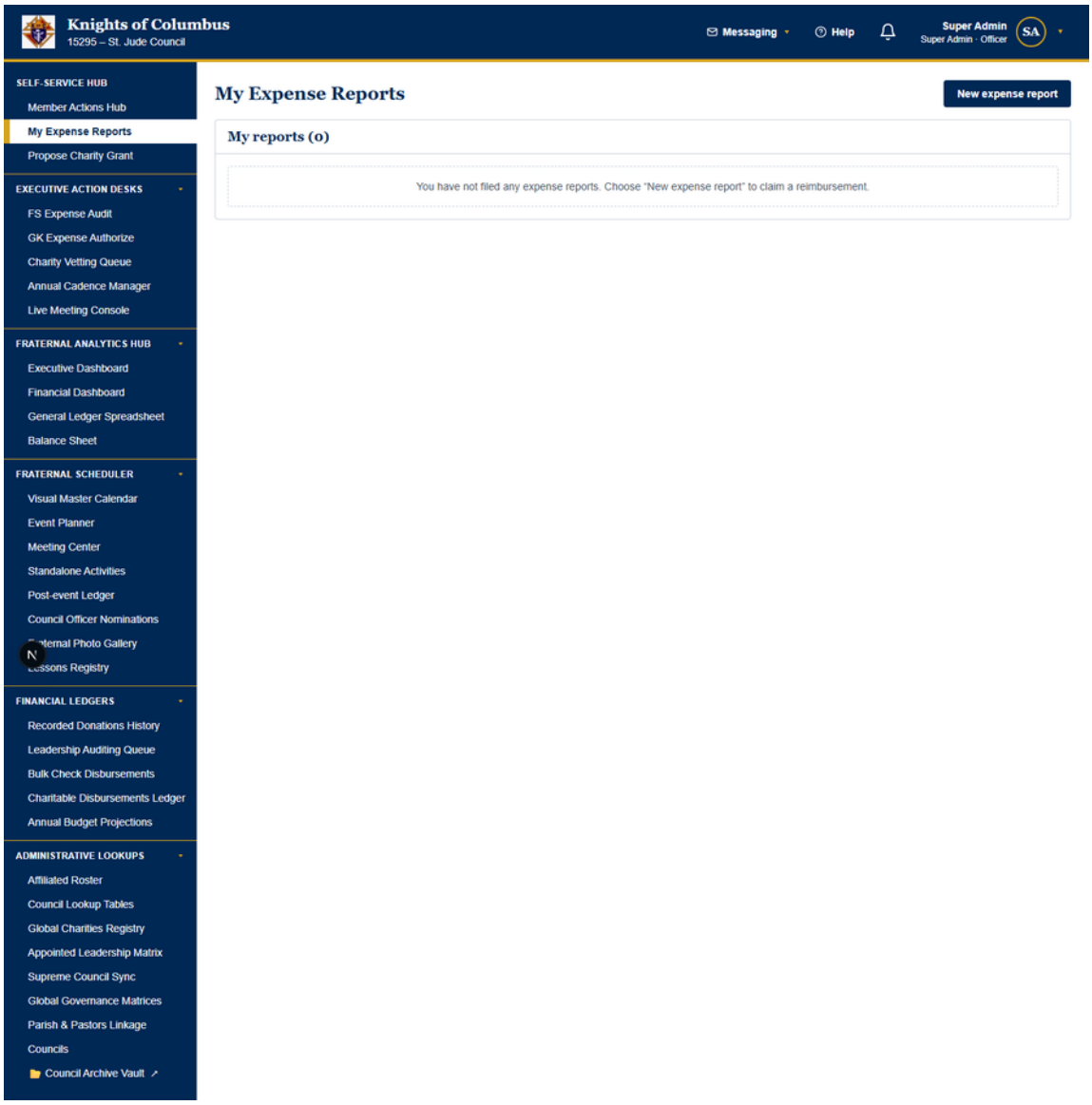
---

4. Finances: release, vetting and endorsement

4.1 Concept: the two-signature expense path

Step	Who acts	Where	Status tag
1. File	The member	**My Expense Reports**	**Submitted**
2. Payment request	The Financial Secretary	**FS Expense Audit Queue → Verify & Sign Expense**	**RECORDED BY FS**
3. Categorize	The Treasurer	**Treasurer Ledger Audit → Categorize & Lock Expense**	**CODED BY TREASURER**
4. Final release	The Grand Knight	**GK Expense Authorize → Final Release for Payment**	**Approved**
5. Pay	The FS or the Treasurer	**Disbursed Check Registry**	**Reimbursed**
Return	Council leadership	**Leadership Auditing Queue → Reject & Return**	**Returned**

- A Super Admin may sign either line, but never both lines of the same report.
- Each signer chooses the budget line in **Assign Ledger Budget Line Item**. The report saves the line.
- The budget counts the report only against the saved line.
- The Treasurer chooses the ledger account before the Grand Knight signs. The account decides the budget line. A green line on the **Treasurer Ledger Audit** names the line, for example **Inferred Budget: Automatically Mapped to Monthly Council Meetings**. **Categorize & Lock Expense** locks the account and the line.
- The officer who issued the order sees a **Collusion Guard** tag. That officer sees no **Final Release for Payment** button.
- Council Admins open both desks to follow the work. Only the seat holders or a Super Admin sign.
- A signer sees no button on a report the signer cannot sign. A tag tells who signs the report.
- A return clears both signatures and the saved budget line.



My Expense Reports (/expenses)

4.2 Give the final release for payment

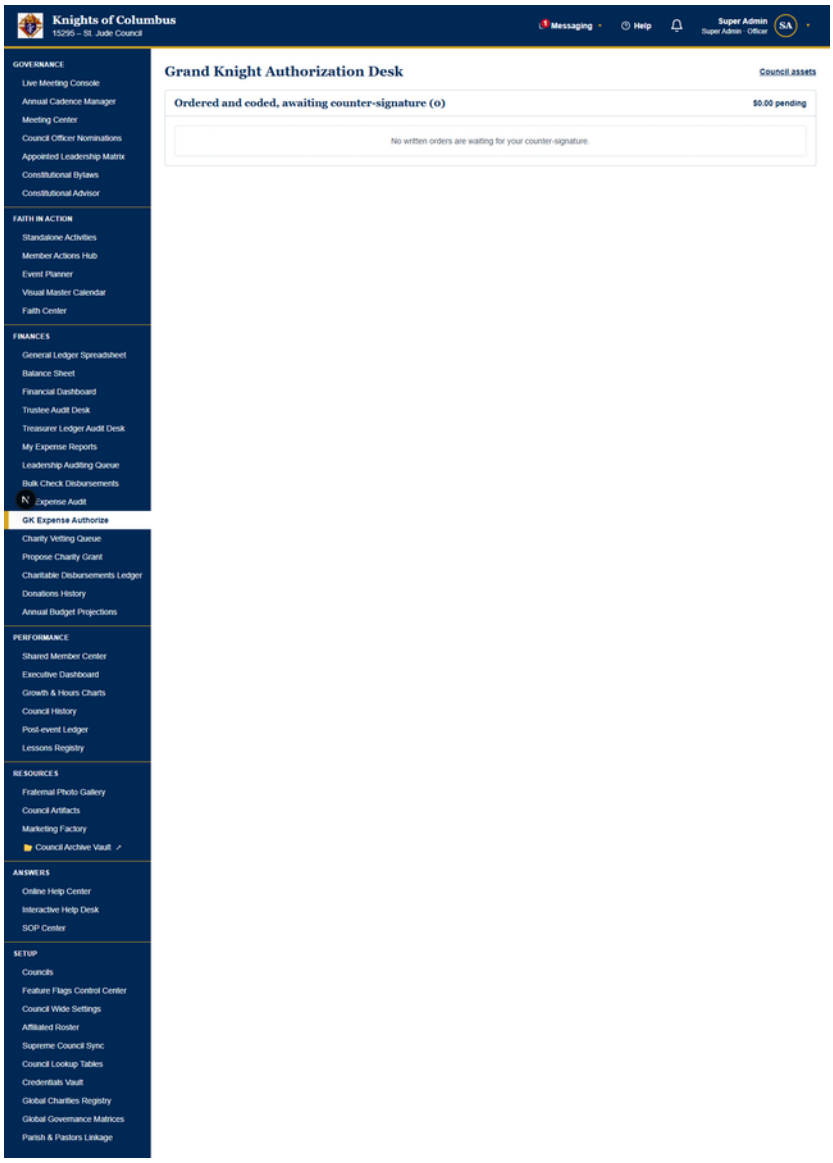
> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be the council's Grand Knight or Deputy Grand Knight, or a Super Admin. Council Admins read the desk only.
>
> **Warning:** the final release approves the report for payment.

Goal: Give the second signature, which releases the report for payment.

Start point: Sidebar → Finances → **FINANCIAL ACTIONS** → **GK Expense Authorize**.

Steps:

1. Open the ordered report.
2. Check the order and the receipts.
3. Check the line in **Assign Ledger Budget Line Item**. The line starts on the Treasurer's choice.
4. Select **Final Release for Payment**.



GK Authorization Desk (/expenses/authorize)

Expected result: The member sees **Approved**. The report shows in **Disbursed Check Registry**.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
Collusion Guard shows.	You issued the payment request.	Another signer must give the final release.

4.3 Vet a charity request

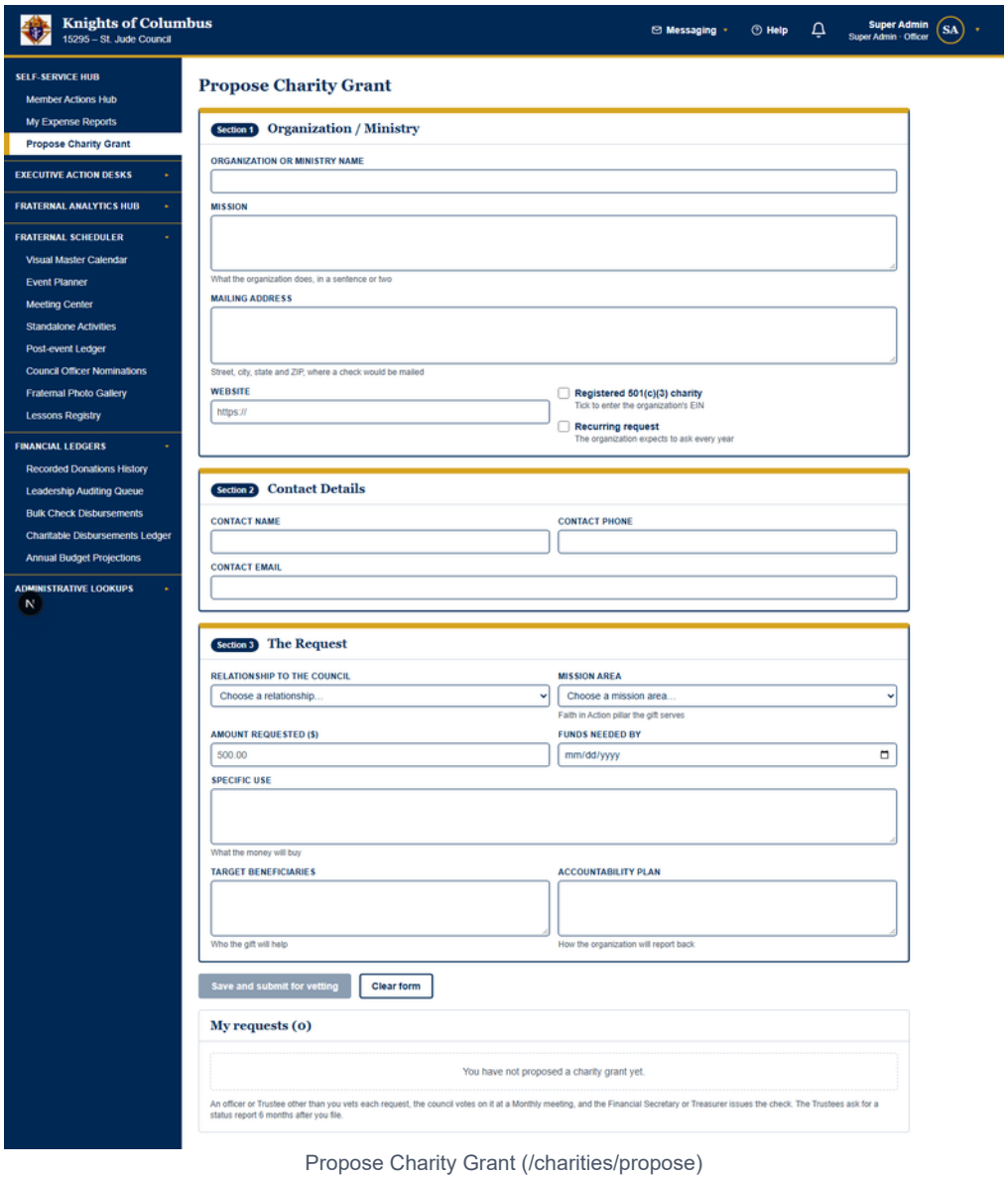
> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be a seated officer, a Trustee or an Admin of the council, or a Super Admin. The Knight Shepherd never vets the Shepherd's own request.
>
> **Warning:** a decline stops the request.

Goal: Review a member's charity request and move the request forward.

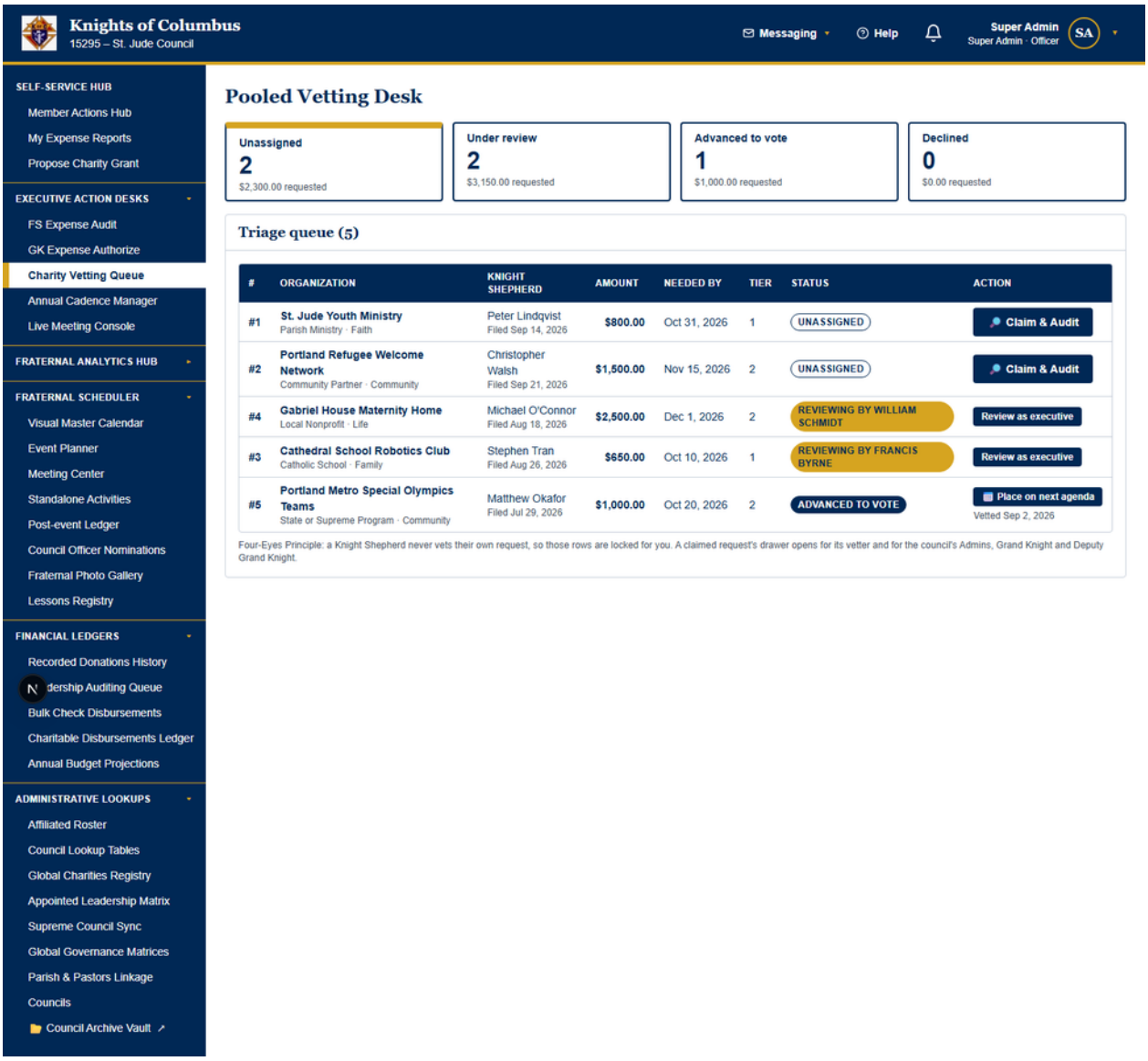
Start point: Active Desks → Grand Knight Desk → Charitable Grant Requests Vetting Board folder. Other vetting officers use Sidebar → Governance → **Charity Vetting Queue**.

Steps:

1. Claim the request.
2. Check the organization, the 501(c)(3) status and the amount.
3. Advance the request, or decline the request.
4. For an advanced request, select **Place on next agenda**.



Propose Charity Grant (/charities/propose)



Charity Vetting Queue (/charities/vetting)

Expected result: The request goes on a Monthly meeting at least 10 days away. The council votes in the **Live Meeting Console**.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
Place on next agenda is refused.	No Monthly meeting is at least 10 days away.	Schedule the meeting.
The desk is missing.	The council switched off **Charity proposals**.	Ask a Super Admin.

4.3.1 Endorse an approved charity grant for payment

> **Who can do this:** the council's Financial Secretary (FS), Grand Knight (GK) or Deputy Grand Knight (DGK), or a Super Admin. The Knight Shepherd of the request cannot endorse it.
>
> **Warning:** you cannot undo an endorsement. The officer who endorses a request cannot also write its check.

Goal: Clear a grant that the council approved for its check. This is the **FS/GK Compliance Endorsement** step.

Start point: Active Desks → Financial Secretary Desk or **Grand Knight Desk → FS/GK Compliance Endorsements**. Or (Financial Secretary): Sidebar → Finances → **FINANCIAL ACTIONS → Charitable Grants Registry** → the **FS/GK Compliance Endorsements** tab.

Steps:

1. Select the **FS/GK Compliance Endorsements** folder. A red border means that an approved request waits for your endorsement. The folder then moves to the top of the spine.
2. Find the request under **FS/GK Compliance Endorsement**.
3. Check the organization and the approved amount.
4. Select **Endorse for payment**. You cannot undo the endorsement.

Expected result: The request moves to **Treasurer Check Settlement**. The Treasurer sees it in the **Charitable Grants Registry** with its endorsement date.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The request shows "You shepherd this request".	You are the Knight Shepherd of the request.	Ask another FS, GK or DGK to endorse it.
The endorse button does not show.	You are not the FS, GK or DGK of this council.	Ask one of these officers to endorse it.
The request is not in the endorsement step.	The council has not passed the motion yet.	Wait for the vote (section 4.3).

5. Performance

5.1 Read the executive dashboard

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be a seated officer or an Admin of the council, or a Super Admin. Only Admins and Super Admins see the audits.

Goal: Review one month of council activity.

Start point: Sidebar → Performance → **Executive Dashboard**. The **Executive Summary** page opens.

Steps:

1. Choose the **Month** and the **Year**.
2. Read the four scorecard tiles.
3. Read the **Budget tracking** gauges.
4. Admins: read **Executive audits** for no-shows and shifts that need hours.



Executive Dashboard Summaries (/executive-dashboard)

![Image: Executive Audits]

Expected result: The tiles show four measures.

Tile	Measures
Total labor hours	Shift hours plus activity hours in the month
Unique Knights participating	Members who logged any time in the month
Net balance	Funds raised minus the month's approved expenses and charity checks
Community outreach	Actual attendees at the month's events

A budget gauge turns gold at 85% of the cap. The gauge turns red past 100%.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The hours look low.	Members log hours up to 90 days later, by default (section 11.2).	Check the month again later.
The gauges show no caps.	The budget is not approved.	Approve the budget (section 2.11 of the Treasurer Manual).

5.2 Read the growth and hours charts

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be a seated officer or an Admin of the council, or a Super Admin.

Goal: See membership growth and labor hours over 12 months.

Start point: Sidebar → Performance → **Growth & Hours Charts**.

Steps:

1. Read the new-members chart. The chart counts active members by join month.
2. Read the labor-hours chart.

Expected result: Each chart shows one bar per month.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
A new member is missing.	The member has no join date.	Run the Supreme roster sync (section 2.3 of the Financial Secretary Manual).

5.3 Record an event's results

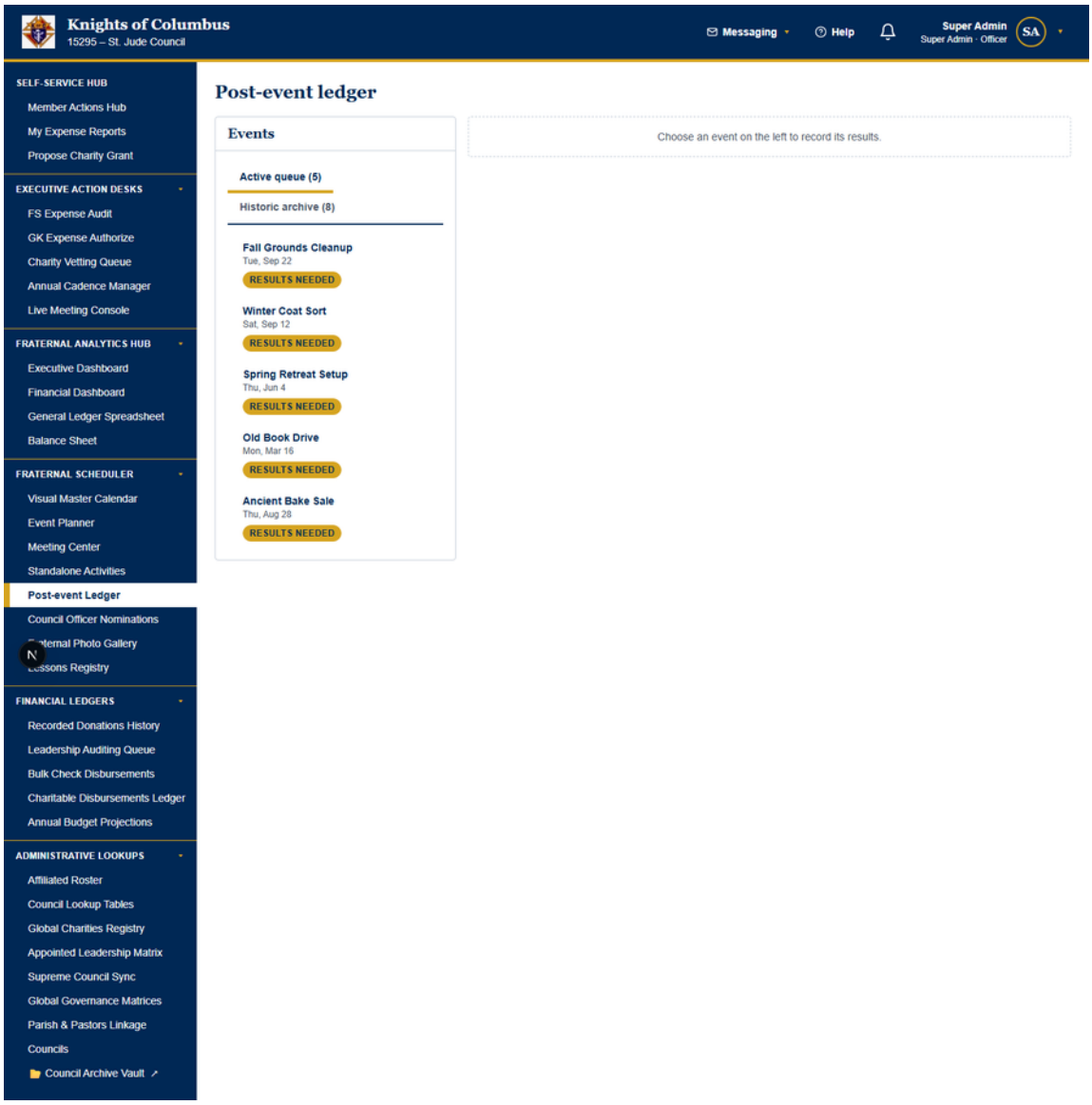
> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be the event owner, an elected officer or Admin of a council linked to the event, or a Super Admin. Other members do not see the event on the ledger.

Goal: Close out an event with attendance, funds and lessons.

Start point: Sidebar → Performance → **Post-event Ledger** → **Active queue**.

Steps:

1. Choose the event with **Results needed**.
2. Enter **Actual attendees**. The event's costs come from the expense reports linked to it, not from this page.
3. Enter **Cash raised ($)** and **Electronic raised ($)** if the fields are open.
4. Write **Highlights** for the monthly summary.
5. Select **Save results**.
6. Add lessons: choose a **Category**. Write **What did we learn?**. Select **Add lesson**.



Post-event Ledger (/ledger)

Expected result: A message shows *"Results saved."* The event moves to **Historic archive**.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The cash fields show **Synced from donations**.	Donations drive the totals.	Correct the donations (section 1.9 of the Financial Secretary Manual).

5.4 Mark or clear a no-show

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be an Admin of a council linked to the event, or a Super Admin.
>
> **Warning:** a no-show shows in the member's history and in the executive audits.

Goal: Record that a volunteer missed a shift.

Start point: Sidebar → Performance → **Post-event Ledger** → the event → **Fraternal Volunteer Turnout Summary**.

Steps:

1. Select **Mark no-show** on the volunteer's row.
2. Choose the reason.
3. Select **Confirm**.
4. To remove a mistake, select **Clear** on the row.

Expected result: The row shows a red edge and a **No-show** pill.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
Mark no-show is missing.	The volunteer logged hours, or the event is not linked to your council.	Correct the hours first.

5.5 Search the lessons registry

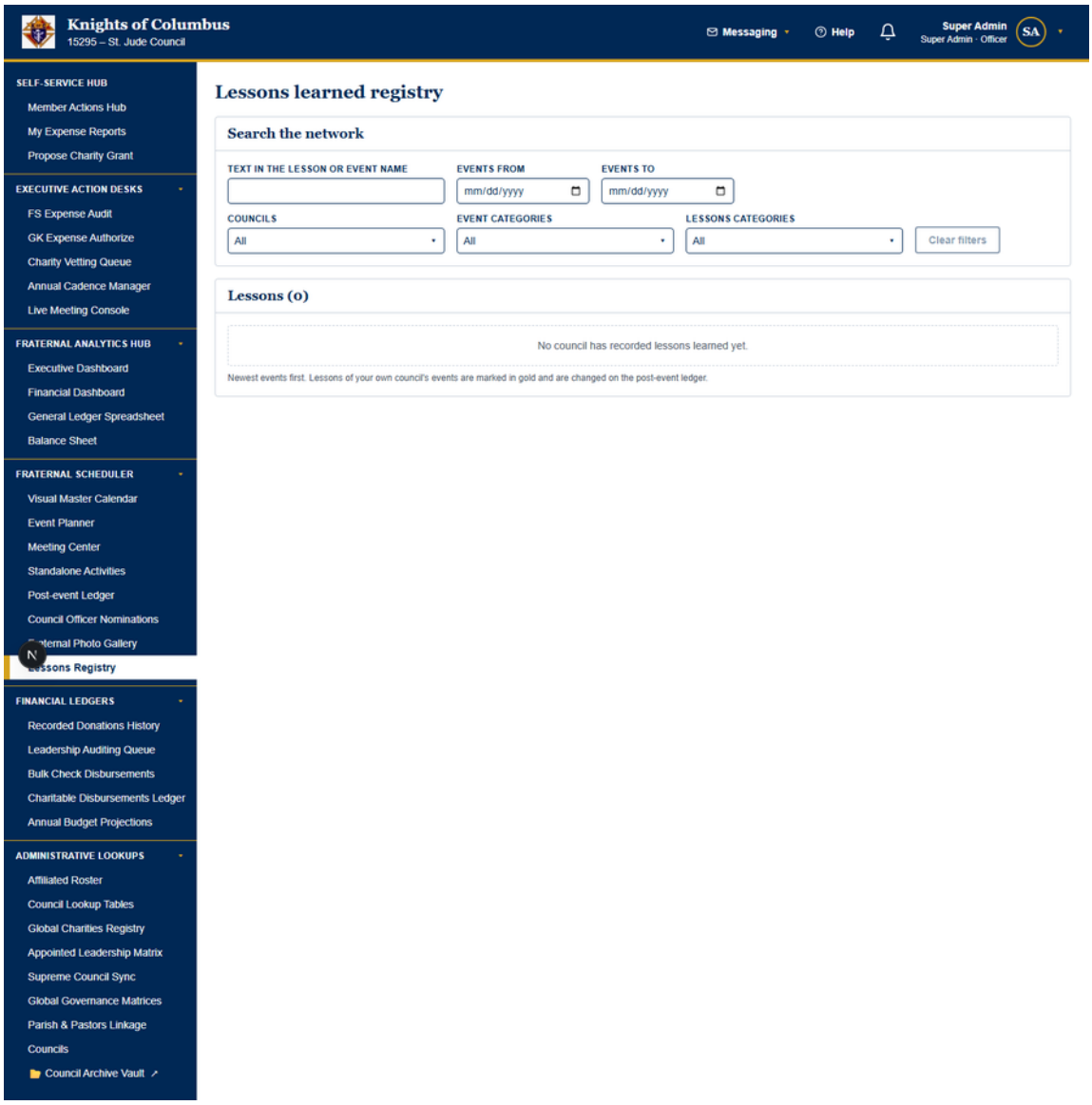
> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must have council Admin privileges for the council, or Super Admin privileges.

Goal: Learn from other councils' events.

Start point: Sidebar → Performance → **Lessons Registry**.

Steps:

1. Filter by text, dates, councils or categories.
2. Read the lessons. Your council's lessons show in gold.



Lessons Registry (/lessons-registry)

Expected result: The newest events show first.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
You cannot edit a lesson here.	The registry is read only.	Edit the lesson on the **Post-event Ledger**.

6. Resources

6.1 Open the Council Archive Vault folder

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be a seated officer, a council Admin or a Super Admin. Members do not see the link.

Goal: Open the council's shared Google Drive folder.

Start point: Sidebar → Resources → **Council Archive Vault**.

Steps:

1. Select **Council Archive Vault**.

Expected result: The Drive folder opens in a new browser tab.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
Google Drive refuses access.	Drive sharing settings decide who opens the folder.	Ask the folder owner to share the folder with you.

6.2 Share photos and council artifacts

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be a signed-in member to read both pages. You must be an Admin or a Super Admin to upload to the gallery vault.

Goal: Publish event photos, flyers and minutes for the council.

Start point: Active Desks → Historian Desk → Google Drive Media Gallery Sync Board folder, or Sidebar → Resources → **Council Artifacts**.

Steps:

1. In the gallery, choose the **Event**.
2. Drag photos onto **Drag and drop photos here**.
3. In **Council Artifacts**, filter the cards with **Show**.

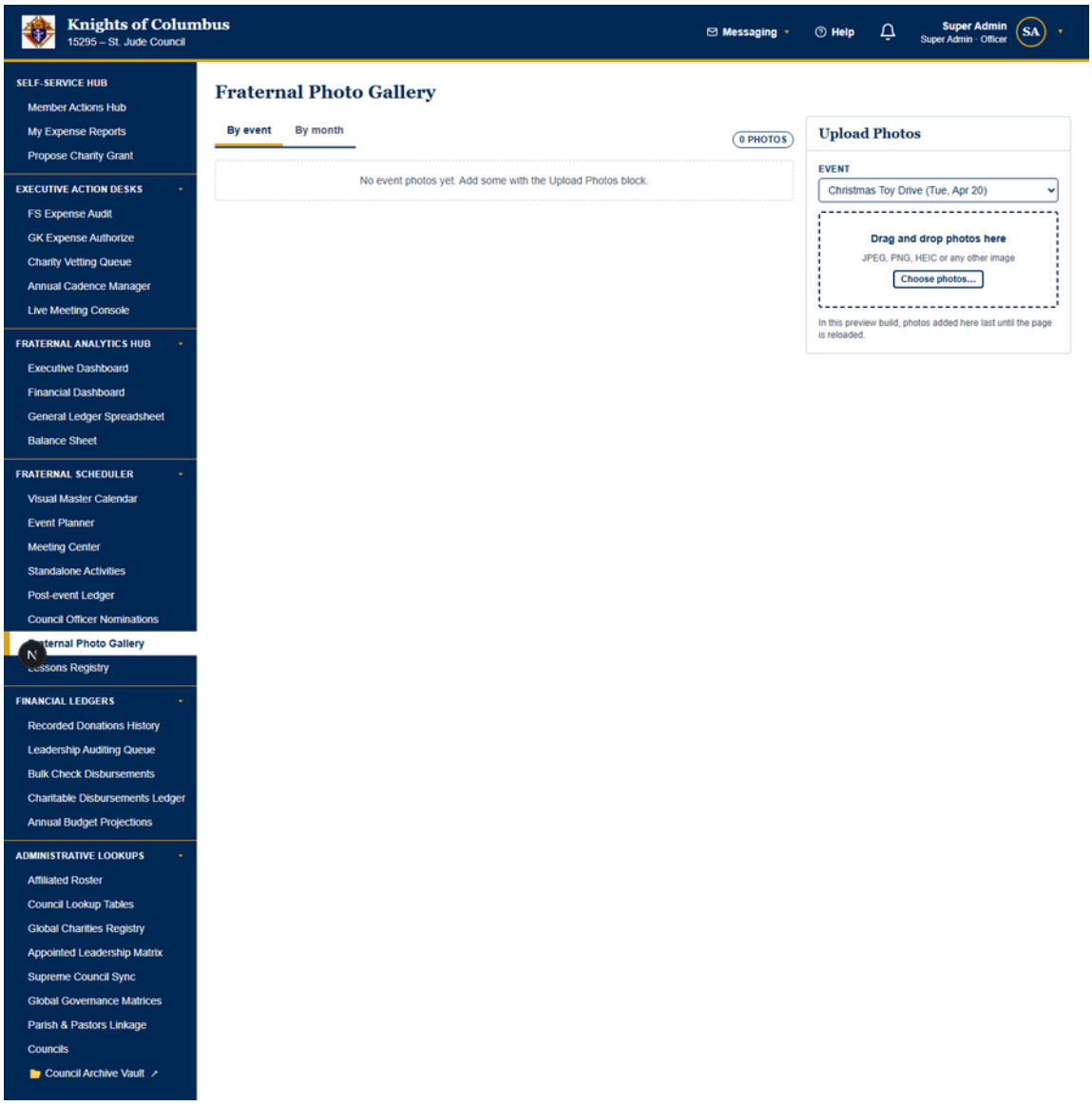


Photo gallery (/gallery)

Expected result: The photos show in the gallery mosaic. Select a photo to open it in the viewer. **Council Artifacts** shows a card for each meeting flyer, set of minutes, event flyer and event photo album.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
A council artifact card is missing.	The meeting or the event has no Drive link.	Add the link on the meeting or the event.

6.3 Ask the Microsoft Co-Pilot for collateral

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be a seated officer, a council Admin or a Super Admin. Other members do not see the **Recruitment Factory**.
>
> **Warning:** the Microsoft Co-Pilot is an AI service from Microsoft (Copilot Studio). The portal sends your request and the facts of the chosen event to Microsoft.

Goal: Get a draft of a notice, a post or other collateral for a council event.

Start point: Sidebar → Resources → **Recruitment Factory**.

Steps:

1. Choose the **Event**.
2. In **Ask Microsoft Co-Pilot to Design Advanced Collateral**, type what you need. The limit is 2,000 characters.
3. Select **Design Advanced Collateral**. The answer can take up to 30 seconds.
4. Read **The co-pilot's draft**. Check every fact, date and name.
5. Select **Copy the draft**.

Expected result: The draft shows under the prompt box.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
Design Advanced Collateral is grey. Its tooltip says *"The Microsoft Co-Pilot is not connected yet"*.	The council has no Co-Pilot key in the Secure Access Vault.	Select the tooltip's link to the Secure Access Vault. A council Admin saves the key there (section 5.2 of the Administrator User Guide).
"Microsoft refused the saved Co-Pilot key."	The key was changed or removed in Copilot Studio.	Ask a council Admin to save the new key (section 5.2 of the Administrator User Guide).
"The Microsoft Co-Pilot did not answer in time."	The agent took more than 30 seconds.	Type a shorter request. Try again.
Rewrite in plain, warm words shows.	The draft uses business jargon.	Edit the words before you use the draft.

7. Find members with a trade skill

7.1 Find members with a trade skill

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must have council Admin privileges for the council, or Super Admin privileges.
>
> **Warning: Send to *n* members** sends a message at once.

Goal: Find and message members with a skill.

Start point: Sidebar → Faith In Action → **Council Roster** → **Skills**.

Steps:

1. Choose a skill in the **Council skills** drawer.
2. Read **Members with *skill***.
3. Optional: write a note. Select **Send to *n* members**.

![Image: Skills Filter Drawer]

Expected result: Active members with the skill get the message. Replies arrive in **Council Messages & Alerts**.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
"No member of this council has recorded a skill yet."	Members have no skills on file.	Ask members to add skills in **My Profile**.

---

8. Automated messages reference

Delivery in this version: the platform prepares emails and texts. The email and text services are not connected yet.

High-priority alerts always reach each recipient's bell. Use the screens in the **Where to follow** column.

Hybrid messaging rule: an email or a text is only a short nudge. The nudge sends the member back to the platform.

Conversations stay in **Council Messages & Alerts**. Audit notes stay in the **General Ledger** and on the desks.

Decisions stay on the status tags and desks. No dollar amount, audit finding or private reason goes by email or text.

Charity grant requests

Step	Message	Recipient	Where to follow
Request filed	A tracking message with the three steps and the follow-up date	The Knight Shepherd	**Charity Vetting Queue**
1. Vetting	None	—	**Charity Vetting Queue**
2. Presentation	None	—	The meeting agenda and the **Live Meeting Console**
3. Payment Made	None	—	**Charitable Grants Registry**
6 months after filing	The Trustees ask the Shepherd for a status report. The app sends no reminder.	The Trustees	The date in the Shepherd's tracking message

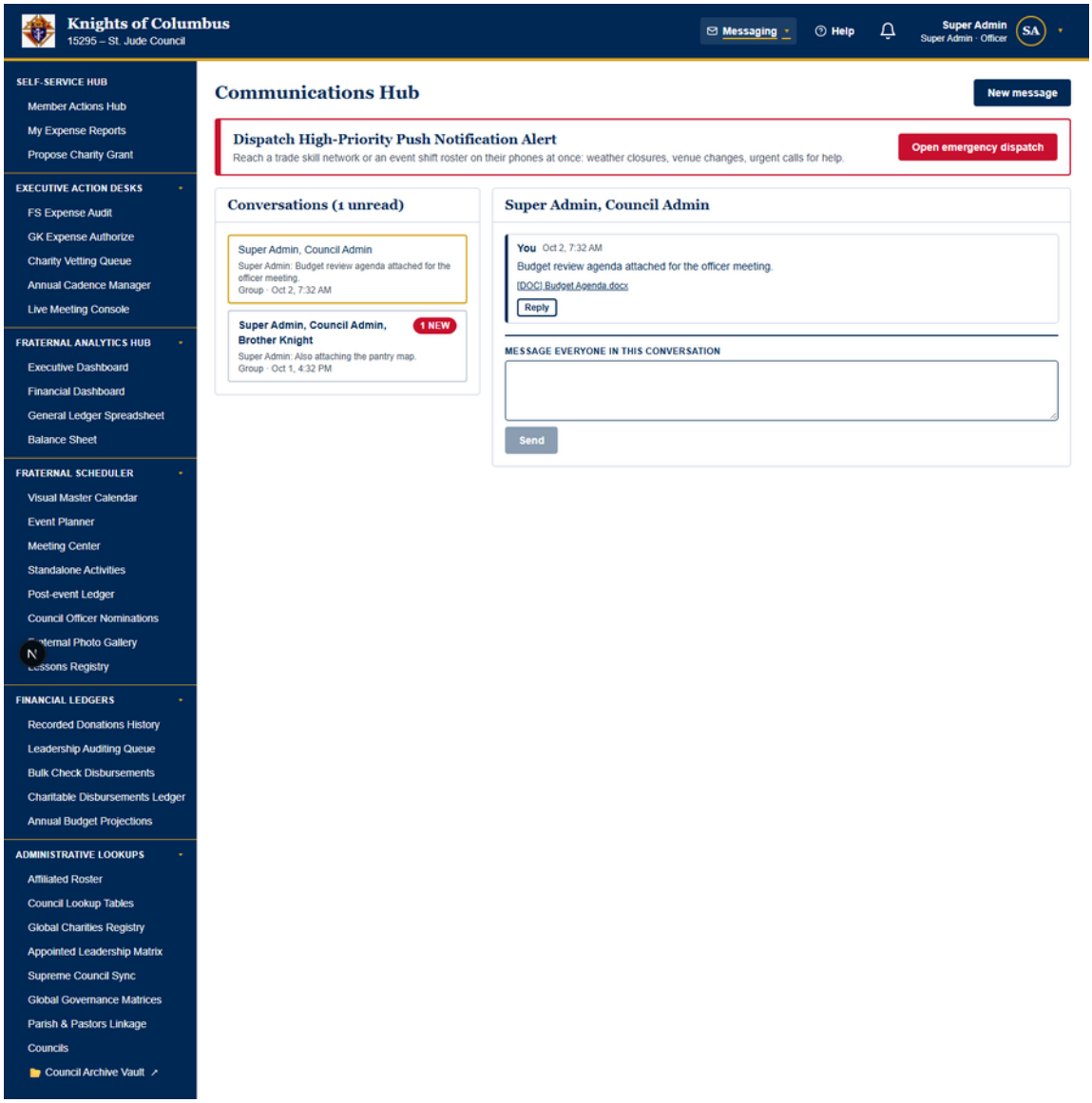
Expense reports

The platform sends no message when an expense report changes status. The member reads the status tag. Officers follow the desks (4.1).

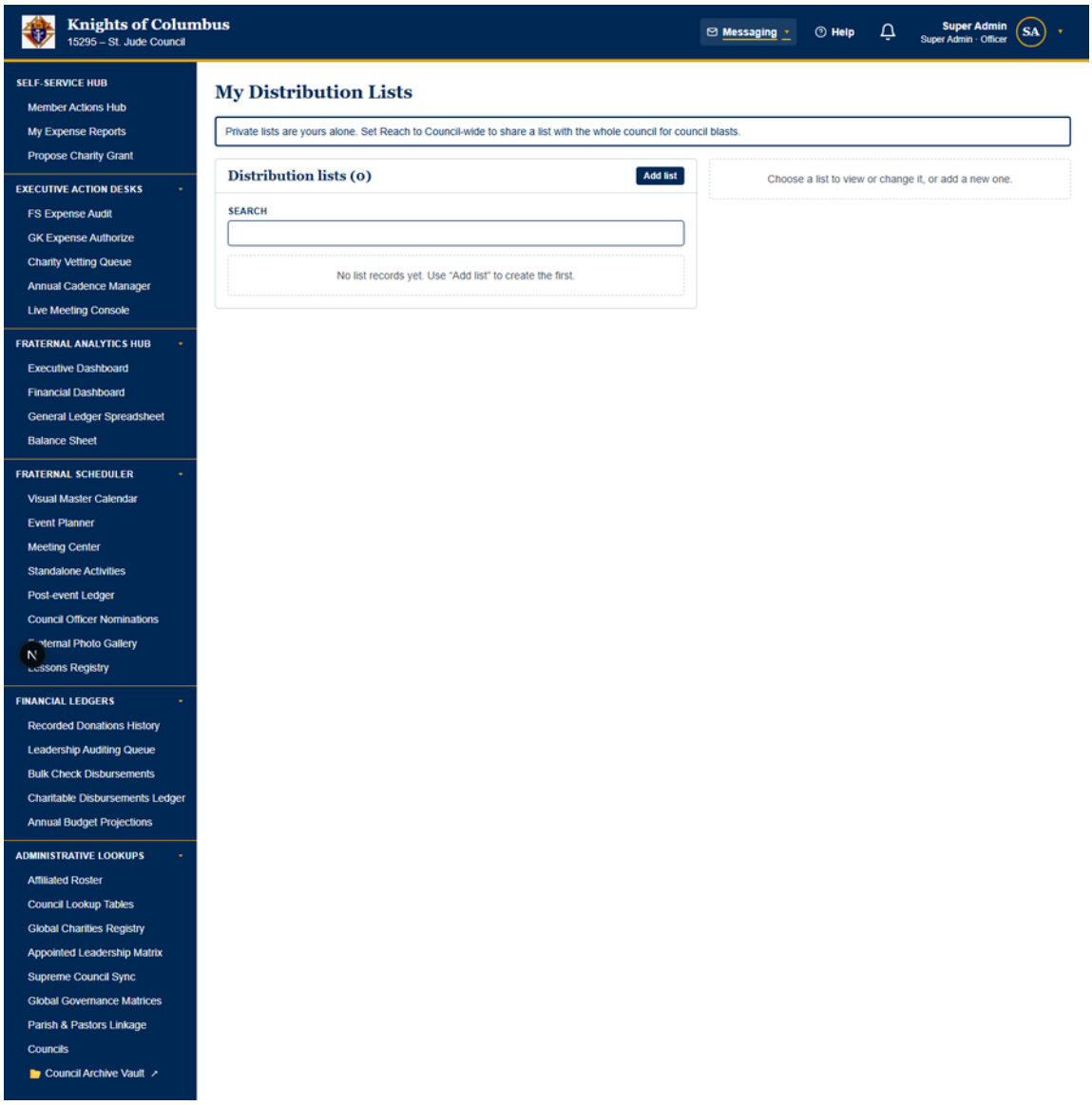
Volunteer service and onboarding

Trigger	Message	Recipient	Where to follow
A shift starts in 24 hours	A reminder email with a calendar file	Every volunteer on the shift	The event's shift roster
A meeting starts in 24 hours	A reminder email with a calendar file and the agenda	Every invitee	**Meeting Center**
Day 5 after a shift with no hours (the council can change the day, section 11.2)	A text reminder	The volunteer	**Active Desks** row → **Grand Knight Desk** → **Shifts Awaiting Hours** drawer
Every 7 days after that (the council can change the days, section 11.2)	A follow-up text, until the shift is older than the logging window (90 days by default)	The volunteer	Same panel. The row shows **Closed** when the window ends.
An officer sends an urgent alert	A phone push alert and a bell entry, kept 6 months	Members with the chosen skills or shifts	**Council Messages & Alerts** → **Dispatch High-Priority Push Notification Alert**
A member is added or synced	A welcome email with the app steps and a setup code	The new member	The confirmation on the **Council Roster** or the **Financial Secretary Desk** roster upload
A member requests a password reset	An email with a 6-digit code, valid 15 minutes	The member	None. The member resets the password alone.

Only the Financial Secretary, the Treasurer, council Admins and Super Admins see the urgent alert tile.



Council Messages & Alerts (/messages)



My Distribution Lists (/distribution-lists)

9. Member engagement

9.1 Concept: the Council Dashboard

The **Council Dashboard** shows every member how the council is doing. The page has no money on it. Cash, budgets and the general ledger stay on the **Executive Dashboard** and the Finances pages. Plain members cannot open those pages.

Card	What the card shows
Council volunteers	The month's volunteer count, the hours served and the name of each member who served
Our combined devotions	The rosaries, hours of adoration and confessions of all members, added together
Top 5 Volunteers Leaderboard	The 5 active members with the most hours ever logged at council events and activities
My impact	The reader's own events attended, personal hours, merit tier and council history

- The combined devotions show only totals. No card shows the devotions of one member.
- Members with equal hours share a place on the leaderboard.
- The **Top 5 Fraternal Volunteers** card on the dashboard **Home** desk is a different list. That card counts only the hours of the current month (section 14.2).
- A white-label organization does not see the devotions card or the shield.

9.2 Open the Council Dashboard

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** Every active member of the council. A Super Admin opens the page for the Super Admin's own council.

Goal: See the council's month and your own impact.

Start point: Sidebar → Performance → **Council Dashboard**. On the phone: Home → **Open the Council Dashboard**.

Steps:

1. Choose the **Month** and the **Year**. The phone always shows the current month.
2. Read the **Council volunteers** card.
3. Read **Our combined devotions** and the **Top 5 Volunteers Leaderboard**.
4. Read the **My impact** card.

Expected result: The cards show the month's volunteers and your own figures.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
A volunteer is missing from the month.	The volunteer did not log hours yet.	Ask the volunteer to log the hours. Hours close after the logging window, 90 days by default.
The devotions card shows 0.	No member logged devotions on the phone.	Tell members about the **Daily Devotional Drawer** on the phone Home screen.

9.3 Concept: personal impact and the merit tier

The **My impact** card shows three personal measures.

Measure	How the platform counts the measure
Events attended	The events where the member logged shift hours, each event counted one time

Measure	How the platform counts the measure
Personal hours	All shift hours and activity hours the member logged
Merit tier	The highest of the six tiers the member qualifies for this fraternal year

The tiers count hours, events, meeting check-ins and new members recruited in the current fraternal year (July 1 to June 30). The counts start again at 0 every July 1.

Tier	Name	Default rule
1	New Member	180 days or fewer since the First Degree / Initiation Date
2	Active Knight	1 hour, 1 event and 1 meeting
3	Anchor Knight	20 hours, 4 events and 4 meetings
4	Fraternal Champion	60 hours, 8 events and 8 meetings
5	Shining Armor Companion	3 meetings, 3 separate events and 1 new member recruited
6	Shield Circle / Honorary	The Grand Knight or Deputy Grand Knight seat, 25+ years since joining, or awarded by an Admin

- A member who meets no rule has no tier yet. The card says **No tier yet**.
- A founding member also shows the 📜 **Charter Member** badge.
- Devotions do not change the tier. The member logs devotions on the phone: Home → **Daily Devotional Drawer** → **Log devotions**. Only the member sees the member's own tally.

9.4 Set the merit tier milestones

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must have council Admin privileges for the council, or Super Admin privileges.

Goal: Set the numbers for Tiers 2 to 5 in your council.

You change the milestones on the **Admin Desk** only. Every other page shows the tiers as read-only text.

Start point: Active Desks row → **Admin Desk** → **Council Lookup Tables** drawer → **Merit Tier Milestones** tab.

Steps:

1. Enter the **Hours**, **Events** and **Meetings** for Tiers 2, 3 and 4.
2. Enter the **Meetings**, **Separate events** and **Recruits** for Tier 5.
3. Select **Save milestones**.

Expected result: The message **Merit tier milestones saved.** shows. Every member's tier uses the new numbers at once.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The milestones are refused.	A value is a decimal, too large, or lower than the tier below.	Enter whole numbers that do not go down from Tier 2 to Tier 4.
The tab is missing.	Only Admins and Super Admins set the milestones.	Ask a council Admin.

9.5 Read the monthly activity overview

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be a seated officer or an Admin of the council, or a Super Admin.

Goal: See the month's volunteers next to the cash collected.

Start point: Sidebar → Performance → **Executive Dashboard**. Scroll down to the navy overview card.

Steps:

1. Choose the **Month** and the **Year**.
2. Read the navy **Monthly activity overview** card.
3. To read the **Top 5 Volunteers Leaderboard**, open Sidebar → Performance → **Council Dashboard**.

Expected result: The overview shows the volunteer count, the cash collected, the hours served and each volunteer's name.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The cash collected differs from the deposits.	The overview counts the cash raised at the month's events.	Check the **Net balance** tile on the same page.

---

10. Flagged hours review

10.1 Concept: the flagged hours review

The flagged hours review protects the council's hour totals from over-reporting. The platform holds some hour entries for leadership review. A held entry is flagged for review. A held entry does not count anywhere until a leader clears it. The rule covers these totals:

- The council's monthly summary and the **Executive Dashboard** hours.
- The member's merit tier and personal hours.
- The **Top 5 Volunteers Leaderboard** and the **Council Dashboard**.

The member sees this message when the platform holds an entry: "... hours sent to leadership review before they count toward your totals." The message also gives the reason.

10.2 Concept: the 5/5 over-reporting rules

The platform holds a regular member's entry when either 5/5 rule applies. The numbers 5 and 5.0 are the defaults. Each council can change them in **Council Wide Settings** (section 11.2).

Rule	The platform holds the entry when	Example
5 activities	The entry is the member's sixth different activity on the same day.	A member logs 5 activities on Saturday. The sixth activity on Saturday goes to review.
5.0 hours	The entry puts more than 5.0 hours against one activity on one day.	A member logs 3 hours of **Food drive**. A second entry of 2.25 hours on the same day goes to review.

The two rules count in this way:

- A shift counts on the shift date. A council activity counts on the activity date.
- Held entries count toward both rules. A member cannot split hours to get past a rule.
- A second entry on an activity that the member already logged that day is not a new activity.
- On the phone **Report** tab, taps past a rule go to one held entry. The hours logged before the limit still count.

10.3 Concept: the +1 hour shift padding rule

A regular member may report up to 1.0 hour more than the scheduled shift. Set-up and clean-up often take extra time. The 1.0 hour is the default. Each council can change it in **Extra hours allowed past a scheduled shift** (section 11.2). The platform holds a shift report that is more than 1.0 hour over the scheduled length.

Scheduled shift	Largest report that counts at once	Report that goes to review
08:00 to 11:00 (3 hours)	4 hours	4.25 hours or more
18:00 to 20:00 (2 hours)	3 hours	3.25 hours or more

A shift report of more than 5.0 hours also goes to review under the 5.0-hour rule. A new report on the same shift replaces the member's report that waits for review.

10.4 Concept: who the rules do not apply to

The rules apply to regular members only. These members are exempt. The platform always logs their hours at once:

Exempt member	Why
Admins and Super Admins	They keep the council records.

Exempt member	Why
Elected officers: Grand Knight (GK), Deputy Grand Knight (DGK), Chancellor, Recorder, Treasurer, Warden, Advocate, Inside Guard and Outside Guard	The council elected them to lead.
Trustees 1, 2 and 3	The council elected them too.
The owner of the event	The owner runs the shift. The exemption covers only the shifts of the owner's own event.

Appointed officers, such as the Financial Secretary (FS), follow the rules.

A Super Admin can switch the flagged hours review off. The Super Admin turns off **Flagged hours review** in the Master Feature Deployment Grid (section 2 of the Super Admin System Manual). When the switch is off, every entry counts at once. The desk is hidden. Entries that wait for review stay flagged until the switch is on again.

10.5 Approve or reject held volunteer time

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** The Grand Knight (GK), the Deputy Grand Knight (DGK) or an Admin of the council, or a Super Admin. Other members do not see the desk.
>
> **Warning:** an approval is final. A rejected entry goes back to the member. It returns to the desk only when the member resubmits it.

Goal: Decide each held entry, so that true hours count and false hours never count.

Start point: Active Desks row → **Grand Knight Desk** → **Flagged Hours Review** drawer. The tile has a red border while an entry waits for review.

Steps:

1. Read the count of pending entries in the desk header.
2. Read each entry: the member name, the shift or activity, the date and the hours.
3. Read the **Description** that the member wrote. Read the red reason under the description.
4. Ask the member or the event owner about the time when the entry is not clear.
5. Select **Approve & Add to Time Log** for true hours. The hours count in every total at once.
6. Select **Reject & Return to Member** for wrong hours. The field **Reason for returning time report (required)** opens.
7. Type the reason. Tell the member what to correct. Select **Send back to member**. You cannot send an entry back without a reason.
8. The entry goes back to the member as a draft. The hours do not count. The member sees your reason on the phone **Report Hours** screen, corrects the hours and resubmits. The entry then comes back to the desk for a new decision.

Expected result: The entry leaves the desk. A message confirms the decision. An approved entry shows in the council's hours and on the member's shield.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The desk is not on the dashboard.	Your role is not GK, DGK or Admin, or the flagged hours review switch is off.	Ask a Super Admin to check your role and the **Flagged hours review** switch.
The desk says "has switched Flagged hours review off".	A Super Admin opened another council, and that council has the switch off.	Turn the switch on for that council, or choose another council.
An approved shift report replaced other hours.	A member has one report for each shift. Approval writes the held report over the old one.	Ask the member to report the correct hours again.

Problem	Cause	Fix
An approved activity entry is missing.	Someone deleted the activity after the member logged the time.	Restore the activity. Ask the member to log the time again.
A member says the hours are lost.	The entry waits on the desk.	Decide the entry. Tell the member that held hours count after a leader approves them.

11. Council Wide Settings

11.1 Concept: council settings and platform settings

Some numbers belong to one council. Other numbers belong to every council at once.

Kind	Who changes it	Where	What it holds
Council Wide Settings	The council's Admins and officers, or a Super Admin	Sidebar → System Settings → **Council Wide Settings**	The volunteer time limits, the time windows and the reminder timing of one council. The **Roster Inactivity Sweep** card (council Admins and Super Admins run it).
Platform Settings	Super Admins only	Sidebar → System Settings → **Global System Parameters** → **Platform Settings**	The invitation lead time, the sign-in length, the record retention, the recording time limit and two character limits for every council
Base dues rate and tenant type	Super Admins only	Sidebar → System Settings → **Global System Parameters** → **Global Council Parameters Dashboard**	The dues rate and the organization type of one council

A new council starts with the default values. A change applies to the next entry that a member saves. A change never moves hours that are already logged or held.

The time windows and reminder days were fixed numbers in earlier versions. Each council now sets its own numbers.

The page address is `/system-settings/council-settings`. Every administration and setup page sits under the System Settings pillar. An old bookmark to `/setup/council-settings` opens the new address.

11.2 Concept: the council settings

Financial Submissions card:

On-screen label	Default	Allowed values	What the setting controls
Days after an event or meeting to submit expenses	30 days	1 to 365	The expense filing window (section 4). A report that names an event or a meeting can be submitted from its first day through this many days after it ends.
Days before an unsubmitted expense draft expires	90 days	7 to 730	**Not used yet.** Drafts do not expire today.
Days a charity proposal stays open for a vote	14 days	1 to 90	**Not used yet.** The council votes at the next Monthly meeting at least 10 days away.

Volunteer & Meeting Operations card:

On-screen label	Default	Allowed values	What the setting controls
Most activities a member may report in one day	5	1 to 24	The 5-activity rule (section 10.2)
Most hours a member may report on one activity in one day	5.0 hours	0.25 to 24, in quarter hours	The 5.0-hour rule (section 10.2)
Extra hours allowed past a scheduled shift	1.0 hour	0 to 8, in quarter hours	The shift padding rule (section 10.3)
Days without service before a member counts as inactive	365 days	30 to 3,650	**Check for Inactive Members** (section 3.4 of the Financial Secretary Manual)

On-screen label	Default	Allowed values	What the setting controls
Days back a member may log volunteer time	90 days	7 to 730	The logging window. A member may log shift time and activity time this many days back.
Hours before an event that gate donations open	2 hours	0 to 72, in quarter hours	How long before an event begins the phone's **Collect** screen offers it for gate donations. With 0, an event is offered only once it is under way. Members may still sign up until a shift ends.
Days after a meeting that the minutes are due	7 days	1 to 60	The **Recorder Desk** counts down to the due date: the meeting's last day plus this number. Minutes not published by then show as overdue.
Days of notice before a special election	60 days	1 to 365	**Not used yet.** A mid-year nomination stays open for 14 days.
Days before a meeting a motion request must be in	5 days	1 to 60	An approved motion request goes on the first Monthly meeting at least this many days after the member submits it.

Reminder Cadences card:

On-screen label	Default	Allowed values	What the setting controls
Days after a shift before the first hours reminder	5 days	1 to 60	The first text reminder to a volunteer with no logged hours (section 8)
Days between follow-up hours reminders	7 days	1 to 60	The follow-up text reminders (section 8)
Days before an officer is reminded to sign an expense report	3 days	1 to 60	**Not used yet.** No signature reminder is sent today.

A value of 0 for **Extra hours allowed past a scheduled shift** sends every report longer than the scheduled shift to review.

The logging window replaces two older limits: 3 months for shift time and 6 months for activity time. A council that wants the old activity limit can enter `183` days.

The logging window also ends the hours reminders. A shift older than the window shows **Closed** on the **Shifts awaiting hours** panel, and the reminders stop.

11.3 Change the Council Wide Settings

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be a council Admin or a council officer of the council, or a Super Admin. Other members do not see this page.

Goal: Set your council's volunteer time limits, time windows and reminder timing.

Start point: Sidebar → System Settings → **Council Wide Settings**.

Steps:

1. Super Admins only: choose the council in **Council** at the top of the page.
2. Open the **System Settings** drawer. Find the card that holds the setting (section 11.2).
3. Optional: select **(i)** beside the field to read what the setting does. Select **Close**.
4. Enter the new number.
5. Select the save button of the card, for example **Save Financial Submissions**.

Expected result: A message says "Saved for council" with the council number. The new numbers apply from now on.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The page is not in the sidebar.	You are not an Admin or an officer of the council.	Ask a council Admin to make the change.
A number in another card went back to its old value.	Each card saves only its own fields.	Enter the number again and select the save button of that card.
The message says the value "must be a multiple of 0.25 hours".	Hours use 15-minute steps.	Enter a value such as `4.5` or `4.75`.
The message says the value must be "from" one number "to" another.	The value is outside the allowed range (section 11.2).	Enter a value inside the range.
The message says "Nothing changed."	Every number in the card is the same as the saved value.	Change a number, then save.
A field with **Not used yet** has no effect.	No feature reads the number yet.	No fix is needed. Keep the default.
You cannot find the cards.	A different tab is selected.	Select the tab that holds the card (section 8.2.1 of the Administrator User Guide).

11.3.1 Turn biometric sign-in on or off for the council

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be a council Admin or a council officer of the council, or a Super Admin.

Goal: Allow or stop Face ID and fingerprint sign-in on the phones of the council's members.

Start point: Sidebar → System Settings → **Council Wide Settings** → **Council Feature Deployment Matrix** drawer.

Steps:

1. Super Admins only: choose the council in **Council** at the top of the page.
2. Find the **Biometric Authentication** row.
3. Select **Turn off** to stop biometric sign-in. Select **Turn on** to allow it again.

Expected result: The badge changes to **AVAILABLE / OFF** or **DEPLOYED**. While it is off, a phone makes no new biometric key for a member of the council. A key that a phone already holds is deleted at its next use, and the member signs in with the password.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The row has no button.	You are not an Admin or an officer of the council.	Ask a council Admin to make the change.
A member still sees the **Enable FaceID / Biometric Login** switch.	The phone does not know the member's council before the sign-in.	No action. The phone makes no key after the sign-in.
A member reads *"Your council has turned off biometric sign-in."*	Biometric sign-in is off for the council.	The member signs in with the password.

11.3.2 Concept: sign-in codes on your account

- When the portal operator turns on sign-in codes for every member, each password sign-in asks for a 6-digit code. Admins and Super Admins always type a code when the portal has a text or email provider.
- The code goes by text message to the cell phone on file. When no text can be sent, the code goes by email.
- On a phone, the code shows above the keyboard. Tap the code once to fill the box.

- The code expires after 5 minutes. After 5 wrong codes, sign in again for a new code.
- Face ID, fingerprint and passkey sign-in do not ask for a code.
- When no cell phone or email on file can receive a code, the portal refuses the sign-in. Ask your council admin to add your cell phone.

12. Asset photos and remote help

12.1 Concept: asset photos in Google Drive

Each council asset can have one photo. The portal files every asset photo in the council's shared Google Drive. Each asset has its own folder:

```
Fraternal Enterprise Suite / Assets / <asset name>
```

The asset record keeps the Drive file. The photo stays with the asset for every member who opens the asset, on any computer and on the phone. An Admin does not need to upload the photo.

Who	Sees the inventory	Adds or removes a photo	Changes the name, status, serial number, location and notes
Grand Knight, Deputy Grand Knight (DGK), Admins, Financial Secretary, Treasurer, Super Admins	Yes	Yes	Yes
Trustees	Yes	Yes	No
Other members	No	No	No

The Deputy Grand Knight is a full asset manager because the DGK directs the council's programs and their equipment.

The portal accepts image files up to 25 MB. The council's Google Drive must be connected in **Secure Access Vault**. When Drive is not connected, the portal saves no photo.

On the phone, the **Council assets** button on the **Home** tab opens a list of the assets with their photos. The phone list is for viewing only.

12.2 Add a photo to a council asset

> **Who can do this:** The council's Grand Knight, Deputy Grand Knight, Trustees, Admins, Financial Secretary and Treasurer, or a Super Admin.

Goal: File a photo of the item in the council Google Drive and attach the photo to its asset record.

Start point: Sidebar → System Settings → **Council Asset Management** → **Edit** (or **Add photo**) on the asset row. The **Council assets** link on **My Expense Reports** opens the same page.

Steps:

1. Select **Upload photo** in the **Asset photo** box.
2. Choose an image file. The portal files the photo in Drive at once.
3. To change the photo, select **Replace photo** and choose another image.
4. To remove the photo from the asset, select **Remove photo**. The file stays in Drive.

Expected result: The photo shows on the asset form. The message says "Saved the photo of" and the asset name. The photo is in Drive under **Assets / <asset name>**. The inventory and the phone list show the photo.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The message says "The Drive vault is not configured." or "DRIVE_VAULT_LIVE is not on."	The council's Google Drive is not connected or not switched on.	Ask an Admin to connect Google Drive in **Secure Access Vault**. Ask the portal host to switch the Drive vault on.
The message says the file "is not a file type the Assets folder takes."	The file is not an image.	Choose a photo file.

Problem	Cause	Fix
The message says "Google Drive did not accept the photo. Try again later."	Google Drive did not answer.	Wait a few minutes, then upload the photo again.
The form shows the details but no **Save asset details** button.	You are a Trustee.	Ask an asset manager to change the details. You can still add the photo.

12.3 Concept: co-watching remote assistance

An officer or Admin who needs help can share a copy of the screen with the Super Admins. The officer starts and stops the sharing. Nothing is shared until the officer selects **Share my screen**.

- The copy refreshes every 5 seconds while the officer shares.
- The copy never contains what the officer types in form fields. Passwords are never sent.
- The copy cannot run on the Super Admin's computer. The desk shows the copy as a still picture of the page.
- Sharing stops when the officer selects **Stop sharing**, when a Super Admin closes the request, or after 30 minutes without an update.

12.4 Ask for remote help

> **Who can do this:** Officers and Admins. Members and Super Admins do not see the button.

Goal: Let a Super Admin see your screen while you get help.

Start point: The portal header → **Request Remote Officer Assistance**.

Steps:

1. Select **Request Remote Officer Assistance**.
2. Enter what you need in **What do you need help with? (optional)**.
3. Select **Share my screen**.
4. Go to the page you need help with. The Super Admin sees each page you open.
5. Select **Stop sharing** when you finish.

Expected result: The header button turns red and says ● **Sharing screen · Stop sharing**. After **Stop sharing**, the button goes back to **Request Remote Officer Assistance**.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The request fails with a session message.	Your server session ended.	Sign out, then sign in again.
The red button changed back by itself.	A Super Admin closed the request, or 30 minutes passed.	Send a new request if you still need help.

13. Annual roadmap, meeting check-in and meeting photos

13.1 Concept: the Annual Fraternal Roadmap

The **Annual Fraternal Roadmap** is a card on the **Executive Dashboard** page. The top of the page shows the same steps as one line, the roadmap ribbon. The card shows the three steps that hand the council over to its next fraternal year. A cycle carries the calendar year of its steps. The 2027 cycle elects and budgets the 2027-2028 fraternal year.

Step	Window	The portal marks the step done when
Nominations	May 1 - May 31	A nomination is recorded for the coming fraternal year, or the officers are seated.
Elections	June 1 - June 30	An officer is seated for the coming fraternal year. Concluding the fraternal year seats the officers.
Budget Lock	July 1 - July 10	The coming year's budget is approved.

Each step has one of four looks:

Look	Label	Meaning
Navy circle with	**Done**	The database shows the step done.
Heavy gold border	**Up next**	The first step that is not done and not past its due date.
Red circle with !	**Overdue**	The due date passed and the step is not done.
Plain outline	**Later**	A step after the next one.

The card opens on the current cycle. The current cycle changes to the next year 30 days after the July 10 Budget Lock. Use the year arrows to see an earlier or later cycle.

Overdue alerts. When a step is overdue, the card sends a push alert to the council's leaders. The leaders are the Grand Knight, the Deputy Grand Knight, the Financial Secretary, the Treasurer and the council's Admins. Each leader gets one alert for each overdue step in each cycle. The alert title is **Overdue: Nominations 2027**, **Overdue: Elections 2027** or **Overdue: Budget Lock 2027**. The alert also shows in each leader's alert list on the phone.

13.2 Read the roadmap and send the overdue alerts

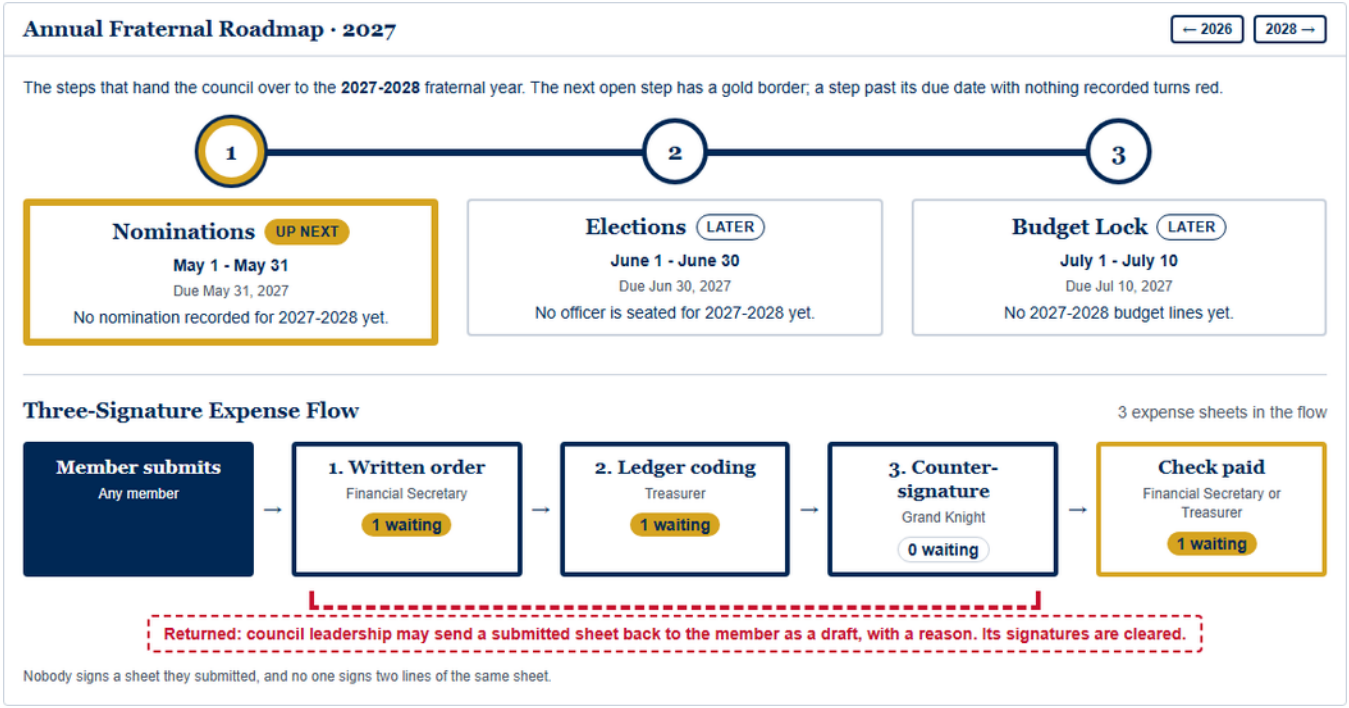
> **Who can do this:** the council's Admins and officers, and Super Admins. Other members do not see the **Executive Dashboard**.
>
> **Warning:** opening the card with an overdue step sends a push alert to the council's leaders. You cannot recall an alert.

Goal: See where the council stands on its yearly hand-over, and alert the leaders to a missed step.

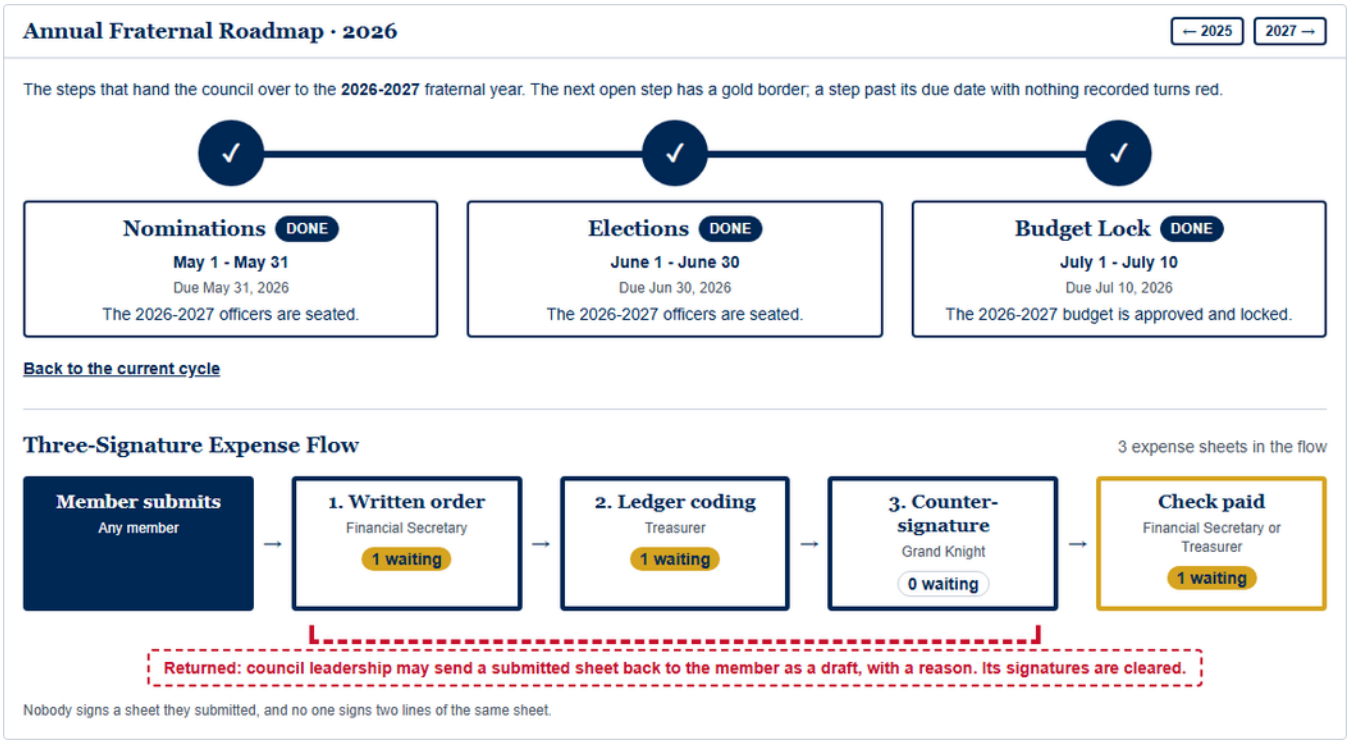
Start point: Sidebar → Performance → **Executive Dashboard**. Select **Full roadmap** ↓ in the roadmap ribbon. The page scrolls to the card.

Steps:

1. Scroll to the **Annual Fraternal Roadmap** card.
2. Find the step with the gold border. That step is next.
3. Read the line under each step. The line says what the database shows.
4. Check for a red step. When a red step shows, the card sends the overdue alert at once.
5. Read the note under the steps. The note says how many leaders got the alert.
6. Optional: select ← **2026** or **2028** → to see another cycle. Select **Back to the current cycle** to return.



Annual Fraternal Roadmap with Nominations up next (/dashboard)



Annual Fraternal Roadmap with all three steps done (/dashboard)

Expected result: The card shows the three steps of the cycle. After an alert, the note says *"Push alert sent to 4 council leaders for 1 overdue step."*

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
"Council leadership already has the alert for each overdue step."	The leaders got the alert on an earlier visit.	No action. The portal sends each alert one time.

Problem	Cause	Fix
Elections stays **Overdue** after the vote.	The fraternal year is not concluded, so no officer is seated for the new year.	Conclude the fraternal year on the elections page.
Budget Lock stays **Overdue**.	The coming year's budget is still Draft or Proposed.	Approve the budget on the budget page.
A leader got no push on the phone.	The leader's phone has no registered device.	The alert still shows in the leader's alert list.

13.3 Concept: the Three-Signature Expense Flow

Under the roadmap, the **Three-Signature Expense Flow** draws the path of an expense report. Each box shows how many of the council's reports wait at that step.

Box	Who acts	What the step does
Member submits	Any member	The member submits the expense report.
1. Payment request	Financial Secretary	The Financial Secretary audits the report and issues the payment request.
2. Ledger coding	Treasurer	The Treasurer picks the budget line and the ledger account.
3. Counter-signature	Grand Knight	The Grand Knight signs. The report becomes Approved.
Check paid	Financial Secretary or Treasurer	The check is recorded. The report becomes Reimbursed.

- Council leadership may return a submitted report to the member as a draft, with a reason. The return clears the report's signatures.
- Nobody signs a report that they submitted. One officer never signs two lines of the same report.

13.4 Concept: meeting check-in by PIN

Members check in to a live meeting from the phone with the 4-digit **meeting PIN**. The Grand Knight reads out the PIN at the meeting. The phone does not ask for the member's location.

- After 5 wrong PINs, the PIN box locks for that member and that meeting. An officer then checks the member in on the **Live Meeting Console**.
- The default meeting PIN is `0000`. Change the PIN before the first meeting.
- The Recorder keeps the PIN on the **Recorder Desk**. When the Recorder is absent, the Grand Knight, the Deputy Grand Knight or a council Admin sets it from the **Grand Knight Desk**. Super Admins may too. The PIN is not sent to members' phones.

13.5 Set the meeting PIN

> **Who can do this:** the council's Recorder, Grand Knight, Deputy Grand Knight and Admins, and Super Admins. Other officers do not see the **Meeting Check-In** card.
>
> **Warning:** a new PIN takes effect at once. Members who know only the old PIN cannot check in.

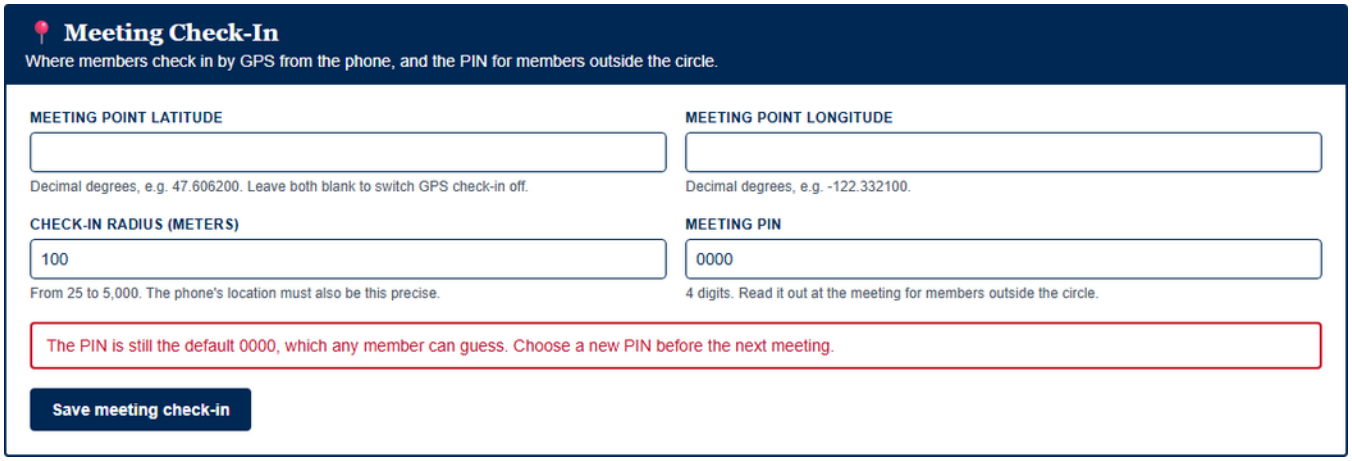
Goal: Set the 4-digit PIN that members type to check in to a meeting.

Start point: Active Desks row → **Recorder Desk** → **Chamber Check-In**. When the Recorder is absent: **Active Desks** row → **Grand Knight Desk** → **Chamber Check-In (Recorder Absent)**.

Steps:

1. Select **Generate new PIN**. The card makes a random 4-digit PIN, never `0000`, and saves it at once.
2. Or enter 4 digits in **Meeting PIN** and select **Save meeting check-in**.

3. Read the PIN out at the meeting.



Meeting Check-In card with the default PIN warning (/setup/council-settings)

Expected result: The card says *"New meeting PIN … saved."* or *"Saved. Members check in with this PIN."* The Council Wide Settings page no longer holds this card.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
"The PIN is still the default 0000, which any member can guess. …"	The PIN is `0000`.	Enter a new 4-digit PIN. Select **Save meeting check-in**.
"The meeting PIN must be exactly 4 digits."	The PIN has letters, or too few or too many digits.	Enter 4 digits.

13.6 File a meeting photo with the minutes

> **Who can do this:** the meeting's chair: the meeting owner, the council's Admins and officers, and Super Admins.

Goal: Keep one photo of the meeting with its minutes, in the council's Google Drive.

Start point: Sidebar → Governance → **Live Meeting Console** → **Meeting photo**.

Steps:

1. Pick the meeting and start the console.
2. Scroll to the **Meeting photo** panel, under **Live attendance**.
3. Select **Upload photo**.
4. Choose the photo file.
5. To change the photo, select **Replace photo**. To remove the photo, select **Remove photo**.

Expected result: The photo shows in the panel. An Admin's upload is filed in Google Drive under **Fraternal Enterprise Suite / Media / Meeting_Photos**.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The photo is gone after you reload the page.	The upload was not filed in Drive: the uploader is not an Admin, or the council's Drive is off.	Ask an Admin to upload the photo. Turn on Drive in the **Secure Access Vault**.
"Google Drive did not accept the file."	Drive refused the upload.	Try again later.

Problem	Cause	Fix
Members' own photos are not in the panel.	A member's check-in photo stays on the member's phone.	Ask the member to send the photo to an Admin.

14. The Active Desks dashboard

14.1 Concept: the Active Desks row

The dashboard is a set of desks. A row of folder tabs sits under the navy header on every page. The row has the title **Active Desks**.

- Each tab looks like the tab of a paper file folder. A navy outline frames each tab.
- The open desk is white and raised. A deep gold edge runs along its top.
- **Home** is the first tab. **Member Desk** is the last tab.
- Select a tab on any page. The dashboard opens on that desk.
- Select the **Home** tab to return to **Home** from any page.
- Select **Executive Dashboard** in the sidebar to open the **Executive Summary** page. That page is not a desk tab. See section 14.11.

Every signed-in member sees the row. A plain member gets **Home** and **Member Desk**. Each officer seat adds its own desk.

A Council Historian without an officer seat and without Admin rights gets **Home**, **Historian Desk** and **Member Desk**. This Historian also gets the **Executive Dashboard** link in the sidebar (section 14.11).

After you sign in, the portal opens on the **Home** tab. This is true for every member, officer, Admin and Super Admin. When more cards are below the first screen, the line **Scroll down for more council info** ↓ shows at the bottom edge. The line fades away when you start to scroll down. The four tabs of the Volunteer Check-In & Service Center are on the **Member Actions Hub** (sidebar **Member Actions Hub**). They are not on the **Member Desk** tab.

Every module that a seat works in is a folder at the top of that seat's desk (section 14.3.1). You do not use the sidebar to find these modules. The **Leadership Auditing Queue** page opens from the **Financial Secretary Desk**.

14.2 Concept: the Home desk

Home holds seven large cards, and nothing else. No card has a link into a desk. The only button on **Home** is **Praying Hands** on the prayer list. The newsletters card leads across the full width. The other cards show two across on a laptop screen, and three across on a very wide screen. Each card grows to show its full list. Scroll the page to see the lower cards.

Your own check-in work - the shift sign-ups, the roster and your hours - is on the **Member Actions Hub** (section 14.6). Select **Member Actions Hub** in the sidebar to open it. To add a prayer intention, open the **Faith Center** page.

Every sign-in opens **Home**. The portal goes to `/dashboard#home`, so the tab that this browser had open last does not come back after a sign-in. A Super Admin's view-as session also opens on **Home**.

Card on Home	What the card shows
Latest Council Newsletters & Bulletins	The council's newest newsletters from the Council Historian, up to 3, newest first, across the full width of **Home**. The newest newsletter shows in full. Select another headline to read it. The card shows only when the council has a saved newsletter.
Bible Verse of the Day	One verse for the day, from the NABRE.
Live Actionable Reminders	Your own unread alerts and the sheets that wait for your signature, as plain text. A red edge is urgent. The card refreshes every minute. Act on a reminder from your desk tab or the alert bell.
Liturgical Feast Day Tracker	Today's feast day and the feasts of the coming days. A holy day of obligation is marked.

Card on Home	What the card shows
Upcoming Event Agenda	The council's events and meetings for the next 7 days, with the day, the time and the place. Under them, **Council priorities · Old Business**: the open items of last month's published minutes, read only (section 14.8.2).
Top 5 Fraternal Volunteers	A navy card with a gold edge. The 5 active members of the council with the most hours logged at council events and activities in the current month, with their hours.
Community Prayer Request List	The council's open prayer intentions, newest first. Each intention shows who asked and how many brothers prayed. Select **Praying Hands** to pray for an intention. You can pray once a day for each intention; the button is then grey until tomorrow. Add an intention on the **Faith Center** page.

The **Top 5 Fraternal Volunteers** card counts only the current month. The card starts empty on the first day of each month. Members with equal hours share a place. The **Top 5 Volunteers Leaderboard** on the **Council Dashboard** counts all hours ever logged.

Home has no status badges, roadmap ribbon or **Executive Summary**. The roadmap ribbon and the **Executive Summary** are on the **Executive Dashboard** page (section 14.11).

The portal has no status badge strip and no **Oversight Desk**. Each queue shows its count on its own drawer tile, and a tile with work for you has a red border (section 14.3.2).

The **Bible Verse of the Day**, the **Liturgical Feast Day Tracker** and the **Community Prayer Request List** show only while the council's **Faith Center** module is on. A white-label organization does not see the three faith cards. **Home** then shows the other four cards.

14.3 Concept: the desks

A desk holds the work of one seat. Every officer desk is a desk blotter of drawers (section 14.3.2). When nobody holds the desk's office, an Admin who opens the desk sees the card **Seat Vacant — Open Council Roster to Assign this Officer Position** above the drawers, with links to the **Council Roster** and the **Appointed Leadership Matrix**. If part of a desk cannot load, the desk shows a short message in its place instead of a blank page. You sign, code and pay inside a drawer on the desk. The **Member Desk** has no drawers.

The portal shows a desk tab only to a reader who may do the desk's work.

Tab	Who gets the tab	What the tab shows	Full desk page
Grand Knight Desk	The council's GK and DGK, the council's Admins and Super Admins	The desk blotter: one drawer for each module (section 14.3.2), with **Approved Expenses** first. Under the drawers: the **Council Roster** panel.	None. You work inside the drawers.
Financial Secretary Desk	The council's FS, the council's Admins and Super Admins	The desk blotter: one drawer for each module (section 14.3.2), with **FS Expense Audit Queue** first.	None. You work inside the drawers.
Treasurer Desk	The council's Treasurer, the council's Admins and Super Admins	The desk blotter, with **Treasurer Ledger Audit**, **Disbursed Check Registry** and **Charitable Grants Registry** first. Under the drawers: the **Disbursed Check Registry** panel.	None. You work inside the drawers.
Recorder Desk	The council's Recorder, the council's Admins and Super Admins	The desk blotter, with the **Historical Meeting Minutes Archive** first on the spine.	None. You work inside the drawers.
Historian Desk	The council's Council Historian, the council's Admins and Super Admins	The desk blotter, with the **Fraternal Diary Entry Logs** first.	None. You work inside the drawers.

Tab	Who gets the tab	What the tab shows	Full desk page
Member Desk	Every reader of the dashboard	Top row, side by side: **Open Shifts Needing Volunteers** and **My shifts: next 30 days**. Under them: **My Charity Requests** and **My open expense sheets**, then the **Council Roster** panel. No drawers.	Sidebar → Finances → **My Expense Reports**; Sidebar → Performance → **Council Dashboard**

14.3.1 Concept: the advanced modules on the desks

The desks no longer use module folders. Each advanced module below is a drawer on its desk (section 14.3.2). The module's own page also stays at its web address.

A drawer shows only to a reader who may open the module. A reader who may not open a module does not see its drawer.

Trustee Semiannual Audit switch. When a Super Admin turns off **Trustee Semiannual Audit**, five inspection drawers leave the desks. The drawers leave for every reader, including Admins and Super Admins.

Desk	Drawers that leave when Trustee Semiannual Audit is off
Financial Secretary Desk	**Trustee Semiannual Audit**, **Expense Report (ER) Routing Track**, **Charitable Donation Records**
Treasurer Desk	**Cash Box Audit Closure Panel**, **Bank Statement Match-Window**

The drawers that move money stay on the desks: **FS Expense Audit Queue**, **Charitable Grants Registry**, **Treasurer Ledger Audit**, **Disbursed Check Registry** and **Charitable Grants Registry**. An expense sheet therefore never stops in the queue. The **Donations History** page stays in the sidebar. The switch deletes no records.

Desk	Module drawer	What the module does
Grand Knight Desk	**Charitable Grant Requests Vetting Board**	Claim, question, advance and place charity grant requests on the agenda (section 2).
Grand Knight Desk	**Constitutional Advisor Panels**	Ask a parliamentary or bylaws question. Officers only.
Grand Knight Desk	**Connected Councils**	Invite nearby councils and answer their invites (section 16).
Financial Secretary Desk	**Trustee Semiannual Audit**	The Trustees' step-by-step audit and the Form 1295 report.
Financial Secretary Desk	**Charitable Grants Registry**	Pay approved charity requests and gifts by check.
Treasurer Desk	**Annual Budget vs Actuals Ledger Grid**	**Budgeted vs. Current Actual Spend** and the **Budget Allocation & YOY Variance Analyzer**.
Treasurer Desk	**Bank Statement Match-Window**	Match a bank statement CSV file against the general ledger. Only the FS, the Treasurer and Super Admins can run the match.
Recorder Desk	**Council Resolutions and Motions Ledger**	Every motion on the council's meetings of this fraternal year, with its meeting, presenter, source and result.
Historian Desk	**Google Drive Media Gallery Sync Board**	Upload and tag photos and build Smart Albums. Select a photo to open the viewer.

The Deputy Grand Knight (DGK) gets the same **Grand Knight Desk** drawers as the GK.

14.3.2 Concept: the filing spine, the Desk Blotter and the alert boundary

Every officer desk is a split-view console: the **Grand Knight Desk**, the **Financial Secretary Desk**, the **Treasurer Desk**, the **Recorder Desk** and the **Historian Desk**. The console has two parts:

- **The filing spine** (the left quarter of the desk). The spine is a flat list of folder links, one for each module. A folder shows the module name and, for a queue, the number of sheets that wait. No folder is inside another folder.
- **The Desk Blotter** (the right three quarters of the desk). The folder that you select opens here. The full module works on the blotter. You sign, verify and look up records on the blotter. You do not go to another page.

The spine has this order from the top:

1. **Priority: waiting on you.** Every folder with work that waits for you moves to the top of the spine, inside a red box. Each of these folders has a thick red border.
2. **The cabinets** (the **Financial Secretary Desk** and the **Treasurer Desk** only). Two cabinet blocks show, one above the other:

- **Inbound Operations**: work that comes in to you. For example, payment requests, coding, cash box counts, donation records and bank matches.
- **Outbound Operations**: money and reports that go out. For example, checks, charity matches and the Form 1295.

3. **The other folders.** On the **Grand Knight Desk**, the **Recorder Desk** and the **Historian Desk**, the other folders show in one flat list.
4. **Accounting Configuration** (the **Treasurer Desk** only). This block holds the **General Ledger** folder (section 6.4.1 of the Treasurer Manual).
5. **Reference Workflows** (every officer desk). This block is always at the bottom of the spine. It holds the workflow drawers that you read for reference (section 14.3.3). A reference folder shows its count in grey. A reference folder never gets a red border and never moves to the top. The same sheet therefore lights only one folder: the folder where you sign.

To close a folder, select **Back to Desk Blotter** at the bottom of the blotter. You can also select **Close** or push **Esc**.

Alert boundary: a folder with a thick red border and a red glow has work that waits for you. It moves to the top of the spine. The folder also shows a red line that names the work, for example *"Waiting for your signature"*. The desk checks the queues again every 30 seconds.

Desk	Folder with the alert boundary	The red border shows when
Grand Knight Desk	**Approved Expenses**	A sheet in the release queue waits for your final release, and you may sign it. A sheet that you submitted, ordered or coded does not light the border.
Financial Secretary Desk	**FS Expense Audit Queue**	A sheet waits for its payment request, and you may sign it. Your own sheet does not light the border.
Grand Knight Desk	**Flagged Hours Review**	A time entry is held for review (section 10).
Grand Knight Desk	**Shifts Awaiting Hours**	A volunteer is past the first hours reminder and has not logged time.
Grand Knight Desk and **Financial Secretary Desk**	**FS/GK Compliance Endorsements**	An approved charity grant waits for your endorsement, and you do not shepherd it.
Treasurer Desk	**Treasurer Ledger Audit**	A signed sheet waits for your ledger account, and you may code it.
Treasurer Desk	**Disbursed Check Registry**	A fully signed sheet waits for your check, and you may pay it. Your own sheet does not light the border.

Desk	Folder with the alert boundary	The red border shows when
Treasurer Desk	**Charitable Grants Registry**	A charity request or gift waits for its check.
Recorder Desk	**Meeting Minutes Entry Desk**	The minutes of a meeting are due or overdue. The red line counts the overdue meetings.

The folders in **Reference Workflows** never show the alert boundary. They are read only: they have no fields and no buttons. Open a reference folder to see the work that waits on each step. Do the work in the working folder that the step names. For example, the **Charitable Donation Workflow** folder counts the approved charity requests that wait for your endorsement. You endorse them in **FS/GK Compliance Endorsements**.

The drawers on each desk:

Desk	Drawer	What you do in the drawer
Grand Knight Desk	**Approved Expenses**	Select **Final Release for Payment** on each sheet.
Grand Knight Desk	**Flagged Hours Review**	Approve or reject the held time entries (section 10).
Grand Knight Desk	**Shifts Awaiting Hours**	Read the volunteers who served but have not logged time, with their phone numbers.
Grand Knight Desk	**Charitable Grant Requests Vetting Board**	Claim, question, advance and place charity grant requests on the agenda (section 2).
Grand Knight Desk	**FS/GK Compliance Endorsements**	Select **Endorse for payment** on each approved charity grant (section 4.3.1).
Grand Knight Desk	**Council Goals & Targets**	Read the Star Council objectives of this fraternal year: Membership Intake, Charitable Dollars (funds raised) and Volunteer Hours, each against its target.
Grand Knight Desk	**Shared Equipment Library**	List, lend and check in council assets (section 15.3).
Grand Knight Desk	**Affiliation Invites**	Accept or decline invites from nearby councils.
Grand Knight Desk	**Connected Councils**	Invite nearby councils (section 16).
Grand Knight Desk	**Constitutional Advisor Panels**	Ask a parliamentary or bylaws question. For example, *How much notice does a motion need?* returns the Section 122(b) rule: 10 days' previous notice and a two-thirds vote.
Grand Knight Desk	**Operations Knowledge Vault**	Write a new entry (the GK, the DGK and Admins). Search the signed operating notes of every council (section 17).
Grand Knight Desk (reference)	**Charitable Donation Workflow**	Read where each outgoing charity grant waits. Read only.
Grand Knight Desk (reference)	**Planning & Budgeting Workflow**	Read the planning steps, the goals and the budget status. Read only. Set and review the goals on **Council Wide Settings** (section 16).
Grand Knight Desk (reference)	**Council Election Workflow**	Read the four election steps, the progress wheels and the nominees. Read only. Nominate in the **Council Election Center** (section 14.3.3).
Financial Secretary Desk	**FS Expense Audit Queue**	Select **Verify & Sign Expense** on each sheet, or return a sheet to its member with a reason. The sidebar link **FS Expense Audit Queue** opens the same queue.
Financial Secretary Desk	**Expense Report (ER) Routing Track**	Read each open sheet and the signature that it waits for.
Financial Secretary Desk	**Charitable Donation Records**	Record, check and correct council donations.

Desk	Drawer	What you do in the drawer
Financial Secretary Desk	**FS/GK Compliance Endorsements**	Select **Endorse for payment** on each approved charity grant (section 4.3.1).
Financial Secretary Desk	**Charitable Grants Registry**	Pay approved charity requests and gifts by check.
Financial Secretary Desk	**Trustee Semiannual Audit**	The Trustees' step-by-step audit and the Form 1295 report.
Financial Secretary Desk	**Excel Roster Imports**	Download the roster template. Upload the Supreme roster CSV.
Financial Secretary Desk	**Operations Knowledge Vault**	Search the signed operating notes of every council (section 17).
Financial Secretary Desk (reference)	**Expense Report (ER) Workflow**	Read where each sheet waits. Read only. Sign in **FS Expense Audit Queue** (section 14.3.3).
Financial Secretary Desk (reference)	**Charitable Donation Workflow**	Read where each outgoing charity grant waits. Read only.
Treasurer Desk	**Treasurer Ledger Audit**	Pick the ledger account. Read the green **Inferred Budget** line. Select **Categorize & Lock Expense**. Log concluded revenue.
Treasurer Desk	**Disbursed Check Registry**	Pay fully signed sheets by check.
Treasurer Desk	**Charitable Grants Registry**	Match approved charity requests and gifts to their checks, and pay them.
Treasurer Desk	**Cash Box Audit Closure Panel**	Count each concluded event's cash box and log any variance (section 10 of the Treasurer Manual).
Treasurer Desk	**High-Volume Batch Transaction Coder**	Code many electronic donations to one Revenue line (section 10 of the Treasurer Manual).
Treasurer Desk	**Annual Budget vs Actuals Ledger Grid**	Read budgeted against actual spend and the variance analyzer.
Treasurer Desk	**Bank Statement Match-Window**	Match a bank statement CSV file against the general ledger.
Treasurer Desk (accounting)	**General Ledger**	Review every general ledger account, its type and its posted balance (section 6.4.1 of the Treasurer Manual).
Treasurer Desk (reference)	**Expense Report (ER) Workflow**	Read where each sheet waits. Read only. Code in **Treasurer Ledger Audit** and pay in **Disbursed Check Registry** (section 14.3.3).
Treasurer Desk (reference)	**Charitable Donation Workflow**	Read where each outgoing charity grant waits. Read only. Pay in **Charitable Grants Registry** (section 2.7 of the Treasurer Manual).
Treasurer Desk (reference)	**Planning & Budgeting Workflow**	Read the planning steps and the budget status. Read only. Mark the budget reviewed on **Council Wide Settings** (section 16).
Recorder Desk	**Historical Meeting Minutes Archive**	Read the published minutes of every past meeting before you open a session (section 14.8.1). This drawer spans the top row of the desk.
Recorder Desk	**Meeting Minutes Entry Desk**	Write, save and publish the minutes (section 14.8).
Recorder Desk	**Start Live Meeting Sequence**	Start the live console and read the PIN (section 14.9).
Recorder Desk	**Council Resolutions and Motions Ledger**	Read every motion of this fraternal year and its result.
Recorder Desk (reference)	**Council Election Workflow**	Read the election steps and the progress wheels.

Desk	Drawer	What you do in the drawer
Historian Desk	**Fraternal Diary Entry Logs**	Read the council's diary entries by year, author or word (section 14.10.1).
Historian Desk	**Monthly Newsletters**	Write one newsletter a month (section 14.10).
Historian Desk	**Meeting Photos**	File each meeting's photo to Google Drive (section 14.10).
Historian Desk	**Oral History Recordings**	Listen to testimonials and record your own (section 14.10).
Historian Desk	**Google Drive Media Gallery Sync Board**	Upload and tag photos and build Smart Albums. A saved album opens at once as the active filter under **Smart Albums**. Select a photo to open the viewer. The Council Historian may tag photos to any past event or meeting of the council.
Historian Desk (reference)	**Council Election Workflow**	Read the election steps and the progress wheels.

A tile shows only to a reader who may open its module. An Admin who does not hold the seat reads the drawers but cannot sign.

Back to Desk Blotter: some work must open another page. For example, the release of a long-term asset opens the asset form. Then a **Back to Desk Blotter** bar shows under the tab row. Select the bar to go back to your desk.

The Oversight Desk is gone. Its audits are drawers on the **Grand Knight Desk**: **Flagged Hours Review** and **Shifts Awaiting Hours**. Super Admins read council access requests on the **Super Admin Desk** only. A saved `/dashboard#oversight` address opens your first tab.

A seat clears a desk only on the officer's own council. A Super Admin who picks another council in the council drop-down sees every desk of that council.

Earlier sections of this guide name the **Executive Dashboard** as a start point. For those tasks, select **Executive Dashboard** in the sidebar. The **Executive Summary** page opens.

Each tab has its own web address. The address is the dashboard address with the tab name after a `#` sign:

Tab	Address
Home	`/dashboard#home`
Grand Knight Desk	`/dashboard#grand-knight`
Financial Secretary Desk	`/dashboard#financial-secretary`
Treasurer Desk	`/dashboard#treasurer`
Recorder Desk	`/dashboard#recorder`
Historian Desk	`/dashboard#historian`
Member Desk	`/dashboard#member`

Save a desk address as a browser bookmark to open the desk directly. The browser also remembers the last tab you opened. The dashboard opens on that tab the next time. A tab you cannot open falls back to your first tab. For most readers, the first tab is **Home**.

14.3.3 Concept: the workflow drawers

Three drawers show a whole workflow in one place. Each workflow drawer uses the layout of the **Planning & Budgeting Workflow** drawer:

- A highlighted action bar at the top. One sentence tells you what happens now and names the working folder where you act. The bar stays gold: a reference folder never turns red.

- A row of numbered steps. The current step has a gold border and the label **(now)**. A done step has a tick.
- A step that you act on carries the tag **Your step**. A step with a queue shows the number of items waiting.
- Progress wheels. Each wheel fills as its count comes closer to complete.

Drawer	Desks	Steps	What you do in the drawer
Expense Report (ER) Workflow	**Financial Secretary Desk** and **Treasurer Desk** (in **Reference Workflows**)	1. **Payment request** (FS). 2. **Ledger coding** (Treasurer). 3. **GK approval** (Grand Knight). 4. **Check issued** (Treasurer).	Read **Every open sheet**: each sheet, its total, the step it waits at and who acts. The Financial Secretary signs in **FS Expense Audit Queue**. The Treasurer codes in **Treasurer Ledger Audit** and pays in **Disbursed Check Registry**.
Charitable Donation Workflow	**Financial Secretary Desk**, **Treasurer Desk** and **Grand Knight Desk** (in **Reference Workflows**)	1. **Member Charity Request** (Knight Shepherd, vetters, council vote). 2. **FS/GK Compliance Endorsement** (FS, GK or DGK). 3. **Treasurer Check Settlement** (Treasurer).	Read where each outgoing charity grant waits. The FS, GK and DGK endorse in **FS/GK Compliance Endorsements**. The Treasurer pays in **Charitable Grants Registry** (the FS in **Charitable Grants Registry**). Gifts coming in stay on the batch coder and cash box drawers.
Council Election Workflow	**Grand Knight Desk**, **Recorder Desk** and **Historian Desk** (in **Reference Workflows**)	1. **Open the ballot** (before May 1). 2. **Nominations** (May 1 - 31). 3. **Election** (June). 4. **New term** (July 1).	Read the wheels **Offices on the ballot** and **Offices with a nominee**, and the nominees of each office. Nominate in the **Council Election Center** (Sidebar). Admins set the ballot on **Council Lookups**.

The workflow drawers have no fields and no buttons. They read the same records as the working folders, so a sheet signed in **FS Expense Audit Queue**, **Treasurer Ledger Audit** or **Disbursed Check Registry** moves to its next step in the workflow drawer.

The workflow drawers are reference folders. They sit in the **Reference Workflows** block at the bottom of the spine. They never get the red border, so a waiting sheet lights only its signing folder.

The **Council Election Workflow** drawer replaces the **Council Election Tracker** drawer. A mid-year election leads the action bar while its nominations are open.

14.4 Read the Home desk

> **Who can do this:** every signed-in member.

Goal: Read the council's newsletters, the day's verse and feast, your reminders, today's agenda, the month's top volunteers and the prayer list.

Start point: Active Desks row → **Home**.

Steps:

1. Select the **Home** tab. The portal opens on **Home** after you sign in.
2. Read the **Latest Council Newsletters & Bulletins** card at the top. Select an older headline to open that newsletter.
3. Read the **Bible Verse of the Day** and the **Liturgical Feast Day Tracker**.
4. Read **Live Actionable Reminders**. To act on a reminder, open your desk tab or the alert bell.

5. Read **Upcoming Event Agenda** and its **Council priorities · Old Business**. Select an event name to open the council calendar.
6. Read the **Top 5 Fraternal Volunteers** card for the month's top volunteers and their hours.
7. Read the **Community Prayer Request List**. Select **Praying Hands** beside an intention to pray for it today.
8. To sign up or log hours, select **Member Actions Hub** in the sidebar (section 14.6).
9. Officers and Admins: to see the **Executive Summary**, select **Executive Dashboard** in the sidebar.

Expected result: Home shows the seven cards. Scroll the page to see the lower cards. After **Praying Hands**, the count goes up by 1 and the button is grey until tomorrow. **Home** has no sign-up or signature button, and no reminder link.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The verse, the feast tracker and the prayer list do not show.	The council's **Faith Center** module is off, or the organization is white-label.	Ask a Super Admin to turn on **Faith Center** on the **Feature Flags** page.
You look for the status badges.	The badges are gone. Each desk tile shows its own count and alert.	Select your desk tab (section 14.3.2).
"No member has logged hours this month yet."	No active member of the council logged hours in the current month.	No action. The card fills when members log hours.
You look for **Sign up**.	Sign-ups are on the **Member Actions Hub**.	Select **Member Actions Hub** in the sidebar (section 14.6).
Praying Hands is grey.	You prayed for that intention today.	No action. The button is active again tomorrow.
A reminder has no link.	**Home** is read only.	Open your desk tab or the alert bell.
"You are all caught up. Nothing needs your action."	No sheet waits for your signature, and you have no unread alert.	No action.
"No event or meeting today."	The council calendar has nothing on today's date.	Open the council calendar to see coming events.
The newsletter card does not show.	The council has no saved newsletter for this month or an earlier month.	Ask the Council Historian to write one (section 14.10).

14.4.1 Open a drawer on your desk

> **Who can do this:** the seat holder of the desk, the council's Admins and Super Admins. A drawer shows only when your role may open its module.

Goal: Work in an advanced module without leaving your desk.

Start point: Active Desks row → your desk.

Steps:

1. Select your desk tab.
2. Find the tile of the module. A tile with a red border has work for you.
3. Select the tile. The drawer slides out from the right.
4. Do the work in the module.
5. Select **Back to Desk Blotter**.

Expected result: The module works inside the drawer the same as on its own page.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
A drawer in section 14.3.2 is not on your desk.	Your role may not open that module, or the council switched the module off.	Ask the seat holder or a Super Admin.
The **Bank Statement Match-Window** shows a notice and no upload box.	Only the FS, the Treasurer and Super Admins can match bank statements.	Ask the Treasurer to run the match.
You want the module on a larger screen.	The drawer is narrower than the full page.	Open the module's page from the sidebar.

14.5 Release approved expenses from the Grand Knight Desk

> **Who can do this:** the council's Grand Knight, Deputy Grand Knight and Super Admins sign. The council's Admins read the desk.
>
> **Warning:** the final release sets the sheet to **Approved** and sends the sheet to payment. You cannot undo the release.

Goal: Find the sheets that wait for the final release, and release them without leaving the desk.

Start point: Active Desks row → **Grand Knight Desk**.

Steps:

1. Select the **Grand Knight Desk** tab.
2. Find the **Approved Expenses** tile. A red glowing border means that a sheet waits for your signature.
3. Select the **Approved Expenses** tile. The drawer slides out.
4. Read each sheet. Select **Final Release for Payment** on each sheet. You cannot undo the release.
5. Select **Back to Desk Blotter**.

Expected result: Each released sheet shows *"Released to the Treasurer"*. When you close the drawer, the count on the tile drops. The red border goes off when no sheet waits for you.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The **Grand Knight Desk** tab does not show.	You do not hold the Grand Knight or Deputy Grand Knight seat on this council, and you are not an Admin.	Use the **Home** tab. Ask the Grand Knight to release the sheets.
A sheet shows no release button in the drawer.	You submitted, ordered or coded that sheet (the collusion guard).	Ask a Super Admin to release the sheet.
The asset form opened after a release.	The sheet is a long-term asset.	Complete the asset form. Then select **Back to Desk Blotter** under the tab row.
The tile has a red border, but the drawer shows no button you can use.	The queue changed after the last check.	Close the drawer. The desk checks the queue again.

14.5.1 Decide motion requests from the Grand Knight Desk

> **Who can do this:** the council's Grand Knight, Deputy Grand Knight and Super Admins decide. The council's other officers read the requests and post officer advisory messages on the **Motion Request** page (Faith In Action).
>
> **Warning:** an approval puts the motion on a meeting agenda at once. You cannot undo an approval or a denial.

Goal: Approve or deny the motions that members ask to bring to the council.

Start point: Active Desks row → **Grand Knight Desk** → **Motion Requests**.

Steps:

1. Find the **Motion Requests** drawer. A red glowing border means that a request waits for your decision.
2. Select **Motion Requests**. The drawer lists waiting requests first, each with a red border.
3. Read what the motion does, why, and its financial impact.
4. Select **Officer advisory** to read and post messages with the other officers. The member does not see these messages.
5. Select **Member and Grand Knight** to message the member.
6. To approve, select **Approve and add to the agenda**. You cannot undo the approval.
7. To deny, type a note in **Note to the member**. Select **Deny request**. You cannot undo the denial.

Expected result: An approval shows the meeting and the date. The motion is on the agenda of the first Monthly meeting at least 5 days after the member submitted it, with a 5-minute slot. A denial shows *"Denied. The member sees your note."*

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The approval says the council has no Monthly meeting late enough.	The meetings are not built yet.	Build the meetings on **Recurring Meetings**. Approve again.
Deny request stays grey.	**Note to the member** is empty.	Type a short note.
The **Motion Requests** drawer is missing.	You do not hold the Grand Knight or Deputy Grand Knight seat.	Use **Motion Request** in the Faith In Action pillar to read the requests.
The **Motion Requests** drawer is missing for every officer.	The council's **Motion requests** module switch is off.	Ask a Super Admin to turn on **Motion requests** in the **Master Feature Deployment Grid**.

14.6 Check your own work on the Member Actions Hub and the Member Desk

> **Who can do this:** every signed-in member.

Goal: Do your volunteer work: sign up for shifts, see your own shifts, sheets and charity requests, and log your hours.

Start point: Sidebar → Faith In Action → **Member Actions Hub** (the `/member-actions` page) for the check-in tabs. **Active Desks** row → **Member Desk** for the shift trackers, charity requests and sheets.

Steps:

1. Select **Member Actions Hub** in the sidebar. The page opens under the heading **Member Actions Hub**. It shows only four tabs: **My active shifts**, **Registration desk**, **Fraternal roster** and **Hour ledger**.
2. Select a tab to see your coming shifts, sign up for an open shift, find the phone or email of a brother, or log your hours.
3. Open the **Member Desk** tab from the **Active Desks** row. The two shift trackers are side by side, at equal height, at the top of the desk.
4. Read **Open Shifts Needing Volunteers** on the left. The card lists the shifts in the next 30 days that still need volunteers, such as the parish parking lot shifts.
5. Select **Sign up** on a shift to take a place. The shift leaves the card.
6. Read **My shifts: next 30 days** on the right.
7. Read **My Charity Requests** under the shift trackers. The tracking steps show the stage of each request that you carry.
8. Read **My open expense sheets**. The status pill shows the stage of each sheet.
9. Select **Open my expenses** to edit a draft or submit a sheet.
10. Select **Open the Council Dashboard** for the council's service record and your own impact card.

Expected result: The hub shows the four check-in tabs. The desk lists the open shifts, your charity requests, each unpaid sheet and each coming shift. The check-in tabs show only on the hub, not on the desk.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
A paid sheet does not show.	The desk lists only sheets that are not **Reimbursed**.	Open **My Expense Reports** to see paid sheets.
A shift after 30 days does not show.	The desk lists the next 30 days only.	Open the council calendar.
My Charity Requests does not show.	The council's charity proposals module is off.	Ask a Super Admin to turn on the module on the **Feature Flags** page.
Sign up shows an error.	The shift is full, or the shift overlaps another of your shifts.	Pick another shift.
You look for the reminders or the prayer list.	They are read-only cards on **Home**.	Select **Home**.

14.7 Concept: the minutes countdown

The **Recorder Desk** lists the council's meetings from 90 days ago to 30 days ahead. This list is the **Business calendar**. Each meeting has one countdown pill.

Pill	Meaning
Not held yet	The meeting is in the future.
Due in 3 days	The meeting is over. The minutes are due in 3 days.
Due today	The minutes are due today.
2 days overdue	The due date has passed. Nobody published the minutes.
Published	The Recorder published the minutes. The countdown stops.

The due date is the meeting's last day plus the **Days after a meeting that the minutes are due** setting (section 11.2). The default is 7 days. Overdue meetings come first in the list.

14.8 Write and publish the meeting minutes

> **Who can do this:** the council's Recorder, the council's Admins and Super Admins. Other members do not see the **Recorder Desk**.
>
> **Warning: Publish minutes** shows the minutes as the council's official record.

Goal: Write the official minutes of a meeting and publish them before the due date.

Start point: Active Desks row → **Recorder Desk**.

Steps:

1. Select the **Recorder Desk** tab. Select the **Meeting Minutes Entry Desk** tile. A red border means that minutes are due.
2. Select a meeting in the **Business calendar**. Overdue meetings are at the top.
3. In **Meeting Minutes Entry Desk**, type the minutes. Start a heading with `#`. Start a bullet with `-`.
4. Select **Preview** to read the minutes as members see them. Select **Write** to go back.
5. Select **Save draft** to keep the minutes without publishing them.
6. Select **Publish minutes**. The pill changes to **Published**.

Expected result: The message *"The minutes are published."* shows. The meeting moves to the end of the list.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
Publish minutes is not available.	The minutes are blank.	Type the minutes first.
You must correct published minutes.	Published minutes stay open for changes.	Change the text, then select **Publish changes**. The first publication date stays.
You published the wrong meeting.	You selected another meeting in the list.	Select **Withdraw to draft**. The minutes go back to a draft.
The **Recorder Desk** tab does not show.	You do not hold the Recorder seat on this council, and you are not an Admin.	Ask the Grand Knight to check your seat.

14.8.1 Read the Historical Meeting Minutes Archive

> **Who can do this:** the council's Recorder, the council's Admins and Super Admins.

Goal: Read the minutes of earlier meetings before you open a session.

Start point: Active Desks row → **Recorder Desk** → **Historical Meeting Minutes Archive** (the wide tile at the top of the desk).

Steps:

1. Select the **Recorder Desk** tab.
2. Select the **Historical Meeting Minutes Archive** tile. The drawer slides out.
3. Optional: type words in **Search the minutes**, for example `budget` or a month.
4. Select a meeting in the list. The newest meeting is first.
5. Read the minutes in the reader. If the meeting has a minutes file, select **Open the minutes file**.
6. Select **Back to Desk Blotter**.

Expected result: The reader shows the published minutes of the meeting that you selected.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
"No meeting has published minutes yet."	No past meeting has published minutes or a minutes file.	Publish the minutes of a meeting (section 14.8).
A meeting with draft minutes does not show.	The archive shows only published minutes.	Publish the minutes (section 14.8).

14.8.2 Concept: the automated Old Business

The council's unfinished projects carry from one month to the next with no copy and paste.

- An open item is a line in the published minutes written as an open tick box: `- [ ] Seal the teak furniture`. A ticked line, `- [x] ...`, is resolved.
- The open items of all meetings held in the previous calendar month count. Unpublished drafts do not count. The same text counts once.
- The **Upcoming Event Agenda** card on Home lists the open items under **Council priorities · Old Business**. Nobody can change them on Home.
- **Start Live Meeting Sequence** writes the open items at the top of the new meeting's minutes draft, under **Old Business (carried from last month)**. The launch writes them once. The launch never changes published minutes.

- The **Meeting Minutes Entry Desk** shows every tick-box line of the minutes as a tick box above the text. An item that stays open in the published minutes carries again the next month.

14.9 Start the live meeting from the Recorder Desk

> **Who can do this:** the council's Recorder, the council's Admins and Super Admins.
>
> **Warning:** the start locks the quorum count to the council's Active members at that moment. You cannot change the locked count.

Goal: Open the live meeting and read the meeting PIN to the members in the hall.

Start point: Active Desks row → **Recorder Desk**.

Steps:

1. Select the **Start Live Meeting Sequence** tile. Select the meeting in the **Meeting** list.
2. Select **Start Live Meeting Sequence**. The quorum count locks. You cannot change the locked count.
3. Read the 4-digit **Meeting PIN bypass** in the navy box.
4. Read the PIN aloud. Members whose phones cannot check in by location type the PIN.
5. Read **Old Business carried from last month**. Each open item of last month's published minutes is a tick box. The items are already in this meeting's minutes draft.
6. Tick each item that the council resolves during the session. Select **Save ticks to the minutes draft**.
7. Select **Open the Live Meeting Console** → to run the agenda.

Expected result: The navy box shows the PIN and the locked quorum base. The meeting shows ● **Live now**. The minutes draft starts with **Old Business (carried from last month)** and one tick box for each open item.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The box says the PIN is still the factory PIN 0000.	Nobody changed the council's PIN.	Ask the Grand Knight to set a new PIN (section 13.5).
The meeting was already live.	Someone started the meeting before you.	No action. The first quorum count stays.
No old business is carried in.	Last month's minutes are not published, or every item in them is ticked.	Publish last month's minutes. Write open items as `- [ ] item`.
The tick boxes do not show.	This meeting's minutes are already published.	Edit the published minutes in the **Meeting Minutes Entry Desk**.

14.10 Keep the Digital Fraternal Annals Scrapbook

> **Who can do this:** the council's Council Historian, the council's Admins and Super Admins. Other members do not see the **Historian Desk**.

Goal: Write the monthly newsletter, file meeting photos and check the oral history recordings.

Start point: Active Desks row → **Historian Desk**.

Steps:

1. Select the **Historian Desk** tab.
2. Select the **Monthly Newsletters** tile. In **Monthly newsletters**, select the **Month**.
3. Optional: type a **Headline**. Without a headline, the newsletter has the name of its month, for example *"October 2026 Newsletter"*.
4. Choose the **Layout** (see the table under the steps).

5. Type the newsletter text. Leave a blank line between paragraphs.
6. Optional: select **Preview as members see it on Home** to check the layout.
7. Select **Save newsletter**.
8. To open an earlier newsletter, select its month button under the text box.
9. In **Parish event and meeting photos**, select the **Meeting**.
10. Select **Upload photo**, then pick the image file.
11. In **Oral history recordings**, select **Listen** beside a recording to play it.
12. To record your own testimonial, use the recorder under the list.

Layout	How the text shows
Paragraphs, headings and bullets	A blank line starts a new paragraph. A line that starts with ## is a section heading. A line that starts with - is a bullet. This is the default.
Plain text as typed	The text shows as one block, with your line breaks kept.

The portal removes spaces at the end of each line and closes up a run of blank lines to one blank line.

Expected result: The newsletter shows *"Newsletter saved."* A saved newsletter for this month or an earlier month shows at the top of **Home** for every member of the council. A newsletter for a later month stays off the feed until its month. The photo shows under the meeting name. The portal files the photo in the council's Google Drive under **Media / Meeting_Photos**.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
"The Drive vault is off, so the photo is kept in this browser only."	The council's Google Drive is not connected.	Ask a Super Admin to connect Google Drive (section 5.2 of the Administrator User Guide).
The recorder does not show.	You recorded your one testimonial before.	No action. Each member records one testimonial.
One month shows only one newsletter.	The council keeps one newsletter for each month.	Change the text and select **Save newsletter**. The new text replaces the old text.
The newsletter does not show on **Home**.	The newsletter is blank, or its month is later than this month.	Type the text, or wait for its month.
A ## or - shows in the newsletter.	The **Layout** is **Plain text as typed**.	Choose **Paragraphs, headings and bullets** and save again.

14.10.1 Read the Fraternal Diary Entry Logs

> **Who can do this:** the council's Council Historian, the council's Admins and Super Admins.

Goal: Read the council's diary entries without leaving the desk.

Start point: Active Desks row → **Historian Desk** → **Fraternal Diary Entry Logs**.

Steps:

1. Select the **Historian Desk** tab.
2. Select the **Fraternal Diary Entry Logs** tile. The drawer slides out.
3. Optional: select a **Fraternal year**.
4. Optional: type a name or a word in **Search the diary**.
5. Read the entries. The newest entry is first. Select **Listen to the recording** to play an oral history.
6. Select **Back to Desk Blotter**.

Expected result: The drawer lists the matching entries and their number.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
"No diary entry matches."	No entry has your words in the year you picked.	Select **Every year**, or type fewer words.
You cannot add an entry here.	The diary logs are read-only.	Write your entry on the **Team Legacy** page.

14.11 Read the Executive Dashboard page

> **Who can do this:** the council's Admins and officers, the Council Historian, and Super Admins. A Council Historian without an officer seat reads the month, the roadmap and the engagement row. The budget, mission tracking and audit panels stay with the officers.
>
> **Warning:** when the roadmap ribbon shows an overdue step, the portal sends a push alert to the council's leaders. You cannot recall an alert.

Goal: Read one month of council activity: the roadmap, the stat tiles, the budget and the audits.

Start point: Sidebar → Performance → **Executive Dashboard**. The address is `/executive-dashboard`.

Steps:

1. Read the roadmap ribbon at the top. The gold step is next. A red step is overdue.
2. Choose the **Month** and the **Year** of the **Executive Summary**.
3. Read the four stat tiles and the monthly activity overview.
4. Open a drawer under the overview to read its panel. Select the drawer title again to close the drawer.
5. Read the **Faith-in-Action Mission Tracking** card and the **Budget tracking** gauges.
6. Read the **Monthly highlights**.

The drawers, in order:

Drawer	What it holds	Who sees it
Annual Fraternal Roadmap	Nominations, elections, the July 1 term and the Three-Signature Expense Flow. **Full roadmap** ↓ on the ribbon opens this drawer.	Every reader of the page
Annual Council Goals Progress Center	The progress wheels (section 14.12)	Readers of the general ledger
Year-over-Year Trends	This fraternal year against the two before it (section 14.14)	Readers of the general ledger
No-Show Audits	Missed shifts in the last 6 months and their reasons	Officers, Admins and Super Admins

Expected result: The page shows the **Executive Summary** for the month. Each drawer opens in place. The **Active Desks** row stays under the header.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The **Executive Dashboard** link does not show.	You do not hold an officer seat or the Council Historian role, and you are not an Admin.	Ask a council Admin.
The **Shifts awaiting hours** audit is not on the page.	The audit moved to the **Grand Knight Desk**.	Open **Active Desks** → **Grand Knight Desk** → **Shifts Awaiting Hours**.

Problem	Cause	Fix
The **Top 5 Volunteers Leaderboard** or the **Financial ledger** table is not on the page.	Sprint 10 removed both from this page.	Read the leaderboard on the **Council Dashboard**. Read the month's funds on the **Net balance** tile.
The budget gauges do not show.	Your seat does not review the budget.	Ask the Grand Knight or the Financial Secretary.

14.12 Concept: the Annual Council Goals Progress Center

The **Annual Council Goals Progress Center** is a card on the **Executive Dashboard** page. The card compares the council's targets for one fraternal year (July 1 to June 30) with the council's records.

Wheel	Target	What the portal counts
Funds raised	Dollars	The funds raised at the council's events in the fraternal year. The count matches the funds raised on the **Net balance** tile, month by month.
New members	Members	The council's members whose join date falls in the fraternal year.
Service hours	Hours	The hours members logged at council events and activities in the fraternal year.
Rosaries	Rosaries	The rosaries that the council's members logged in the **Faith Center** tally.
Hours of adoration	Hours	The hours of adoration that the council's members logged in the tally.
Confessions	Confessions	The confessions that the council's members logged in the tally.

Each wheel fills with navy as the council moves toward the target. The percent shows in the middle. A wheel at 100% or more turns gold and shows **Goal reached**. A wheel with no target shows **No target set**.

The devotional tally has no dates. The three spiritual wheels count every devotion that members logged, not only the devotions of the fraternal year. A white-label organization does not see the three spiritual wheels.

The goals card and the **Year-over-Year Trends** card show money. Only the council's officers, the council's Admins and Super Admins see the two cards. A Council Historian without an officer seat does not see the two cards.

14.13 Set the council's annual goals

> **Who can do this:** the Grand Knight (GK), the Deputy Grand Knight (DGK), the council's Admins and Super Admins. Other readers see the wheels only.
>
> **Warning:** the goals of a fraternal year lock for good on its July 1. Nobody can change the goals after that date. See section 16.

Goal: Save the six targets of one fraternal year.

Start point: Sidebar → Performance → **Executive Dashboard** → **Annual Council Goals Progress Center**.

Steps:

1. Choose the year in **Fraternal year**.
2. Select **Set targets**. When the year already has targets, the button reads **Edit targets**.
3. Enter each target. Enter the hours in steps of 0.25.
4. Select **Save targets**.

Expected result: The form closes. Each wheel shows the new target and the new percent.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The **Set targets** button does not show.	You do not hold the GK or DGK seat, and you are not an Admin.	Ask the Grand Knight.
The card shows **Locked July 1** and no **Edit targets** button.	The fraternal year started. The goals are read-only.	Set the next year's goals before its July 1. See section 16.2.
The portal refuses the hours target.	The hours target is not a multiple of 0.25.	Enter the hours in quarter hours, for example `2500.25`.
The **Funds raised** wheel stays at 0%.	No event of the fraternal year has funds raised recorded.	Record the funds raised in the **Post-event Ledger**.

14.14 Read the Year-over-Year Trends

> **Who can do this:** the council's officers, the council's Admins and Super Admins.

Goal: Compare the funds raised and the volunteer hours of the current fraternal year with the 2 years before it.

Start point: Sidebar → Performance → **Executive Dashboard** → **Year-over-Year Trends**.

Steps:

1. Read the **Funds raised by month** chart. Each line is one fraternal year, from July to June. The current year is a solid navy line. The year before is a dashed gold line. The year before that is a dotted grey line.
2. Point to a month on a chart. A box shows the figure of each year for that month.
3. Read the **Volunteer hours by month** chart.
4. Read the table under the charts. The table splits the funds raised into **Cash** and **Electronic**. The table splits the hours into **Event hours** and **Activity hours**.
5. Select **Show the monthly figures as a table** to read every month as numbers.

Expected result: The card shows the two charts and the table. The line under the table gives the change of the current year against the year before, as a percent.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
A line stays flat at 0.	The council recorded no funds or hours in that fraternal year.	Record the results in the **Post-event Ledger**.
The note says the figures were computed in this browser.	The portal server did not answer for your sign-in. The card shows the same figures from your browser.	No action is necessary. To use the server, sign out and sign in again.

15. The Shared Equipment Library and the colour-coded calendar

15.1 Concept: the Shared Equipment Library

The **Shared Equipment Library** lets councils lend equipment to each other. Tents, sound systems and fryers are examples. Each item is an asset in the council's asset inventory.

Status	Meaning
Available	A brother council can borrow the item.
Checked out	A brother council has the item. The library shows the borrower, the borrowing council and the expected return date.
Overdue	The item is checked out, and the expected return date is past.
Paused	The council holds the item out of the library for now, for example for a repair.

Every active member reads the shared inventory directory. A member sees the items of the member's own council. A member also sees the items of each affiliated council when both councils have loaner library sharing on. See section 16.8. The directory never shows the cost, the serial number, the notes or the storage place of an item.

Only the council's GK, the council's DGK and Super Admins lend the council's items. Admins, the Financial Secretary and the Trustees do not lend items.

15.2 Find an item to borrow

> **Who can do this:** every active member.

Goal: Find an item that a brother council lends.

Start point: Sidebar → Resources → **Shared Equipment Library**. The address is `/inventory/loaner-library`.

Steps:

1. Read the **Shared inventory directory**. Available items show first.
2. Read the **Owning council** of the item.
3. Call the Grand Knight of the owning council to ask for the item.

Expected result: You know which council has the item and when the item is free.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The directory is empty.	Your council and its affiliated councils have listed no item yet.	Ask your Grand Knight to list the council's equipment.
A brother council's items do not show.	The councils are not affiliated, or one council has sharing off.	Ask your Grand Knight. See section 16.8.

15.3 Lend, pause and check in the council's items

> **Who can do this:** the council's GK, the council's DGK and Super Admins.
>
> **Warning:** affiliated councils see an item as soon as you put the item in the library, while both councils have sharing on.

Goal: Put an item in the library, check the item out to a borrower and log its return.

Start point: Active Desks → **Grand Knight Desk** → **Shared Equipment Library**. The same controls are on Sidebar → Resources → **Shared Equipment Library**, under the directory.

Steps:

1. Find the item in **Loaner library: our items**.
2. Select the **In the loaner library** switch. The switch shows **On**. The item shows **Available**.
3. To lend the item, select **Check out**.
4. Enter the **Borrower**, the **Borrowing council** and the **Expected return** date. The date must be today or later.
5. Select **Check out** in the form. The item shows **Checked out**.
6. When the item comes back, select **Log return**. The item shows **Available** again.
7. To hold an available item out of the library, select **Pause (hold out of the pool)**. Select **Resume lending** to put the item back.
8. To take the item out of the library, select the **In the loaner library** switch again. The switch shows **Off**.

Expected result: The **Shared inventory directory** shows the item with its new status.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The **In the loaner library** switch is grey.	The item is checked out.	Select **Log return** first.
The item is not in the list.	The item is disposed or lost, or the council has no asset record for the item.	Approve the purchase as a long-term council asset. See section 12.
The check-out form refuses the date.	The expected return date is in the past.	Enter today or a later date.

15.4 Concept: the colour-coded calendar

The **Visual Master Calendar** colours each event by the Supreme mission area of the event's local category.

Mission area	Colour	Local categories
Faith	Gold	Faith Building, Evangelization
Community	Blue	Service, Parish Community, Fundraising
Family	Green	Fellowship
Life	Red	Life

Meetings stay solid navy. An event with a category outside the four areas keeps the white block.

On a coloured block, the shift warnings change form:

- A shift that starts within 48 hours puts a red outline around the block. The outline pulses.
- A shift that still needs volunteers puts the ⚑ flag before the event name.

The legend above the calendar lists every colour and mark.

15.5 Message all attendants of an event

> **Who can do this:** council officers, Admins, Super Admins and the event's owner.
>
> **Warning:** The message goes at once to every member signed up for any shift of the event. You cannot recall it.

Goal: Send one message to everyone signed up for an event.

Start point: Sidebar → Faith In Action → **Visual Master Calendar** → a day with the event.

Steps:

1. Select the day. The details card opens beside the calendar.
2. Under the event, select **Message All Attendants**.

3. Enter the message.
4. Select **Send**. The message goes out at once.

Expected result: The message *"Sent to … attendants."* shows. Replies arrive in **Council Messages & Alerts**.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
Message All Attendants does not show.	Nobody else is signed up yet, or you are not an officer, an Admin or the event's owner.	Wait for sign-ups, or ask the event's owner.

---

16. Planning workflows and bilateral council affiliations

16.1 Concept: the Annual Budget Planner

The council plans each fraternal year in the two months before the year starts. The fraternal year runs from July 1 to June 30.

Step	When	What happens
Draft	May 1 - May 31	Leadership drafts the Annual Council Goals and the budget lines.
Review	June 1 - June 30	Leadership checks the goals and the budget. Leadership marks each one reviewed.
Lock	July 1	The year starts. The goals become read-only for good. The budget figures lock.
Final vote	By July 10	The council votes the budget. The vote locks every budget line.

The goals and the budget each show one status:

Status	Meaning
Draft	Nobody marked the goals or the budget reviewed yet.
Reviewed	Leadership marked the goals or the budget reviewed. Leadership can still change the goals until July 1.
Locked	The year started (goals), or the council voted (budget).

The July 1 goals lock has no exception. Nobody can change the goals of a started year, not even a Super Admin. Set the goals before July 1.

The budget vote must be recorded by July 10. After July 10, only a Super Admin can record the vote, with the override.

The **Annual Budget Planner** banner leads the **Council Wide Settings** page. The banner shows the four steps and marks the current step **(now)**. Under the steps, the banner shows the year's goals and the budget status.

16.2 Draft and review the year's goals

> **Who can do this:** the Grand Knight (GK), the Deputy Grand Knight (DGK), the council's Admins and Super Admins.

Goal: Save the targets of the next fraternal year and mark them reviewed before July 1.

Start point: Sidebar → Finances → **FINANCIAL REPORTS** → **Annual Budget Center** → **Annual Budget Planner**.

Steps:

1. Choose the year in **Fraternal year**. The next year shows first.
2. Select **Set targets**. When the year already has targets, the button reads **Edit targets**.
3. Enter each target. Enter the hours in steps of 0.25.
4. Select **Save targets**.
5. In June, check the targets with leadership.
6. Select **Mark goals reviewed**.

Expected result: The goals show the **Reviewed** status. The targets show as information blocks.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The **Set targets** button does not show.	The year started on July 1. The goals are locked.	No fix is possible. Set the next year's goals before its July 1.
The portal says the goals are locked.	Today is July 1 or later in that fraternal year.	Choose the next fraternal year.
Mark goals reviewed does not show.	The year has no saved goals, or the goals are already reviewed.	Save the targets first.

16.3 Mark the budget reviewed

> **Who can do this:** the council's Admins, the Financial Secretary, the Treasurer, the Designated Budget Director and Super Admins.

Goal: Record that leadership reviewed the drafted budget in June.

Start point: Sidebar → Finances → **FINANCIAL REPORTS** → **Annual Budget Center** → **Annual Budget Planner** → **Annual budget**.

Steps:

1. Choose the year in **Fraternal year**.
2. Select **Open the budget** to read the budget lines.
3. Go back to **Council Wide Settings**.
4. Select **Mark budget reviewed**.

Expected result: The budget shows the **Reviewed** status.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
Mark budget reviewed does not show.	The drafting window is closed, the budget has no lines, or the budget is already reviewed.	Mark the budget reviewed between May 1 and June 30.

16.4 Record the council's budget vote by July 10

> **Who can do this:** the council's Admins, the Financial Secretary, the Treasurer and Super Admins.
>
> **Warning:** the vote locks every budget line. You cannot undo the vote.

Goal: Record the council's vote on the budget at the July meeting.

Start point: Sidebar → Finances → **FINANCIAL REPORTS** → **Annual Budget Center**.

Steps:

1. Choose the fraternal year.
2. Select **Approve & Finalize Entire Budget**.
3. Confirm the approval. You cannot undo this.

Expected result: The budget shows **Approved**. The planning banner shows the budget as **Locked**.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The portal says the vote deadline passed.	Today is after July 10.	Ask a Super Admin to record the vote with the override.

16.5 Concept: bilateral council affiliations

Two councils of the same state can affiliate. An affiliation is a handshake between the two councils:

1. An Admin, the GK or the DGK of one council sends an invite. The invite shows **Invite sent**.
2. The GK or the DGK of the other council selects **Accept** or **Decline**.
3. After **Accept**, the two councils are **Affiliated**. The portal records the date.

A council Admin can send an invite but cannot accept one. Only the GK or the DGK of the invited council accepts the invite.

The **Connected Councils** directory lists the other councils of your state. The nearest council shows first. The portal measures the distance between the councils' stored meeting points. A council without a meeting point follows in district order. Councils of your own district show first.

A Super Admin enters the district number on the **Councils** page.

16.6 Send an affiliation invite

> **Who can do this:** the council's Admins, the GK, the DGK and Super Admins.
>
> **Warning:** the other council sees the invite at once.

Goal: Invite a nearby council of your state to affiliate.

Start point: Active Desks → Grand Knight Desk → Connected Councils folder. A council Admin without a desk uses the page at `/system-settings/affiliations`.

Steps:

1. Find the council in the list of councils in your state. Use **Find a council** or **My district only** to shorten the list.
2. Select **Send invite**.

Expected result: The council shows **Invite sent** with today's date.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
A council is not in the list.	The council is in another state.	Affiliations stay inside your state.
The portal says an invite is already pending.	One of the two councils already sent an invite.	Wait for the other council's answer.

16.7 Accept or decline an affiliation invite

> **Who can do this:** the GK, the DGK and Super Admins.

Goal: Answer an invite that another council sent to your council.

Start point: Active Desks → **Grand Knight Desk → Affiliation Invites**. The same invites show at the top of **Connected Councils**.

Steps:

1. Read the council name, the distance and the invite date.
2. Select **Accept** to affiliate. Select **Decline** to refuse the invite.

Expected result: After **Accept**, the council shows **Affiliated** with today's date. After **Decline**, the council shows **Declined**. Either council can send a new invite later.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The **Accept** button does not show.	You are an Admin, not the GK or the DGK.	Ask the GK to accept the invite.

16.8 Concept: loaner library sharing

Each council has a **Shared Equipment Library Sharing** switch on **Council Wide Settings**. The switch is off for a new council.

Your members always see your own council's items. A brother council's item shows in your library only when all three rules are true:

Rule	Where to set it
The two councils are **Affiliated**.	**Connected Councils**
Your council has sharing on.	**Council Wide Settings** → **Feature Controls** → **Shared Equipment Library Sharing**
The brother council has sharing on.	The brother council's **Council Wide Settings**

16.9 Switch loaner library sharing on

> **Who can do this:** the council's officers, the council's Admins and Super Admins.

Goal: Share your council's items with affiliated councils, and see their items.

Start point: Sidebar → System Settings → **Council Wide Settings** → **Feature Controls** → **Shared Equipment Library Sharing**.

Steps:

1. Select the switch. The switch shows **Sharing is on**.

Expected result: The **Shared inventory directory** shows the items of each affiliated council that also has sharing on.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
An affiliated council's items do not show.	The other council has sharing off.	Ask the other council's GK to switch sharing on.

17. The Operations Knowledge Vault

17.1 Concept: the Operations Knowledge Vault

Officers change every year. The **Operations Knowledge Vault** keeps what each leader learned, so the next chairman does not start over.

Each entry is one note under one governance tag:

Tag	What to write
Recruiting	Membership drives, parish contacts and what worked.
Treasury	Bank signers, deadlines and money procedures.
Clergy	How the pastor and the chaplain like to work with the council.
Compliance	Supreme forms, due dates and audit steps.
Devotional	Prayer, rosary and spiritual programs.
Logistics	Equipment, storage places, keys and suppliers.

The portal signs each entry. The signature shows your name and your seat, for example **Tom McDougal, Grand Knight**. The portal also records the date. You cannot edit or delete an entry after you save it.

Who	Write entries	Read the archive
Grand Knight (GK) and Deputy Grand Knight (DGK)	Yes, for their council	Yes, every council
The council's Admins	Yes, for their council	Yes, every council
Other officers of the council	No	Yes, every council
Super Admins	Yes, for any council	Yes, every council
Other members	No	No

17.1.1 Concept: one archive for every council

The archive holds the entries of every council on the platform. An officer in one council can read what a brother council learned.

Each entry shows a council badge, for example **Council 2042 · St. Anthony Council**. The portal writes the badge when the entry is saved. The badge of your own council is navy. The badge of a brother council is white.

The **Filter by My Home Council Only** box hides the entries of other councils. Clear the box to see every council again.

17.1.2 Concept: the content guard and the Charter Advisory Warning

The archive is read by officers of every council. For this reason, the archive checks each entry two times: while you type, and again when you save.

The content guard refuses an entry that contains foul language, hateful language or partisan political words. The red message names the kind of language. It does not repeat the word.

The Charter compliance gate compares the entry with the non-partisan and non-profit rules of the Order. A matching rule opens the **Charter Advisory Warning** panel under the editor. The panel has two levels:

Level	Panel colour	What the rule covers	Can you save?
Advisory	Navy	Campaign signs at council events, the Order's name or emblem in politics, ballot measures and lobbying, cash without receipts.	Yes. Read the rule first.

Level	Panel colour	What the rule covers	Can you save?
Severe (**SAVING IS BLOCKED**)	Red	Endorsing or opposing a candidate for public office, council money to a campaign, party or political action committee, private use of council funds.	No. **Save signed entry** stays grey until you change the text.

Each rule in the panel shows the **Source Authority**. The endorsement and campaign-money rules also quote the U.S. tax law for charitable funds (Internal Revenue Code § 501(c)(3)).

The panel does not quote section numbers of the Charter, Constitution and Laws of the Knights of Columbus. The portal does not hold that text. Confirm the exact section with your State Deputy.

The gate looks for words and phrases. It does not understand meaning. A rule can match a note that only warns against the act, for example "Do not endorse a candidate for mayor". Reword the note, for example "The council stays out of election campaigns".

17.2 Write an archive entry

> **Who can do this:** the GK, the DGK, the council's Admins and Super Admins. Other members do not see this card.
>
> **Warning:** you cannot edit or delete an entry after you save it.

Goal: Save a signed note for the leaders who come after you.

Start point: Active Desks → **Grand Knight Desk** → **Operations Knowledge Vault** drawer → **Operations Knowledge Vault · New Entry**.

Steps:

1. Select a tag in **Governance tag**.
2. Write the note in **Entry**. Use `#` for a heading, `-` for a bullet and `**text**` for bold text.
3. Select **Preview** to check the note. Select **Write** to change the note.
4. Read the **Charter Advisory Warning** panel if it shows. Change the text when the panel is red.
5. Select **Save signed entry**. You cannot undo this.

Expected result: The card shows a message with the tag and your signature. The entry shows first under **Latest entries**.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
Save signed entry is grey.	The entry is empty.	Write the note first.
Save signed entry is grey and the panel says **SAVING IS BLOCKED**.	The text matches a severe Charter rule.	Change the words the panel names.
A red message says the entry contains foul, hateful or partisan language.	The content guard found a blocked word.	Remove the word or reword the note.
The save fails with "crosses the Order's non-partisan or non-profit boundaries".	The portal checked the text again at save.	Change the text and save again.
The **New Entry** form does not show in the drawer.	You are not the GK, the DGK or an Admin.	Ask the GK to write the entry.
The note is cut off.	An entry holds at most 8,000 characters.	Split the note into two entries.

17.3 Search the Operations Knowledge Vault

> **Who can do this:** the officers and Admins of every council, and Super Admins. Other members do not see this page.

Goal: Find the notes past leaders of your council, or of brother councils, saved about one subject or one year.

Start point: Sidebar → System Settings → **Operations Knowledge Vault**. The address is `/system-settings/knowledge-archive`. The **Open the archive** link on the vault card opens the same page.

Steps:

1. Select **Filter by My Home Council Only** to see only your council's entries. Clear the box to see every council.
2. Select a tag in **Governance tag**. Select **Every tag** to see all tags.
3. Select a year in **Fraternal year**. A fraternal year runs from July 1 to June 30.
4. Type words in **Search** to find a note, a signature or a council name.
5. Select a row to read the full note. Select the row again to close the note.

Expected result: The grid shows the matching entries, newest first. Each row shows the date, the fraternal year, the council badge, the tag and the signature.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The grid says **No entry matches these filters.**	No entry has all the selected filters.	Select **Every tag** or **Every year**, or clear **Search**.
Entries from other councils show.	The archive shows every council.	Select **Filter by My Home Council Only**.
Your council's entries do not show.	The search words or filters exclude them.	Clear **Search**, and select **Every tag** and **Every year**.
You cannot add an entry here.	This page is read-only.	Write entries in the **Operations Knowledge Vault** drawer of the **Grand Knight Desk** (section 17.2).

18. Revenue split profiles

18.1 Concept: revenue split profiles

Some fundraisers use parish property, for example the cathedral parking lot. The council then shares part of the money with the parish. Since Sprint 10 Revision 3.2 every revenue split comes from the chart of accounts. The parish split engine, its **Parish Fundraiser Revenue Split Console** and its **Church Disbursement Requests** are gone.

Way to split	Where	What it does
Split profile	**Treasurer Desk** → **General Ledger** → **Edit split** on a Revenue account	Every posting to the account is shared out to its destination accounts by percentage, on every screen that posts.
Event Split Override	**Treasurer Desk** → **High-Volume Batch Transaction Coder** → **Override Event Split**	One posting of one event's gifts is shared out by the shares you choose. Nothing is saved to the account.

The destinations of a split are other Revenue accounts of the council. Since schema 103, a destination can also be an affiliated council. That council's share goes to a **Due to Sister Council** account in this council's own books. The shares total exactly 100. The last destination takes any rounding cent. The St. Mary's pilot data has the revenue line **Parish Fundraiser Share** for the parish's part.

18.2 Share fundraiser revenue with a split profile

> **Who can do this:** the council's Treasurer and Super Admins.

Goal: Share each posting to a Revenue account, for example the parish's share of a fundraiser, by percentages.

Start point: Active Desks row → **Treasurer Desk** → **General Ledger** → **Edit split** on the Revenue account.

Steps:

1. Select **Edit split** on the Revenue account that receives the fundraiser's money.
2. Add a destination account and its percentage for each share, for example **Parish Fundraiser Share** at `50`.
3. Make the percentages total exactly 100.
4. Save the split.

Expected result: The account shows as a split account. Every posting to it is shared out to the destination accounts.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
Edit split is missing on an account.	Only Revenue accounts can split.	Choose a Revenue account.
You want to split one event's gifts only once.	A split profile applies to every posting.	Use **Override Event Split** in the batch coder (18.3).

18.3 Share one event's gifts once in the batch coder

> **Who can do this:** the council's Treasurer and Super Admins.

Goal: Code one event's electronic gifts and share that one posting, without saving a split on the account.

Start point: Active Desks row → **Treasurer Desk** → **High-Volume Batch Transaction Coder**.

Steps:

1. Tick the gifts of one event.

2. Choose the line in **Revenue GL line for the selection**, for example **Parking Fundraising**.
3. Select **Override Event Split**.
4. Set each **Destination** and its **Share (%)**, for example **Parking Fundraising** at `50` and **Parish Fundraiser Share** at `50`. Select **Add destination** for another share.
5. Select **Code selected to this Revenue line**.

Expected result: The message names each share, for example *"Event Split Override: $75.00 to Parking Fundraising, $75.00 to Parish Fundraiser Share."*

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
Override Event Split is unavailable.	The ticked gifts belong to more than one event, or no Revenue line is chosen.	Tick one event's gifts and choose the line.

18.4 Send a share to an affiliated council

> **Who can do this:** the council's Treasurer and Super Admins.
>
> **Warning:** After you save, every new posting to the account sends this share. Postings already made do not change.

Goal: Send a part of each posting to an affiliated council, for example for a joint fundraiser.

Start point: Active Desks row → **Treasurer Desk** → **General Ledger** → **Edit split** on the Revenue account.

Steps:

1. Select **Edit split** on the Revenue account that receives the money.
2. In a **Destination** list, choose the council under **Affiliated councils (Due to Sister Council)**.
3. Type its **Share (%)**, for example `40`.
4. Make the percentages total exactly 100.
5. Save the split.

Expected result: The chart shows a new Liability account named **Due to Sister Council - Council** and the council number. This account has the **Sister council clearing** tag. Each posting puts the council's share in this account. Pay the affiliated council from this account. The portal writes nothing to the other council's books.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The council is not in the list.	Only councils with an active affiliation show.	Ask the Grand Knight to complete the affiliation first.
"… is not an active affiliate …"	The affiliation ended or is still pending.	Choose another destination, or finish the affiliation.

---

19. The global search bar

19.1 Concept: the global search bar

The portal header has a search bar between the council name and the **Messaging** menu. The search bar is on every page.

Type 2 or more letters. A list of results opens under the search bar. The results are in four kinds:

Kind	What the result opens
Page	A portal page that your role can open. The search never shows a page that your sidebar does not show.
Event	One of your council's events. The result opens the **Event Planner** if you can plan events. Otherwise, the result opens the **Visual Master Calendar**.
Member	An active member of your council. Every member gets member results. The result opens the **Council Roster**.
Help	The **Online Help Center** and the **Interactive Help Desk**, with your words already in their search box. The two help results are always at the end of the list.

Each kind shows at most 5 results.

Restricted pages: each time you type, the search reads the permissions of your role again. The finance pages (the general ledger, the balance sheet, the finance dashboard and the Trustee audit), the payment desks (**FS Expense Audit Queue**, **GK Expense Authorize**, **Leadership Auditing Queue** and **Disbursed Check Registry**), **Donations History**, the Supreme roster sync, and the council and platform settings pages are restricted. The search shows a restricted page only when your role can open that page. **Annual Budget Center** is not restricted: every member can read the budget.

19.2 Find a page, an event, a member or a help answer

> **Who can do this:** every signed-in member. Member results open the **Council Roster**.

Goal: Open a page, an event, a member or a help answer from the header.

Start point: The search bar in the portal header.

Steps:

1. Select the search bar.
2. Type 2 or more letters, for example `budget` or `fish fry`.
3. Select a result. Or use the up and down arrow keys, then push **Enter**.

Expected result: The page of the result opens. A help result opens its help page with your words already searched.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
No list opens.	You typed fewer than 2 letters.	Type more letters.
Only the two help results show.	No page, event or member name starts with your words.	Try fewer or different words. Or select a help result.
No member results show.	The member is not active, or belongs to another council.	Open the **Council Roster** and choose the council.
A page you expect does not show.	Your role cannot open the page, or the council's module is off.	Ask a council Admin.

20. The Navigation Guide screen

The **Navigation Guide** is a screen that explains your own sidebar. Use it when you do not know where a page is, or what a link does. This chapter explains how the screen works. Section 1.8 is the short tutorial.

20.1 Concept: where the Navigation Guide is

The **Navigation Guide** link is at the top of the sidebar, above the seven pillars. Every signed-in member sees the link. The screen opens at `/navigation-guide`.

The screen is built again each time it opens. It reads three things:

- Your member type: Member, Admin or Super Admin.
- Your officer roles, for example Grand Knight or Treasurer.
- The modules that your council has switched on (section 2 of the Super Admin System Manual).

The screen then lists only the links and desks that you can open. A page that your role cannot open is not on the screen. A module that your council switched off is not on the screen.

20.2 Concept: the guide changes with your role

The screen has two depths: **Summary** and **Full**. Your role sets the depth. You cannot change the depth yourself.

You sign in as	Depth	What each link shows	What each desk shows
Member (a plain volunteer)	Summary	One short sentence	One short sentence. No drawers.
Council Officer	Full	The leader sentence and the sidebar pillar of the link, for example *sidebar: Finances*	The sentence and a list of every drawer of the desk
Council Admin	Full	The leader sentence and the sidebar pillar	The sentence and every drawer of each desk that you hold
Super Admin	Full	The leader sentence and the sidebar pillar, for every page	The sentence and every drawer, including the **Super Admin Desk** cabinets

The first line of the screen tells you your depth. For example, *You are signed in as: Council Officer (Grand Knight)*. Under it, the overview says *You see the full map* or *You see a short summary*.

Example: A plain member opens **Your desks** and reads one sentence about the **Member Desk**. The Grand Knight opens the same block and also reads each drawer of the **Grand Knight Desk**, such as **Approved Expenses** and **Council Election Workflow**.

20.3 Concept: every category group starts closed

The screen opens with all of its category groups closed. Only the **Overview** block is open. The overview tells you who you are signed in as and explains the menus in the top bar.

The closed groups show only their titles and the number of links in each. You can read all of the titles on one screen, so you can find the right group fast. Select a title to open a group. Select the title again to close the group.

The screen does not remember which groups you opened. Each visit starts closed again.

20.4 Concept: the sidebar-first order

The screen follows the sidebar first, then the rest of the portal. The groups are in this order:

1. **Overview**: who you are and the top bar menus. Open on arrival.
2. **The sidebar categories**: **Dashboard**, **Calendars**, **Rosters**, **Vetting**, **Ledgers**, **Archives** and **Settings, planning and help**. A category with no link for you is left out.

3. **Your desks**: the tabs of your **Active Desks** row.
4. **Your time limits**: the time windows and reminder days in force for you now, read from your council's settings.
5. **Phone app tabs**: the phone tabs that your council has switched on.

The screen has three levels:

Level	What it is	Example
1. Group	A closed block with a title and the number of its links	**Ledgers**
2. Link or desk	A page name that you can select, with its sentence	**General Ledger** · *sidebar: Finances*
3. Drawer	A drawer of a desk, listed under the desk (full depth only)	**Approved Expenses** under **Grand Knight Desk**

Select a link name to open that page. Select a desk name to open that desk tab on the **Active Desks** row.

20.5 Find a page with the Navigation Guide

> **Who can do this:** every signed-in member.

Goal: Find a page or a desk drawer that you cannot locate in the sidebar.

Start point: Sidebar → **Navigation Guide** (at the top, above the pillars).

Steps:

1. Select **Navigation Guide**. All of the category groups are closed. Only **Overview** is open.
2. Read the first line. The line shows your role and your depth.
3. Scan the group titles. Select the group that matches your task, for example **Ledgers** for money records.
4. Read the sentence under each link. Officers also read the sidebar pillar of each link.
5. Select the link name. The page opens.
6. To find a drawer, open **Your desks**. Officers, Admins and Super Admins read every drawer under each desk. Select the desk name to open the desk.

Expected result: The page or desk opens. The sidebar marks the page as the open page.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
A desk shows no drawers.	You signed in as a plain member, so the guide shows the summary depth.	No action. Drawers show only for officers, Admins and Super Admins.
A group that you opened is closed again.	The screen starts with every category group closed on each visit.	Select the group title again.
A page that a colleague uses is not on the screen.	Your role cannot open the page.	Ask a council Admin about your role.
A whole module is missing.	Your council switched the module off (section 2 of the Super Admin System Manual).	Ask a Super Admin to switch the module on.

21. Testing and training sandboxes

21.1 Concept: the three record sets

The desktop program keeps three separate sets of records on every laptop. At start-up it asks which set to open.

Choice at start-up	File	Banner at the top of every page	Who sees your saves
Production	`central-hub-vault.db`	None	The council: these are the real records.
Testing (hall Wi-Fi)	`testing-sandbox.db`	Amber **Testing Mode** banner	The other testing laptops in the same hall, while you share its Wi-Fi
Training (practice)	`training-playground.db`	Cobalt blue **Training Mode** banner	Nobody. The file is erased and built again at every start.

A save in one set never shows in another set. Practice in Testing or Training. Do real work only in Production.

21.2 Practice with other officers in the same hall (Testing Mode)

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** Every officer. Each laptop must have the desktop program and the same testing key file (a council Admin copies it, Administrator User Guide 18.4).
>
> **Warning:** testing laptops share saves only while they are on the same Wi-Fi at the same time.

Goal: Practice a workflow together, for example a cash count or an expense sign-off, without touching the real records.

Start point: Start the desktop program.

Steps:

1. Connect the laptop to the hall Wi-Fi.
2. At the question *"Which records do you want to open?"*, select **Testing (hall Wi-Fi)**.
3. Make sure the amber **Testing Mode** banner shows at the top of the page.
4. Sign in with your own account and do the practice work.

Expected result: Your saves show on the other testing laptops in the hall within a few seconds.

Working alone (standalone): away from the hall, or with no Wi-Fi, Testing Mode still works. Your saves are kept in `testing-sandbox.db` on your laptop only. They are not sent later: a laptop that was away does not receive the saves it missed, and the other laptops do not receive its saves. Do shared practice while every laptop is in the hall.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
Another officer's save does not show.	The laptops are on different Wi-Fi networks, or the passphrase is not set.	Join the same Wi-Fi. Ask a council Admin to set the passphrase.
Two laptops show different records.	One laptop worked alone for a while.	Practice from a fresh start, or keep using one laptop for that work.

21.3 Practice alone with a training account (Training Mode)

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** Everyone. No account of your own is needed.
>
> **Warning:** everything in Training Mode is erased when the program starts again.

Goal: Learn a role on practice records: ten practice members, three upcoming practice fundraisers and three training cash boxes.

Start point: Start the desktop program.

Steps:

1. At the question *"Which records do you want to open?"*, select **Training (practice)**.
2. Make sure the cobalt blue **Training Mode** banner shows at the top of the page.
3. Under the sign-in card, find the **Training Profile Selection Board**.
4. Select the role to practice. The program signs in at once.

Board button	Email	Password
Council Admin	`admin@training`	`training`
Grand Knight	`gk@training`	`training`
Financial Secretary	`fs@training`	`training`
Treasurer	`tr@training`	`training`
Recorder	`rec@training`	`training`
Council Historian	`hist@training`	`training`
Member	`mem@training`	`training`

Expected result: The desks and sidebar of that role open on the practice records. The Council Admin account signs in without a sign-in code in Training Mode only.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The board is not shown.	The program opened Production or Testing.	Restart the program. Select **Training (practice)**.
Yesterday's practice work is gone.	Training Mode starts fresh at every start.	No fix is needed. Use Testing Mode to keep practice work.
A training email does not sign in on Production.	The training accounts exist only in Training Mode.	Restart in Training Mode.

Manual map

The chapters of the four officer manuals. A shared task is printed in each manual that lists its chapter.

Administrator User Guide

- 1. Roles and access
- 2. Module feature flags
- 3. The Google Drive archive vault
- 4. SOP publishing
- 5. Lookup tables, service connections and global lists
- 6. Data protection rules
- 7. Troubleshooting reference
- 8. Council Wide Settings
- 9. View As Member and remote help
- 10. Feedback loops
- 11. Run a room pilot on the hub laptop
- 12. Reset the database to the seed data

- 13. Network addresses, ports and configuration keys
- 14. Firewall clearance
- 15. The software bill of materials (SBOM)
- 16. The Admin Desk
- 18. Testing and training sandboxes
- Appendix: QR code files

Executive Governance Manual

- 1. Left navigation map
- 2. Governance
- 3. Faith In Action
- 4. Finances: release, vetting and endorsement
- 5. Performance
- 6. Resources
- 7. Find members with a trade skill
- 8. Automated messages reference
- 9. Member engagement
- 10. Flagged hours review
- 11. Council Wide Settings
- 12. Asset photos and remote help
- 13. Annual roadmap, meeting check-in and meeting photos
- 14. The Active Desks dashboard
- 15. The Shared Equipment Library and the colour-coded calendar
- 16. Planning workflows and bilateral council affiliations
- 17. The Operations Knowledge Vault
- 18. Parish fundraiser split setup
- 19. The global search bar
- 20. The Navigation Guide screen
- 21. Testing and training sandboxes

Financial Secretary Manual

- 1. Finances: the Financial Secretary's work
- 2. Members, setup codes, the Supreme roster sync and Supreme forms
- 3. The roster lifecycle
- 4. Payment methods, checks, asset photos and remote help
- 5. The Three-Signature Expense Flow
- 6. The Active Desks and the Financial Secretary Desk
- 7. The budget review and vote
- 8. The Operations Knowledge Vault
- 9. Revenue split profiles
- 10. Payment account ownership
- 11. Budget categories and payment account names
- 12. Testing and training sandboxes

Treasurer Manual

- 1. Double-entry bookkeeping primer
- 2. Finances: the Treasurer's work
- 3. Supreme forms
- 4. Payment methods, checks, revenue, asset photos and remote help
- 5. The Three-Signature Expense Flow
- 6. The Active Desks and the Treasurer Desk
- 7. The budget review and vote
- 8. The Operations Knowledge Vault
- 9. Parish fundraiser splits
- 10. Batch coding and cash box audits
- 11. Account ownership and parish-held revenue
- 12. Split accounts, budget categories and payment account names
- 13. Testing and training sandboxes

Disclaimer

Informational notice. This guide describes the Fraternal Council Archives™ for the council officers and administrators who run it. It is provided for information only. It is not an official publication of the Knights of Columbus Supreme Council, and it does not replace the Charter, Constitution and Laws of the Order, the council's bylaws, the forms the Supreme Council prescribes, or the advice of a qualified accountant, auditor or attorney. Screens, roles and rules can change between releases. Where this guide and the portal differ, the portal and the governing documents of the Order prevail.